CENTERLINE

PILATES

VOLUME 3

Advanced Exercises

160 illustrated exercises

THE PILATES INSTRUCTOR'S LIBRARY

How to use this volume

> *Every exercise has its own sheet: position diagram, steps, focus, target muscles, dosage, breathing, common faults, progression and regression, the exact cue to say, and an adaptation.*

1. Find the exercise in the index at the end of this section (numbers like V3-001).
2. Read the steps and the cue. Say the cue out loud once before you teach it.
3. Check the adaptation box before you teach a client with a condition (pregnancy, older adults, back, knee or shoulder).
4. Use the progression and regression to match the level of the room.

Important

This library is an educational resource for trained Pilates instructors. It is not medical advice. The diagrams are simplified to show positions: follow the written steps and your training. Ask clients to consult their healthcare provider when you are unsure.

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VOLUME 3 · ADVANCED

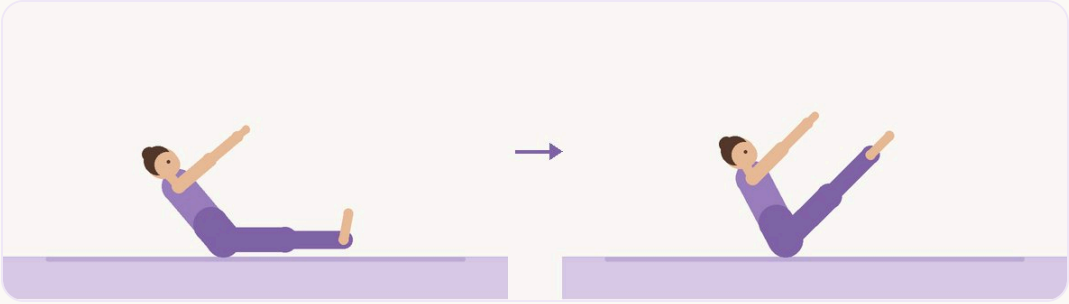
Mat

34 exercises

Teaser

full V-sit

Advanced | Mat | V3-001



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back, legs extended at 45 degrees, arms overhead.
2. Nod the chin and roll the arms and torso up together.
3. Reach your hands beside your shins and balance in a V.
4. Roll down with control, one vertebra at a time, back to start.

Focus
Builds deep abdominal strength and balance while the spine stays long. A signature Advanced mat skill.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, transversus abdominis, hip flexors, quadriceps

Dosage
5–6 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to rise, exhale to hold the V, inhale to lower.

Common faults
Rounding the lower back, swinging the arms for momentum, dropping the chest, gripping with the neck.

Progression / Regression
Easier: bend the knees, shins parallel to the floor. Harder: lower with the arms overhead and hover the legs.

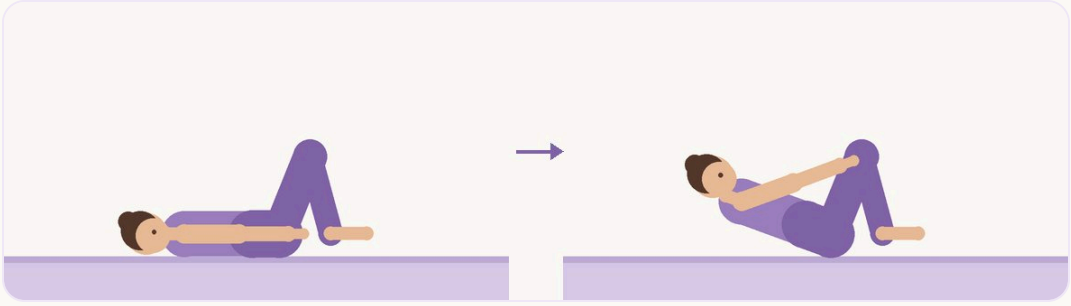
Cue
“Lift tall through your chest and balance on your sit bones.”

Adaptation
Avoid with acute lumbar pain; use Teaser Prep with knees bent. Skip in the second and third trimesters.

Jackknife

legs vertical

Advanced | Mat | V3-002



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back, legs together at 90 degrees, arms by your sides.
2. Lower the legs slightly overhead, then press the arms down.
3. Lift the hips so the body forms a long line over the shoulders.
4. Hold, then roll down one vertebra at a time.

Focus
Challenges abdominal control and spinal articulation as the hips lift. Teaches precise sequencing.

Target muscles
Lower abdominals, hip flexors, erector spinae, triceps

Dosage
4–5 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare, exhale to lift the legs, inhale to hold, exhale to roll down.

Common faults
Kicking the legs up, rolling onto the neck, letting the legs drift over the head.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Rollover with both legs only to the shoulders. Harder: add a controlled leg lower before rolling down.

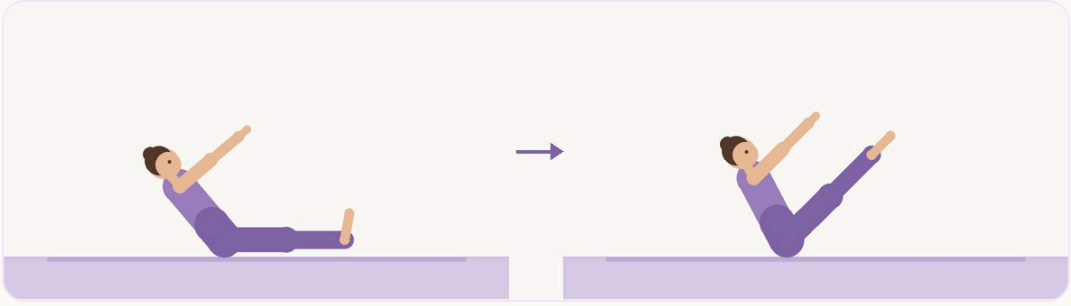
Cue
“Press your arms down and lift your hips straight to the sky.”

Adaptation
Avoid with neck issues, high blood pressure or pregnancy. Choose Shoulder Bridge instead.

Corkscrew

hips circling

Advanced | Mat | V3-003



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back with legs together at 90 degrees, arms by your sides.
2. Lift the pelvis slightly and swing both legs to one side.
3. Circle down, across and back up, keeping the legs together.
4. Reverse the direction and repeat.

Focus
Develops oblique strength and pelvic stability as the legs circle without rocking the torso.

Target muscles
Obliques, rectus abdominis, hip flexors, adductors

Dosage
3–4 circles each direction · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale as the legs swing out, exhale as they return to center.

Common faults
Letting the shoulders lift, circling too wide, sagging the lower back.

Progression / Regression
Easier: bend the knees and use small circles. Harder: place the hands behind the head.

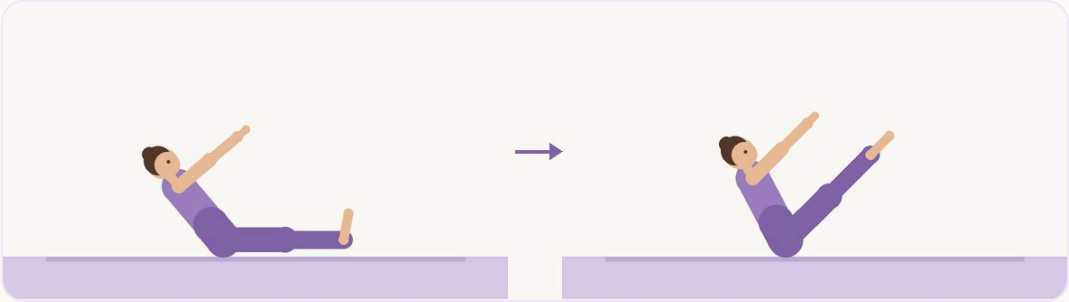
Cue
“Keep your shoulders heavy and circle from your center.”

Adaptation
Skip with disc problems or low back pain; avoid in pregnancy. Use Single Leg Circles.

Boomerang

rolling teaser

Advanced | Mat | V3-004



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall, legs extended and crossed at the ankles, hands by the hips.
2. Roll back into a Rollover, switching the cross of the ankles overhead.
3. Roll up to a Teaser balance with arms reaching behind.
4. Fold forward over the legs and repeat.

Focus
Links the Rollover and Teaser into a flowing sequence that tests coordination and control.

Target muscles
Abdominals, hip flexors, hamstrings, spinal extensors

Dosage
5 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to roll over, exhale to switch the legs, inhale to balance, exhale to fold.

Common faults
Rushing the roll, losing the crossover of the ankles, collapsing the chest in the balance.

Progression / Regression
Easier: practice Rollover and Teaser separately. Harder: add the hand clasp and reach behind.

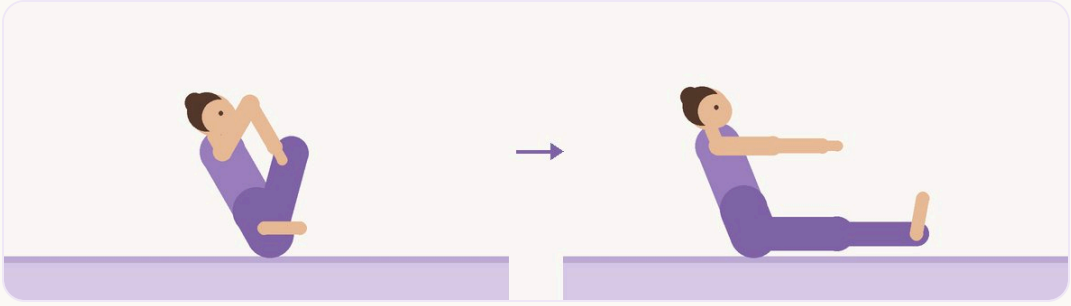
Cue
“Roll with control, cross the ankles and balance tall.”

Adaptation
Avoid with neck issues, osteoporosis or pregnancy; use Teaser Prep and Spine Stretch Forward.

Seal

clapping balance

Advanced | Mat | V3-005



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit in a tight C-curve, knees open, hands between the legs holding the feet.
2. Balance on your sit bones and clap the feet three times.
3. Roll back to the shoulders.
4. Clap and roll up to balance.

Focus
Strengthens the abdominals and promotes a smooth spinal rolling pattern with playful rhythm.

Target muscles
Abdominals, hip flexors, adductors, erector spinae

Dosage
6–8 rolls · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale as you roll back, exhale as you roll forward.

Common faults
Rolling onto the neck, letting the feet separate, losing the C-curve.

Progression / Regression
Easier: hold the ankles instead of the feet. Harder: pause in the balance with no feet support.

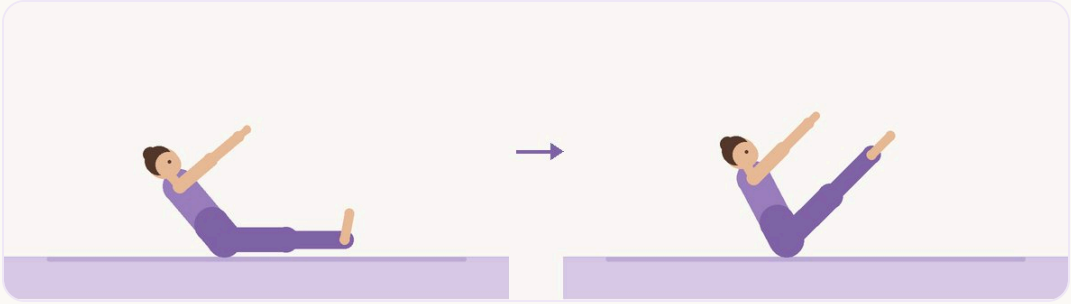
Cue
“Stay round like a ball and clap your feet.”

Adaptation
Skip rolling with spinal osteoporosis or neck pain; rock in place instead.

Crab

crossed ankle roll

Advanced | Mat | V3-006



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit in a C-curve, cross your shins and hold your feet.
2. Roll back to the shoulders, switching the cross of the legs.
3. Roll up to balance.
4. Repeat the sequence on the other side.

Focus
Challenges rolling control while the legs are crossed, building abdominal and spinal mobility.

Target muscles
Abdominals, spinal extensors, obliques, shoulders

Dosage
4–6 rolls · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to roll back, exhale to roll to the other side.

Common faults
Using momentum, letting the feet drop, rolling onto the neck.

Progression / Regression
Easier: smaller rolls without crossing the ankles. Harder: add a rolling pause on the shoulders.

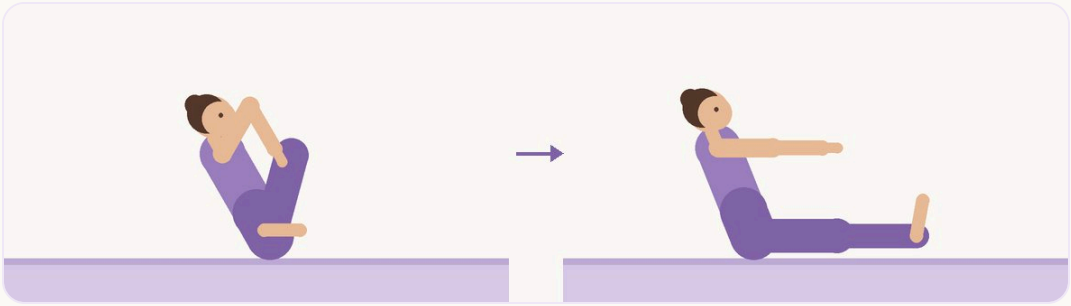
Cue
“Pull your belly in and roll over your shoulders.”

Adaptation
Avoid with neck or shoulder pain; sit in a seated spinal twist instead.

Rocking

swan rock

Advanced | Mat | V3-007



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie face down, bend the knees and hold your ankles.
2. Lift the chest and thighs off the floor.
3. Rock forward onto the chest, then back onto the thighs.
4. Lower slowly to finish.

Focus
Opens the chest and strengthens the back extensors while the front of the body lengthens.

Target muscles
Spinal extensors, glutes, hamstrings, shoulders, hip flexors

Dosage
5–6 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to lift and rock forward, exhale to rock back.

Common faults
Jerking the head back, using momentum, forcing the arch in the lower back.

Progression / Regression
Easier: hold the ankles with bent knees. Harder: reach the arms behind and hold the feet.

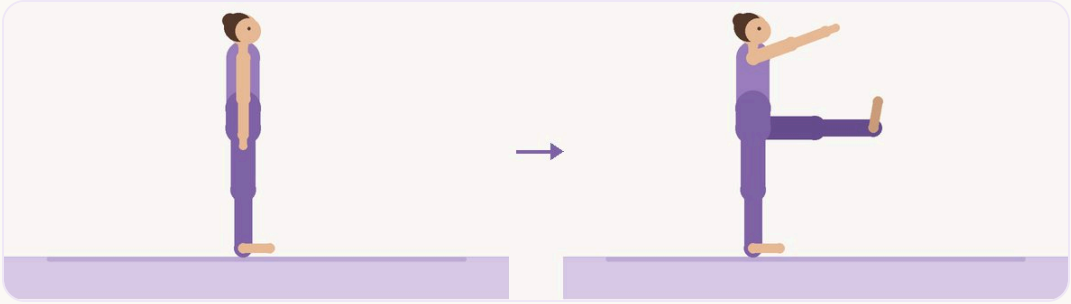
Cue
“Lift your chest and rock like a smooth wave.”

Adaptation
Avoid in pregnancy and with spinal stenosis; use Swimming instead.

Control Balance

one leg overhead

Advanced | Mat | V3-008



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back and roll over to a Rollover position.
2. Grasp one ankle and lift the other leg toward the ceiling.
3. Hold the leg switch for two counts.
4. Roll down with control.

Focus
Develops dynamic stability in an inverted position, demanding abdominal and shoulder strength.

Target muscles
Abdominals, hip flexors, hamstrings, scapular stabilizers

Dosage
3 sets of 3 · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to switch the legs, exhale to hold and switch back.

Common faults
Dropping the support leg, rolling onto the neck, losing the shoulder blades.

Progression / Regression
Easier: hold one ankle with one hand. Harder: float the arms away from the support.

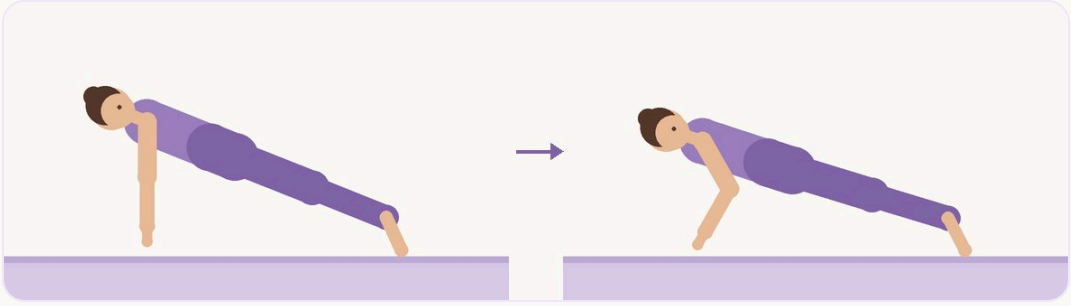
Cue
“Reach long through your legs and lift up through your hips.”

Adaptation
Skip with neck problems or pregnancy; use Single Leg Stretch.

Snake

side plank flow

Advanced | Mat | V3-009



HOW TO DO IT

1. Start in a side plank on one hand, feet stacked.
2. Lift the top arm overhead.
3. Rotate the torso and thread the arm under the body.
4. Return to side plank and repeat.

Focus
Combines a side plank with a spinal rotation, building shoulder and trunk stability.

Target muscles
Obliques, serratus anterior, shoulders, hip abductors

Dosage
3–4 each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare, exhale to lift and rotate.

Common faults
Collapsing the shoulder, letting the hips sag, twisting from the neck only.

Progression / Regression
Easier: lower the bottom knee and reduce the range. Harder: lift the top leg during the rotation.

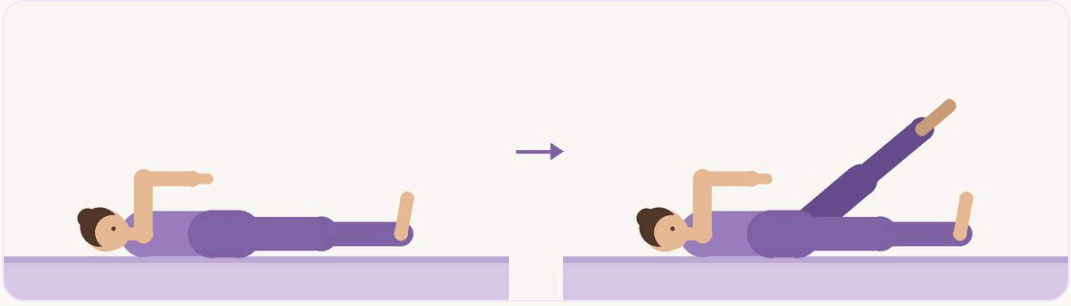
Cue
“Press the floor away and lift your hips tall.”

Adaptation
Avoid with shoulder pain or pregnancy; use Side Bend with the knee down.

Twist

side support

Advanced | Mat | V3-010



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit sideways with both legs stacked and one hand behind you.
2. Press up into a side support, top arm overhead.
3. Rotate the torso to thread the arm under the body.
4. Reverse and return to the start.

Focus
Challenges the waist and shoulders as the pelvis lifts and rotates in a controlled arc.

Target muscles
Obliques, shoulders, hip abductors, transversus abdominis

Dosage
3–4 each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to lift, exhale to rotate down.

Common faults
Hanging in the shoulders, dropping the hips, losing the leg alignment.

Progression / Regression
Easier: lower the bottom knee. Harder: lift the top leg higher during the twist.

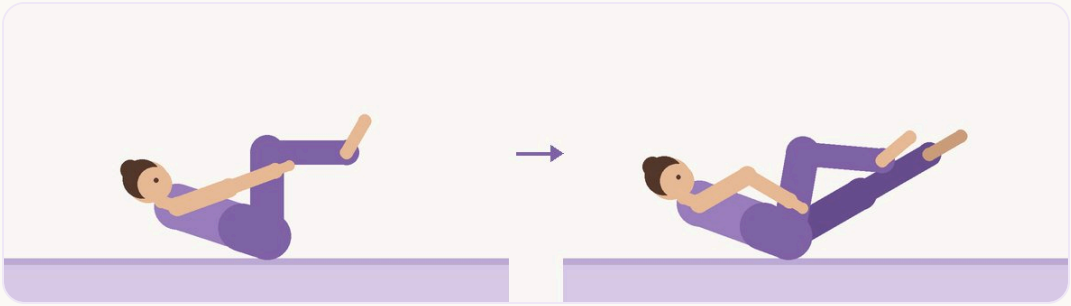
Cue
“Lift your waist and reach long through your legs.”

Adaptation
Skip with wrist or shoulder injury; use a forearm side support. Avoid in late pregnancy.

Scissors

straight legs

Advanced | Mat | V3-011



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back, legs lifted and reaching to the ceiling.
2. Lift the shoulder blades off the floor, hands behind the head.
3. Lower one leg toward the floor as the other reaches higher.
4. Switch the legs with a gentle pulse.

Focus
Strengthens the abdominals and hip flexors while keeping the pelvis steady as the legs alternate.

Target muscles
Abdominals, hip flexors, hamstrings, quadriceps

Dosage
10 reps each side · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to switch, exhale to hold.

Common faults
Arching the back, letting the neck tense, locking the knees.

Progression / Regression
Easier: bend the knees and keep the shoulders down. Harder: lower the legs slightly while scissoring.

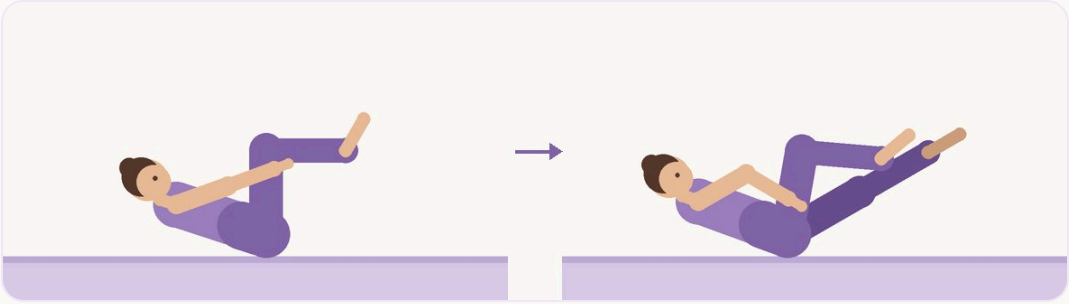
Cue
“Reach long and switch your legs without rocking your pelvis.”

Adaptation
Skip in late pregnancy and with lumbar issues; use a single leg lift with feet down.

Bicycle

pedaling legs

Advanced | Mat | V3-012



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back and roll the hips up, supporting the pelvis with your hands.
2. Extend one leg and bend the other, as if pedaling.
3. Pedal backward in smooth circles.
4. Reverse the direction and lower with control.

Focus
Builds hip mobility and abdominal control while the legs pedal in a smooth circular path.

Target muscles
Hip flexors, quadriceps, hamstrings, abdominals

Dosage
6–8 each direction · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale as the leg extends, exhale as the knee bends.

Common faults
Letting the lower back arch, bouncing the hips, dropping the elbows.

Progression / Regression
Easier: pedal with the head down. Harder: increase the leg extension and range.

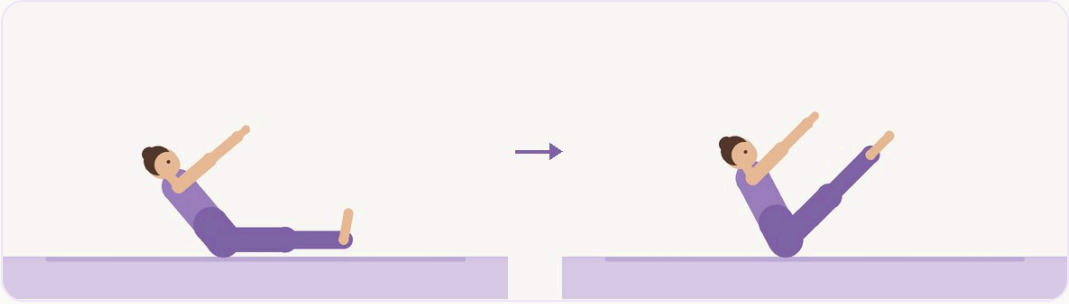
Cue
“Pedal with long legs and a still pelvis.”

Adaptation
Skip in later pregnancy; use side-lying leg circles. Avoid with neck strain.

Hip Circles

V-sit balance

Advanced | Mat | V3-013



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit in a V-position with legs lifted and hands behind you.
2. Draw the legs together in a small circle.
3. Reverse the circle after four reps.
4. Hold your balance steady throughout.

Focus
Trains core stability and balance as the legs trace a controlled circle in the air.

Target muscles
Abdominals, hip flexors, obliques, quadriceps

Dosage
4–5 circles each direction · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to circle down, exhale to circle up.

Common faults
Rolling back onto the tailbone, bending the knees, shifting the torso.

Progression / Regression
Easier: bend the knees. Harder: lift the arms to the sides during the circle.

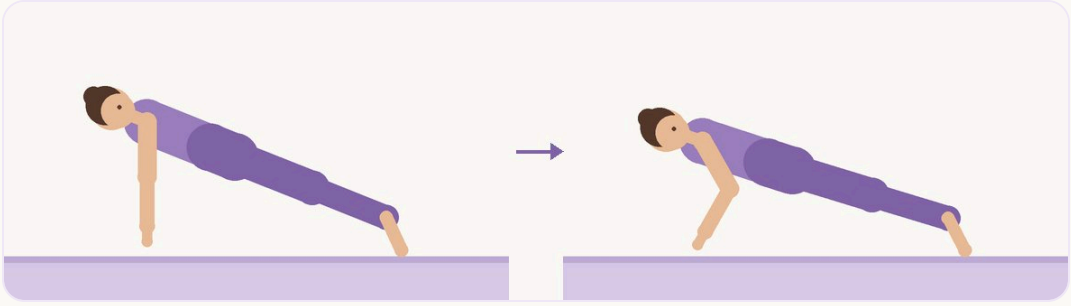
Cue
“Balance on your sit bones and let your legs circle.”

Adaptation
Avoid with low back pain or hip issues; use Teaser Prep. Skip in later pregnancy.

Push-Up

Pilates style

Advanced | Mat | V3-014



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand tall and roll down to a plank position.
2. Walk the hands forward until the body is long.
3. Bend the elbows close to the ribs and lower.
4. Press back up, then walk the hands back.

Focus
Builds upper body strength and stability with a long spine and controlled movement.

Target muscles
Triceps, pectorals, shoulders, abdominals, serratus anterior

Dosage
5–6 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to bend the elbows, exhale to press up.

Common faults
Letting the hips sag, flaring the elbows, dropping the head.

Progression / Regression
Easier: place the knees on the floor. Harder: lift one leg during each push-up.

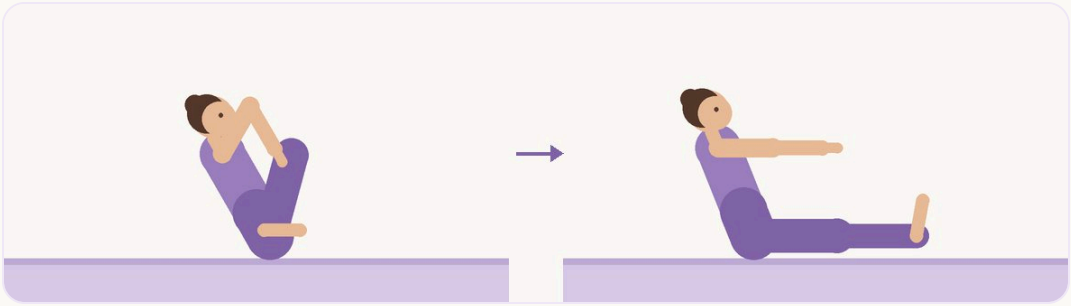
Cue
“Keep your body long and your elbows tight.”

Adaptation
Avoid in pregnancy and with shoulder or wrist pain; use wall push-ups.

Swan Dive

rocking arc

Advanced | Mat | V3-015



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie face down, hands under the shoulders, legs together.
2. Press up into a Swan, lifting the chest.
3. Lift the arms and legs as you rock forward.
4. Rock back to Swan and repeat.

Focus
Develops back extensor strength and fluid rhythm as the body rocks forward and back.

Target muscles
Spinal extensors, glutes, hamstrings, shoulders

Dosage
5–6 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale as you lift the chest, exhale as you rock back.

Common faults
Compressing the neck, over-arching the lower back, using momentum.

Progression / Regression
Easier: keep the hands near the shoulders and rock small. Harder: reach the arms forward as you rock.

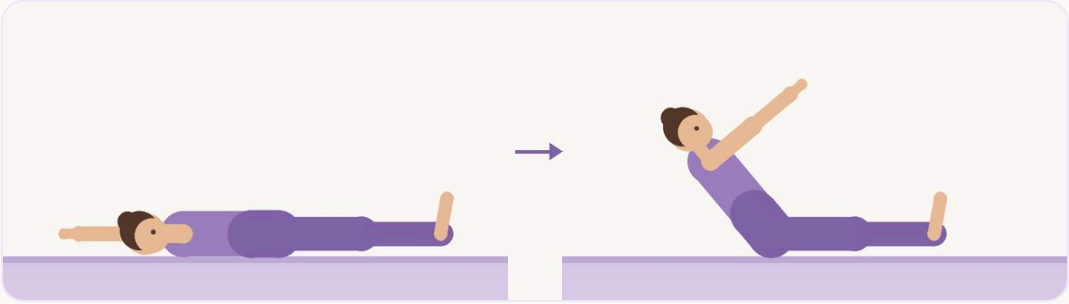
Cue
“Lift your chest and rock like a wave.”

Adaptation
Avoid in pregnancy and with spinal stenosis; use Swan Prep.

Neck Pull

with rollover

Advanced | Mat | V3-016



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back, hands laced behind the head, legs extended.
2. Nod the chin and curl the torso up.
3. Roll forward over the legs, reaching toward the toes.
4. Roll down with control.

Focus
Challenges abdominal control and spinal flexion while the legs stay lifted, with caution for the neck.

Target muscles
Abdominals, hip flexors, spinal flexors, quadriceps

Dosage
4–5 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare, exhale to curl up and forward.

Common faults
Pulling on the head with the hands, kicking the legs, rounding the shoulders.

Progression / Regression
Easier: bend the knees slightly. Harder: lift the legs slightly off the floor before rolling up.

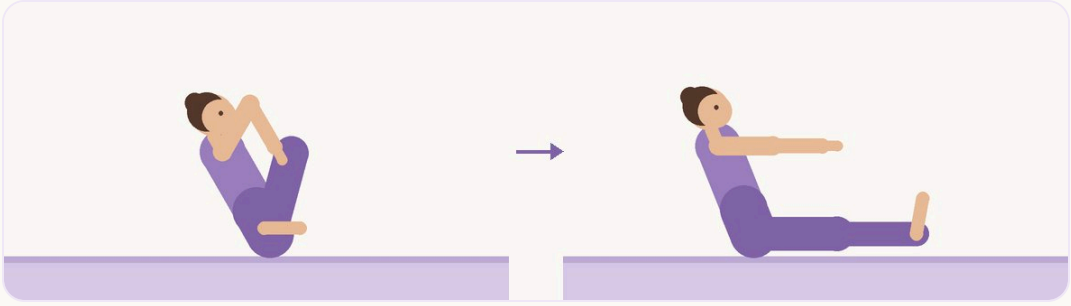
Cue
“Curl up and over your legs without pulling your head.”

Adaptation
Avoid with neck problems; use Roll Up with arms. Skip in later pregnancy.

Open Leg Rocker

balance roll

Advanced | Mat | V3-017



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall, hold the ankles with legs extended in a V.
2. Find your balance on the sit bones.
3. Roll back to the shoulders.
4. Roll up to balance and repeat.

Focus
Combines balance, control and spinal mobility as you rock with open legs.

Target muscles
Hamstrings, abdominals, hip flexors, spinal flexors

Dosage
5–6 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale as you roll back, exhale as you roll forward.

Common faults
Rolling onto the neck, bending the knees, swinging the legs.

Progression / Regression
Easier: hold the shins with bent knees. Harder: hold the ankles with straight legs.

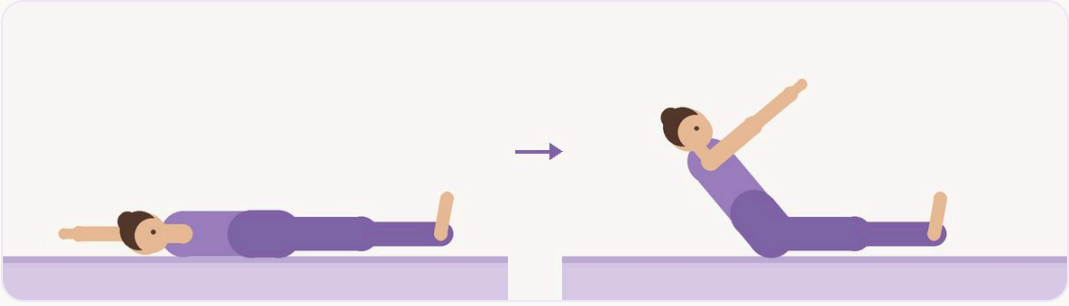
Cue
“Open your legs and roll like a ball.”

Adaptation
Avoid with osteoporosis or neck pain; use Rolling Like a Ball.

Rollover

legs overhead

Advanced | Mat | V3-018



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back, legs lifted to 90 degrees.
2. Roll the legs overhead to the floor, flexing the feet.
3. Open the legs shoulder-width and roll down.
4. Lift the legs and repeat.

Focus
Promotes spinal flexibility and abdominal control as the legs travel overhead and back.

Target muscles
Abdominals, hip flexors, hamstrings, erector spinae

Dosage
4–5 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to lift the legs, exhale to roll over, inhale to open, exhale to roll down.

Common faults
Using momentum, rolling onto the neck, bending the knees.

Progression / Regression
Easier: bend the knees and use less range. Harder: open the legs wider and lower more slowly.

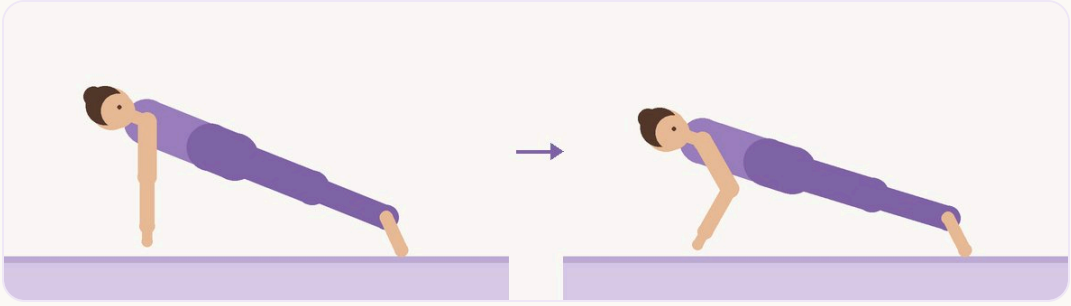
Cue
“Roll through your spine one bone at a time.”

Adaptation
Skip with neck issues or in pregnancy; use Shoulder Bridge.

Leg Pull Front

plank with leg lifts

Advanced | Mat | V3-019



HOW TO DO IT

1. Start in a plank, hands under shoulders, legs long.
2. Lift one leg a few inches while the pelvis stays still.
3. Lower the leg to the start.
4. Repeat on the other side.

Focus
Builds shoulder and core stability in plank while the leg moves with control.

Target muscles
Shoulders, abdominals, glutes, hamstrings, triceps

Dosage
5 each leg · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to lift the leg, exhale to lower.

Common faults
Rocking the hips, shrugging the shoulders, locking the elbows.

Progression / Regression
Easier: lower the knees to the floor. Harder: lift the leg higher with the foot flexed.

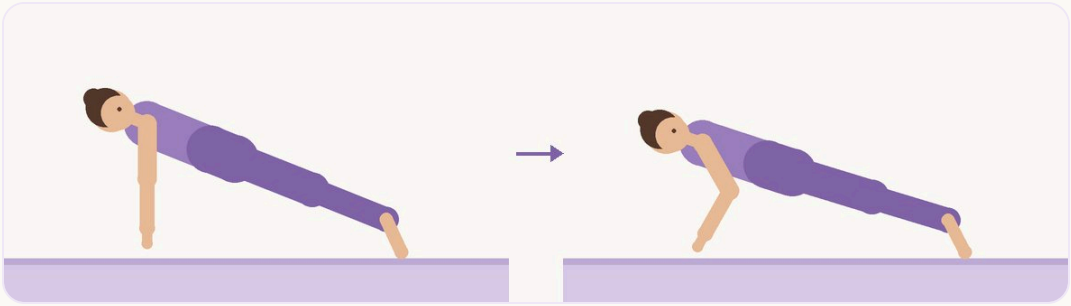
Cue
“Press the floor away and lift your leg without moving your hips.”

Adaptation
Avoid in pregnancy and with shoulder or wrist pain; use a modified plank.

Leg Pull Back

reverse plank

Advanced | Mat | V3-020



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit with legs extended, hands behind you, fingers forward.
2. Press up into a long line from head to heels.
3. Lift one leg toward the ceiling.
4. Lower it and switch sides.

Focus
Opens the chest while strengthening the back of the body in a long reverse plank.

Target muscles
Glutes, hamstrings, triceps, spinal extensors, shoulders

Dosage
5 each leg · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to lift the leg, exhale to lower.

Common faults
Dropping the hips, shrugging the shoulders, bending the elbows.

Progression / Regression
Easier: keep the knees bent. Harder: lift the leg higher with a pointed foot.

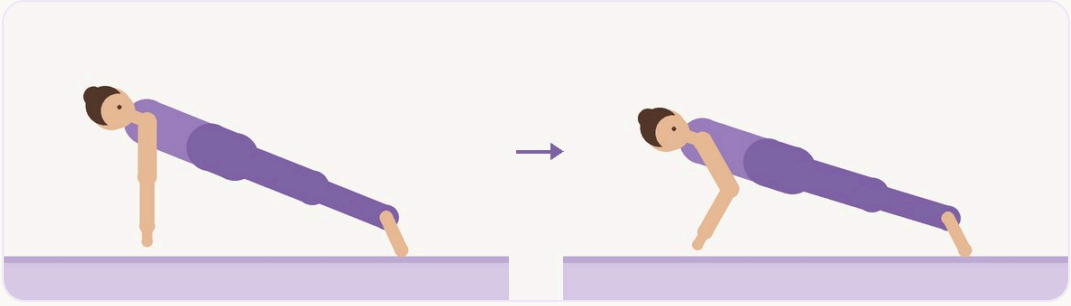
Cue
“Lift your chest and press your hips up high.”

Adaptation
Avoid with wrist or shoulder pain; use Shoulder Bridge. Skip in pregnancy.

Side Bend

side plank bend

Advanced | Mat | V3-021



HOW TO DO IT

1. Start in a side plank with feet stacked.
2. Lower the hips toward the floor.
3. Lift the hips back to a long line.
4. Switch sides after the set.

Focus
Strengthens the waist and shoulders while the body lifts and lowers on the side.

Target muscles
Obliques, shoulders, hip abductors, quadratus lumborum

Dosage
4–5 each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to lift, exhale to lower.

Common faults
Rolling forward, dropping the hips, collapsing the supporting shoulder.

Progression / Regression
Easier: lower the bottom knee for support. Harder: lift the top leg during the lift.

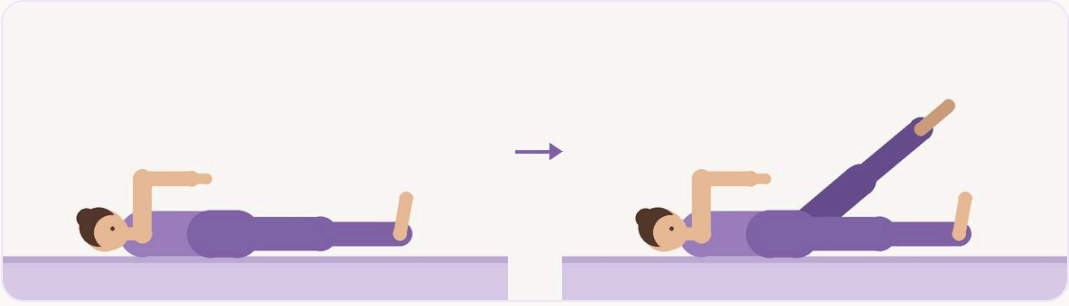
Cue
“Reach long and lift from your waist.”

Adaptation
Avoid with shoulder pain or in pregnancy; use a Side Bend with the knee down.

Kneeling Side Kick

one leg lifted

Advanced | Mat | V3-022



HOW TO DO IT

1. Kneel on one knee, hand under the shoulder, other leg extended to the side.
2. Lift the top leg to hip height.
3. Swing the leg forward with a small pulse.
4. Sweep the leg back.

Focus
Builds hip stability and balance while the top leg moves in a smooth line.

Target muscles
Glutes, hip abductors, obliques, hamstrings

Dosage
6–8 each side · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to kick forward, exhale to sweep back.

Common faults
Rolling the torso, letting the lower back arch, swinging the leg.

Progression / Regression
Easier: place the hand on a block for support. Harder: lift the arm overhead.

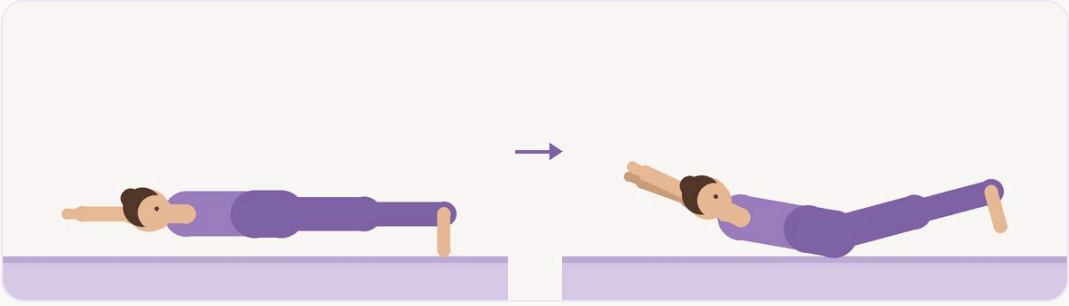
Cue
“Stay tall and sweep your leg long.”

Adaptation
Skip with knee pain; use side-lying leg lifts. Place a cushion under the knee.

Double Leg Kick

back extension

Advanced | Mat | V3-023



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie face down, hands clasped behind the lower back.
2. Kick the heels toward the glutes three times.
3. Extend the arms and lift the chest.
4. Lower and rest.

Focus
Strengthens the back extensors and opens the chest while the heels kick toward the hips.

Target muscles
Spinal extensors, hamstrings, glutes, shoulders

Dosage
6–8 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to kick, exhale to extend.

Common faults
Letting the elbows flare, tensing the neck, over-arching the lower back.

Progression / Regression
Easier: keep the head down and kick lightly. Harder: lift the arms off the floor during the kick.

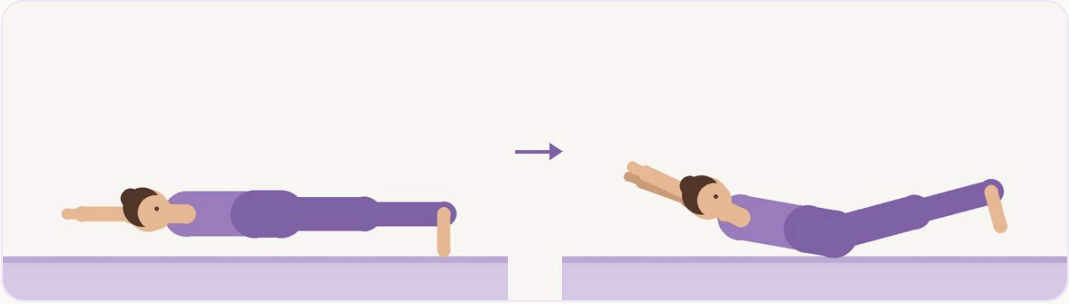
Cue
“Kick, reach and lift your chest.”

Adaptation
Skip in pregnancy; use Swimming. Avoid with spinal stenosis.

Swimming

prone flutter

Advanced | Mat | V3-024



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie face down, arms overhead, legs long.
2. Lift the arms, chest and legs.
3. Flutter the arms and legs in alternation.
4. Lower and rest.

Focus
Builds back extensor endurance and coordination with a steady flutter.

Target muscles
Spinal extensors, glutes, hamstrings, shoulders

Dosage
20–30 counts · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale for five counts, exhale for five counts.

Common faults
Over-arching the lower back, lifting the head too high, bending the knees.

Progression / Regression
Easier: lift only the arms. Harder: increase the speed with a long reach.

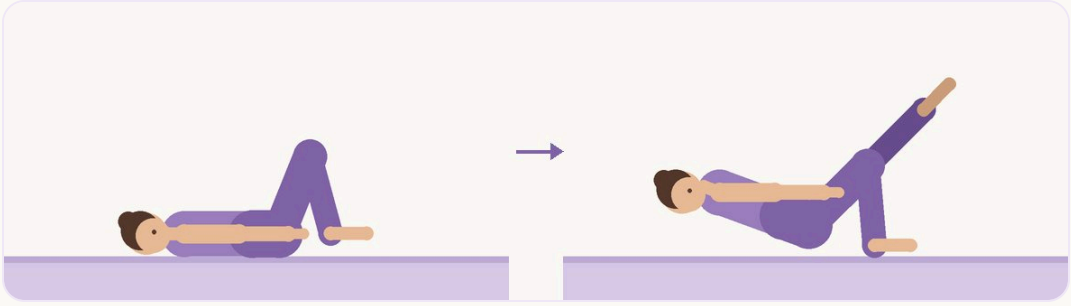
Cue
“Reach long and flutter your arms and legs.”

Adaptation
Avoid in pregnancy and with spinal stenosis; use a bird-dog.

Shoulder Bridge

one leg extended

Advanced | Mat | V3-025



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back, knees bent, arms by your sides.
2. Peel the spine up into a bridge.
3. Extend one leg to the ceiling.
4. Lower the leg and the spine with control.

Focus
Strengthens the glutes and hamstrings while keeping the pelvis steady on one leg.

Target muscles
Glutes, hamstrings, abdominals, spinal extensors

Dosage
4–5 each leg · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to lift the leg, exhale to lower.

Common faults
Dropping the pelvis, rolling to the neck, overarching the lower back.

Progression / Regression
Easier: keep both feet down. Harder: add leg lifts during the hold.

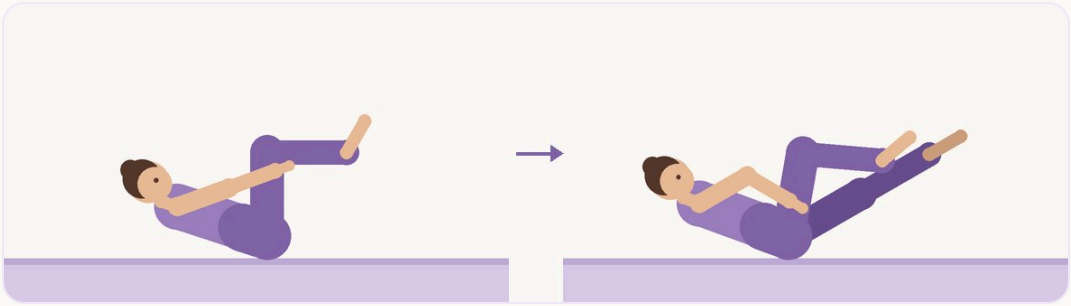
Cue
“Lift your hips high and keep your pelvis level.”

Adaptation
Skip in late pregnancy and with neck issues; use a short bridge.

Criss-Cross

rotating curl

Advanced | Mat | V3-026



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back, hands behind the head, legs at 45 degrees.
2. Curl up and rotate toward one knee.
3. Extend the opposite leg.
4. Switch sides in a smooth motion.

Focus
Challenges the obliques with a fluid rotation while the legs reach in a smooth line.

Target muscles
Obliques, rectus abdominis, hip flexors, quadriceps

Dosage
10–12 each side · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare, exhale to rotate.

Common faults
Pulling on the neck, letting the elbows swing, locking the legs.

Progression / Regression
Easier: keep the legs bent and place the feet down. Harder: lower the legs lower.

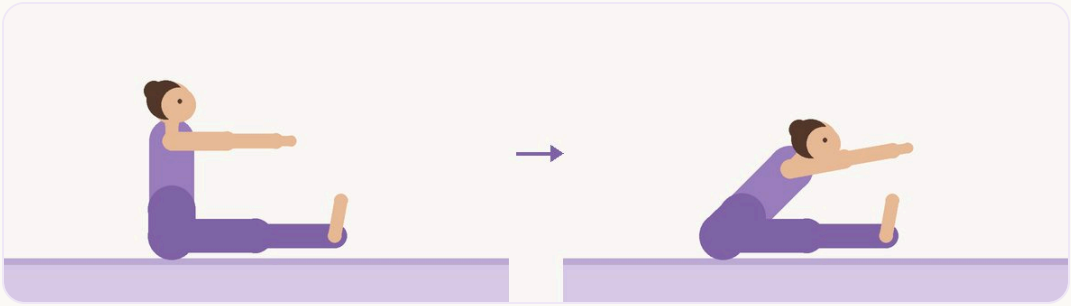
Cue
“Rotate from your ribs and reach long.”

Adaptation
Skip in pregnancy; use a gentle seated twist. Avoid with neck pain.

Saw

seated rotation

Advanced | Mat | V3-027



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall, legs wider than hips, arms out to the sides.
2. Rotate the torso to one side.
3. Reach the opposite hand past the pinky toe.
4. Return to center and switch.

Focus
Stretches the hamstrings and spine while rotating the torso to reach the opposite foot.

Target muscles
Hamstrings, obliques, spinal extensors, shoulders

Dosage
5 each side · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to rotate, exhale to reach.

Common faults
Rolling the spine, lifting the hips, bending the knees.

Progression / Regression
Easier: sit on a folded towel and bend the knees. Harder: reach beyond the foot.

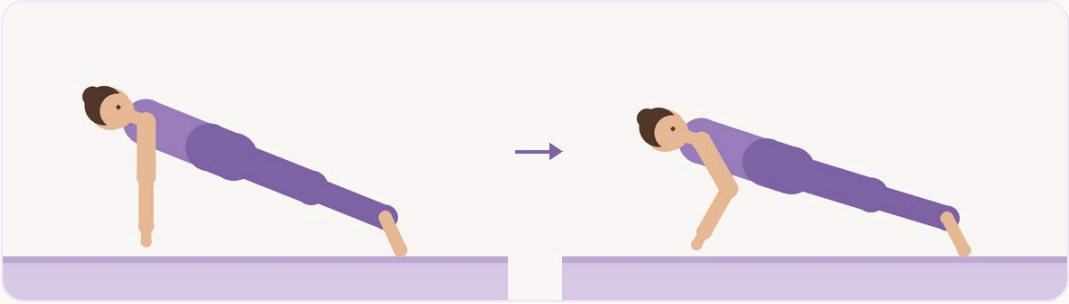
Cue
“Twist tall and saw past your little toe.”

Adaptation
Avoid in osteoporosis and with disc issues; use a seated side bend.

Star

side plank

Advanced | Mat | V3-028



HOW TO DO IT

1. Start in a side plank, one hand beneath the shoulder.
2. Lift the hips high.
3. Lift the top arm and leg toward the ceiling.
4. Hold, then lower with control.

Focus
Builds side-body strength and balance with the top leg and arm lifted.

Target muscles
Obliques, glutes, shoulders, hip abductors

Dosage
3 holds of 20 sec · about 3 min

Breathing
Breathe steadily, exhale as you lift the arm and leg.

Common faults
Sagging the hips, dropping the shoulder, rolling forward.

Progression / Regression
Easier: stay on the forearm with the knee down. Harder: lift the top leg and arm higher.

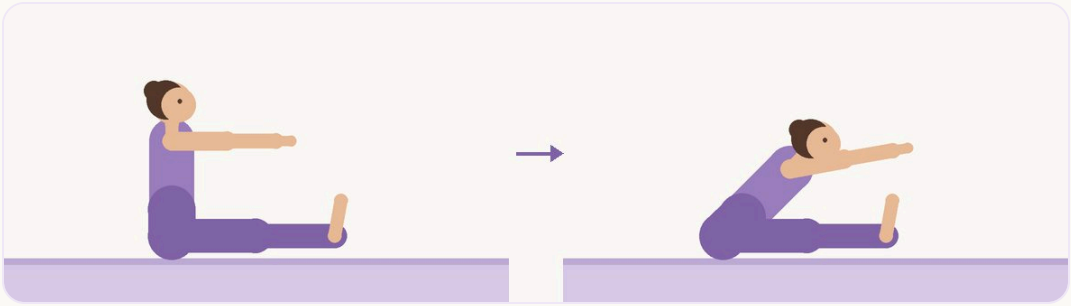
Cue
“Reach long through your fingers and toes.”

Adaptation
Skip with shoulder pain or in pregnancy; use a side plank on the knee.

Mermaid

side stretch

Advanced | Mat | V3-029



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit with legs folded to one side, hand on the floor.
2. Lift the opposite arm overhead.
3. Bend the torso sideways over the base.
4. Return upright and switch.

Focus
Opens the side body and lengthens the spine in a graceful stretch.

Target muscles
Obliques, latissimus dorsi, intercostals, shoulders

Dosage
3 each side · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to lift, exhale to bend.

Common faults
Collapsing the chest, lifting the hip, shrugging the shoulders.

Progression / Regression
Easier: sit on a cushion. Harder: add a rotation at the end.

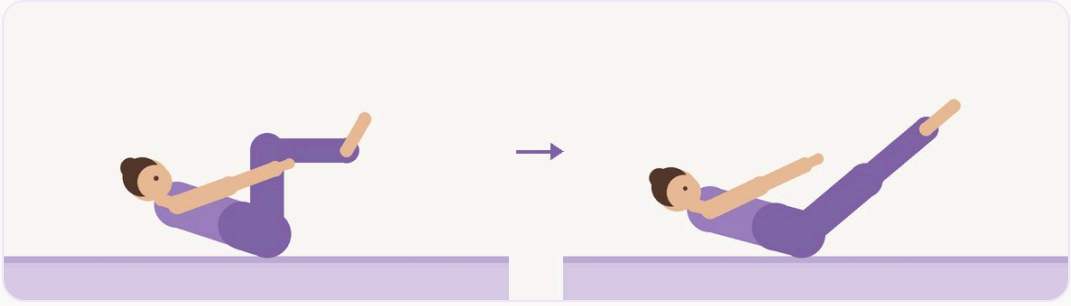
Cue
“Grow tall and curve your body like a rainbow.”

Adaptation
Use a cushion under the sit bones for knee or hip tightness.

The Hundred

legs at 45 degrees

Advanced | Mat | V3-030



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back, legs lifted and extended.
2. Curl up and reach the arms alongside you.
3. Pump the arms in small, rhythmic beats.
4. Breathe in for five and out for five.

Focus
Builds breath, abdominal endurance and heat in the body, a classic mat opener.

Target muscles
Abdominals, hip flexors, shoulders, triceps

Dosage
100 beats · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale for five pumps, exhale for five pumps.

Common faults
Letting the legs drop, tensing the neck, flaring the ribs.

Progression / Regression
Easier: bend the knees with feet in tabletop. Harder: lower the legs lower.

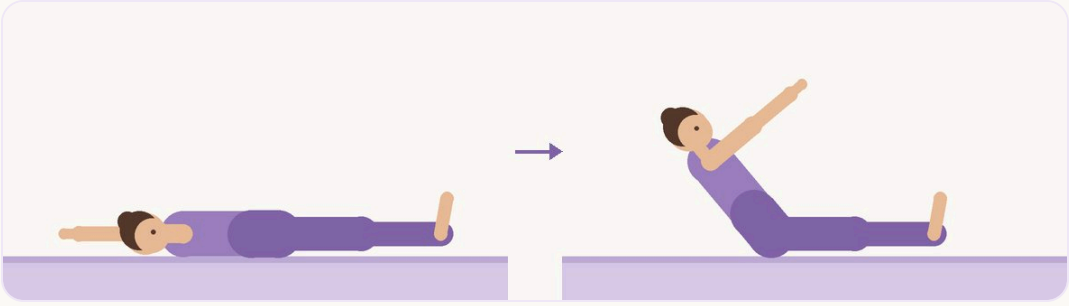
Cue
“Pump your arms and breathe in five, out five.”

Adaptation
Skip in later pregnancy and with neck issues; use a head-down version.

Roll Up

arms overhead

Advanced | Mat | V3-031



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back, arms overhead, legs long.
2. Nod the chin and roll the spine off the mat.
3. Fold forward over the legs.
4. Reverse the movement to lie down.

Focus
Builds spinal articulation and abdominal strength through the full range of movement.

Target muscles
Abdominals, hip flexors, spinal flexors, hamstrings

Dosage
6–8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to lift the arms, exhale to roll up, inhale to fold, exhale to roll down.

Common faults
Using momentum, lifting the feet, rushing the roll.

Progression / Regression
Easier: bend the knees and hold a strap. Harder: take the arms overhead.

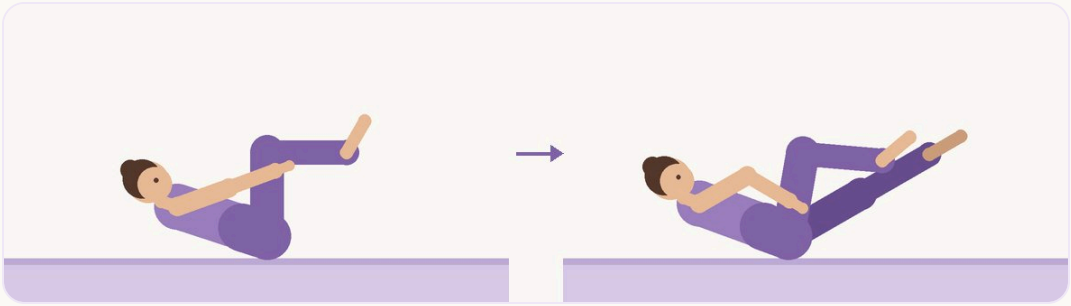
Cue
“Peel up one vertebra at a time.”

Adaptation
Skip in late pregnancy and with disc issues; use a half roll down.

Single Straight Leg Stretch

scissor pulse

Advanced | Mat | V3-032



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back, curl up with one leg lifted.
2. Pull the lifted leg gently toward you.
3. Switch legs in a smooth scissor.
4. Keep the torso steady.

Focus
Strengthens the abdominals and stretches the hamstrings as the legs switch.

Target muscles
Abdominals, hamstrings, hip flexors, quadriceps

Dosage
10–12 each side · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale for two pulls, exhale for two pulls.

Common faults
Letting the lower back arch, bending the knees, swinging the head.

Progression / Regression
Easier: bend the knee on the lower leg. Harder: hold the head up higher.

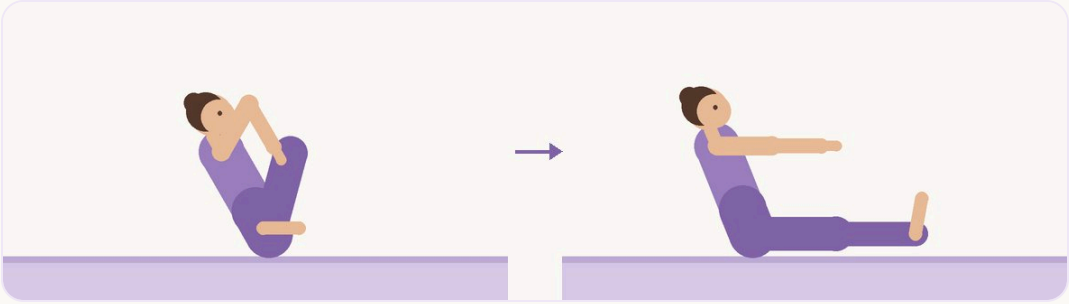
Cue
“Lengthen your legs and switch with control.”

Adaptation
Skip in later pregnancy; use a bent-knee version. Avoid with neck pain.

Rolling Like a Ball

hands free

Advanced | Mat | V3-033



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit in a curl, hands around the shins.
2. Balance on the sit bones with feet lifted.
3. Roll back to the shoulder blades.
4. Roll up to balance.

Focus
Develops balance and a smooth rolling pattern, massaging the spine.

Target muscles
Abdominals, hip flexors, spinal flexors, hamstrings

Dosage
6–8 rolls · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale as you roll back, exhale as you roll up.

Common faults
Rolling onto the neck, letting the feet touch, losing the curl.

Progression / Regression
Easier: hold the shins. Harder: hold the ankles with no hands.

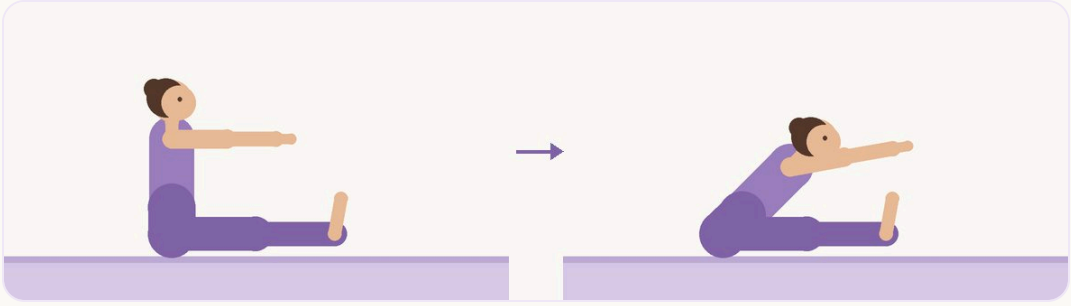
Cue
“Stay round and roll up without touching the floor.”

Adaptation
Skip with osteoporosis; rock in place instead.

Rest Position

with spinal wave

Advanced | Mat | V3-034



HOW TO DO IT

1. Kneel on the mat with big toes touching.
2. Sit back toward your heels, arms forward.
3. Rest the forehead on the floor.
4. Breathe slowly.

Focus
Restores a relaxed spine and calms the breath after a vigorous mat sequence.

Target muscles
Spinal extensors, glutes, latissimus dorsi, hip rotators

Dosage
5 breaths · about 1 min

Breathing
Inhale to widen the back, exhale to sink the hips.

Common faults
Straining the neck, lifting the hips, holding the breath.

Progression / Regression
Easier: place a cushion under the hips. Harder: add side reaches.

Cue
“Sink back and breathe into your back.”

Adaptation
Place a cushion under the knees or avoid it in late pregnancy; kneel with knees wide.

VOLUME 3 · ADVANCED

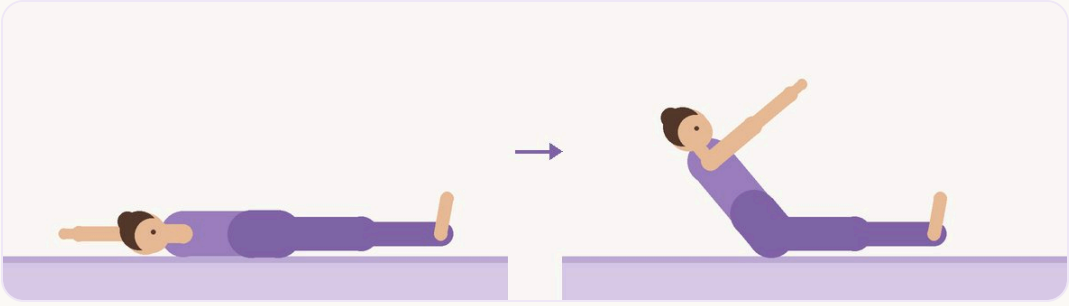
Band

10 exercises

Banded Roll Up

with band assist

Advanced | Band | V3-035



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall on the mat, legs long, band around the feet.
2. Hold the band with soft elbows and lean back slightly.
3. Curl the tailbone under and roll down, keeping the band tension even.
4. Roll back up through the spine, reaching forward over the legs.

Focus
Builds sequential spinal articulation under load, teaching control of the deep abdominals through the full roll.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, obliques, hip flexors, lats

Dosage
6–8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare, exhale to curl up, inhale at the top, exhale to roll down.

Common faults
Momentum from the arms, gripping the thighs, collapsing the chest on the way down.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Bend the knees and anchor the feet. Harder: Hold the band overhead throughout.

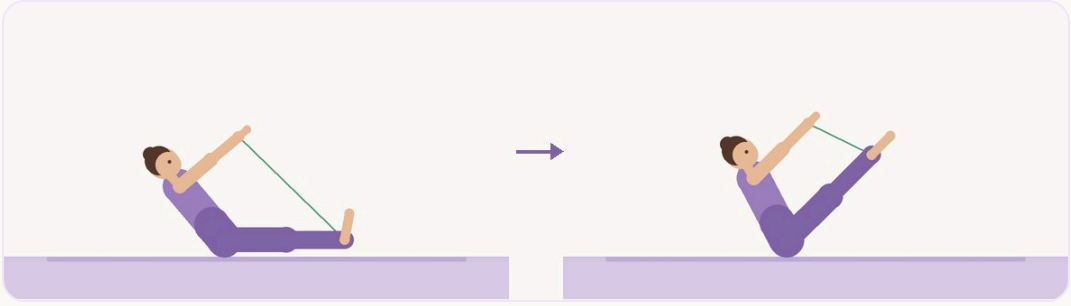
Cue
“Peel your spine off the mat one vertebra at a time.”

Adaptation
Pregnancy: avoid after first trimester. Lumbar: roll only partway and keep knees bent.

Banded Teaser Pull

band at feet

Advanced | Band | V3-036



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back with the band around the feet, legs at 45 degrees.
2. Hold the band ends, arms by the thighs.
3. Roll up into a V position, pulling the band toward your hips.
4. Hold for a breath, then roll down with control.

Focus
Challenges abdominal strength and balance while the band keeps the shoulders active and the ribcage closed.

Target muscles
Deep abdominals, hip flexors, lats, quadriceps

Dosage
5–6 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to lift into the V, inhale to hold, exhale to lower with control.

Common faults
Dropping the chest, flipping the ribs open, using momentum to reach the top.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep knees bent in tabletop. Harder: Add small arm pulses at the top.

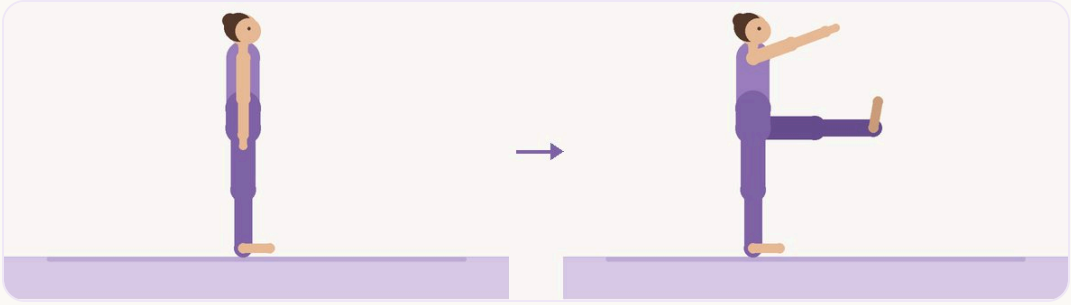
Cue
“Lift into the V and keep your chest wide.”

Adaptation
Pregnancy: avoid. Lumbar: keep knees bent and shorten the range.

Banded Single Leg Stand Biceps Curl

balance challenge

Advanced | Band | V3-037



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand on the band with one foot, holding the ends.
2. Lift the other foot slightly off the floor.
3. Curl both hands toward the shoulders with the elbows glued to the ribs.
4. Lower slowly, then switch legs.

Focus
Pairs balance and hip stability with arm work, training the standing leg to stay level while the arms load.

Target muscles
Biceps, gluteus medius, deep core, ankle stabilizers

Dosage
8 reps each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale as you curl, inhale as you lower the hands.

Common faults
Hiking the hip, locking the standing knee, swaying the ribcage.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Lightly touch a wall. Harder: Close the eyes for the last set.

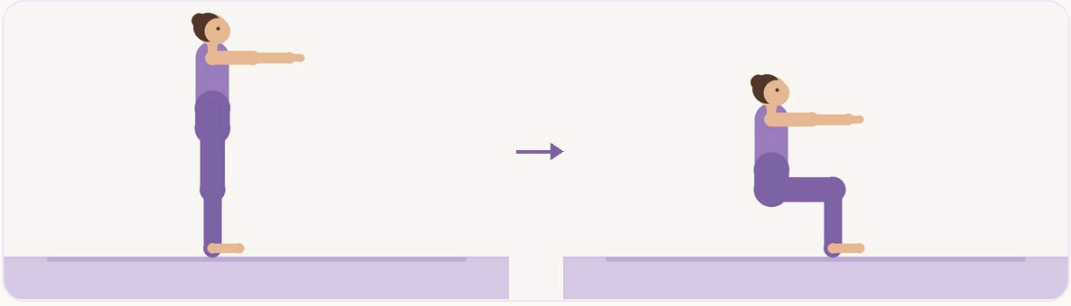
Cue
“Stand tall and keep your hips level.”

Adaptation
Older adults: stay next to a wall. Knee: keep the standing knee soft.

Lateral Band Walk

with deep squat

Advanced | Band | V3-038



HOW TO DO IT

1. Place the band above the knees, feet hip-width apart.
2. Sink into a quarter squat with a long spine.
3. Step sideways, keeping tension in the band.
4. Bring the feet in under control and repeat the other way.

Focus
Builds hip abductor strength and pelvic stability, which supports every standing and side-lying exercise.

Target muscles
Gluteus medius, gluteus minimus, outer hips, quadriceps

Dosage
10 steps each direction · about 3 min

Breathing
Breathe steadily; exhale on each step out.

Common faults
Leaning the torso, letting the knees cave, dragging the trailing foot.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Use a lighter band, no squat. Harder: Lower into a deeper squat.

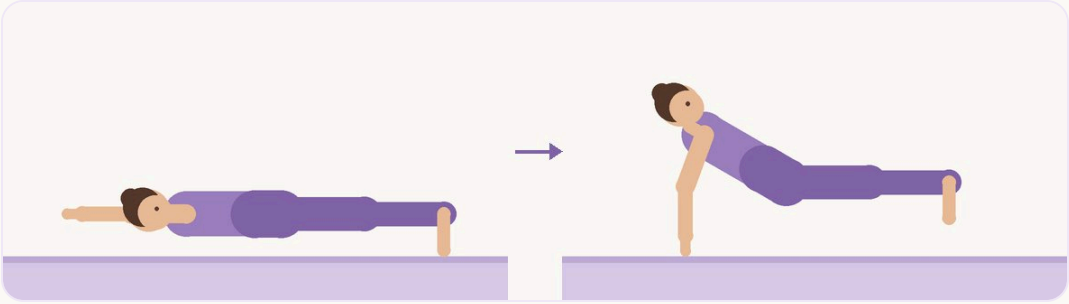
Cue
“Step wide and keep your knees tracking over your toes.”

Adaptation
Knee: reduce the squat depth. Pregnancy: use a lighter band and a wall for balance.

Banded Swan Pull

prone band row

Advanced | Band | V3-039



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie face down on the mat, band held in both hands.
2. Place your hands under the shoulders with elbows wide.
3. Lengthen and lift the chest, pulling the band apart slightly.
4. Lower slowly, keeping the neck long.

Focus
Strengthens the back extensors and mid-back while the band teaches the shoulders to stay away from the ears.

Target muscles
Spinal extensors, rhomboids, rear deltoids, glutes

Dosage
6–8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to lengthen, exhale to lift and pull the band.

Common faults
Cranking the neck, pinching the low back, shrugging the shoulders.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Lift only the head and chest. Harder: Add a leg lift.

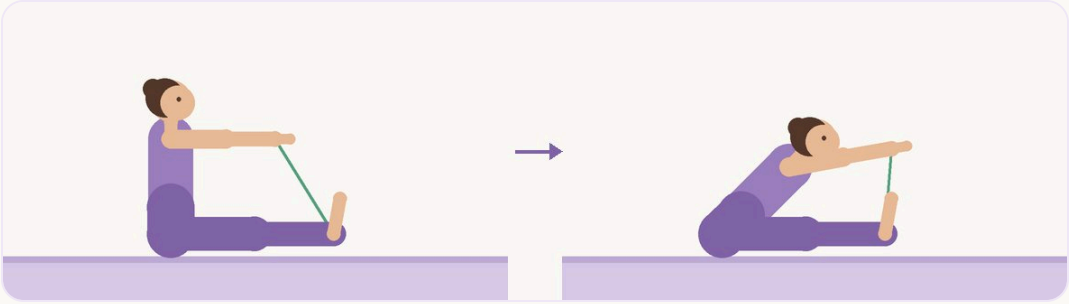
Cue
“Reach long and rise through the crown of your head.”

Adaptation
Pregnancy: do not lie prone. Lumbar: keep the lift very small.

Banded Seated Saw

with band rotation

Advanced | Band | V3-040



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall with legs wide and the band across the upper back.
2. Hold the ends with the arms out to the sides.
3. Rotate the torso toward one side.
4. Reach the opposite hand past the little toe, then return.

Focus
Increases spinal rotation while the band cues the back to stay long and the hips grounded.

Target muscles
Obliques, hamstrings, spinal rotators, lats

Dosage
4 each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to rotate, exhale to reach forward and pulse once.

Common faults
Collapsing the chest, lifting the sit bones, rounding the shoulders.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Bend the knees slightly. Harder: Add a second reach on the exhale.

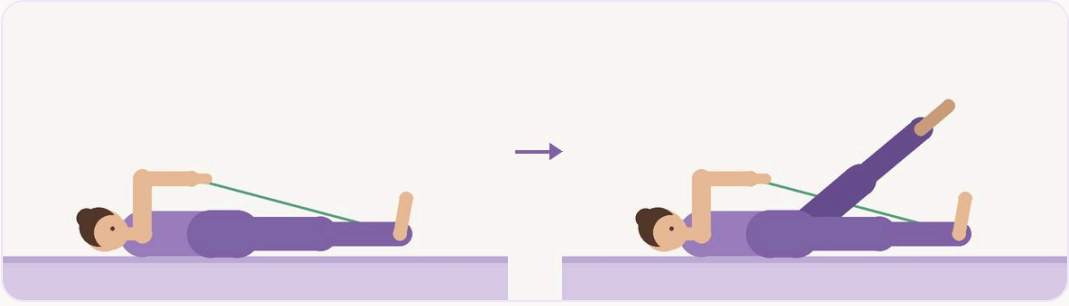
Cue
“Twist from the ribs and reach beyond your pinky.”

Adaptation
Lumbar: shorten the range. Pregnancy: widen the legs to make room for the belly.

Banded Single Leg Circles

foot in band

Advanced | Band | V3-041



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back with a band around one foot.
2. Extend that leg to the ceiling with the band held in both hands.
3. Circle the leg across, down, and around, keeping the pelvis anchored.
4. Reverse the direction, then switch.

Focus
Teaches pelvic stability while the leg moves independently, training the hip joint through a controlled range.

Target muscles
Hip flexors, adductors, abdominals, gluteals

Dosage
5 each direction each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to open the leg, exhale to close and bring it back.

Common faults
Rocking the pelvis, circles too big, losing the neutral spine.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Bend the supporting knee. Harder: Make the circles larger.

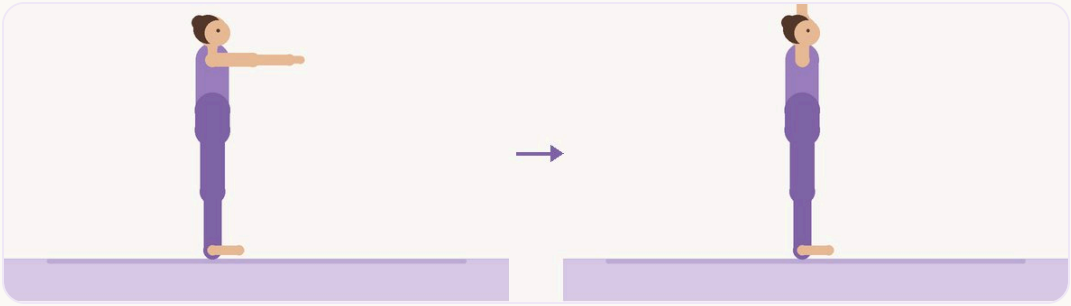
Cue
“Keep your hips still and circle from the hip socket.”

Adaptation
Pregnancy: prop the upper body after first trimester. Lumbar: bend the supporting knee.

Banded Frog Press

to straight leg

Advanced | Band | V3-042



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back with the band around both feet.
2. Bring the heels together and open the knees into a frog shape.
3. Press both legs out to a long diagonal against the band.
4. Bend the knees back to start.

Focus
Targets inner thigh and glute strength while the band adds a smooth line of resistance.

Target muscles
Gluteals, adductors, hamstrings, deep abdominals

Dosage
10 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to open the knees, exhale to straighten the legs.

Common faults
Lifting the hips, letting the knees fall, flaring the ribs.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep the heels low. Harder: Hold the legs straight for a count of three.

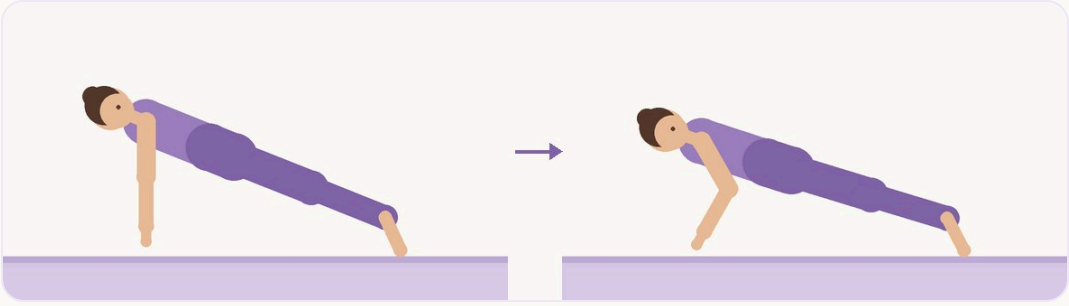
Cue
“Press your heels together and lengthen long.”

Adaptation
Pregnancy: prop the upper body. Knee: keep the range pain-free.

Banded Plank Row

with band

Advanced | Band | V3-043



HOW TO DO IT

1. Anchor the band under the opposite foot or a stable post.
2. Start in a high plank with the band in one hand.
3. Row the elbow back past the ribs without rotating the hips.
4. Lower with control and switch sides.

Focus
Combines full-body stability with unilateral pulling, which challenges the core to resist rotation.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, lats, rhomboids, shoulders, quadriceps

Dosage
6–8 each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale as you row, inhale as you lower.

Common faults
Twisting the pelvis, dropping the hips, shrugging the shoulders.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Plank on the knees. Harder: Add a leg lift on the row.

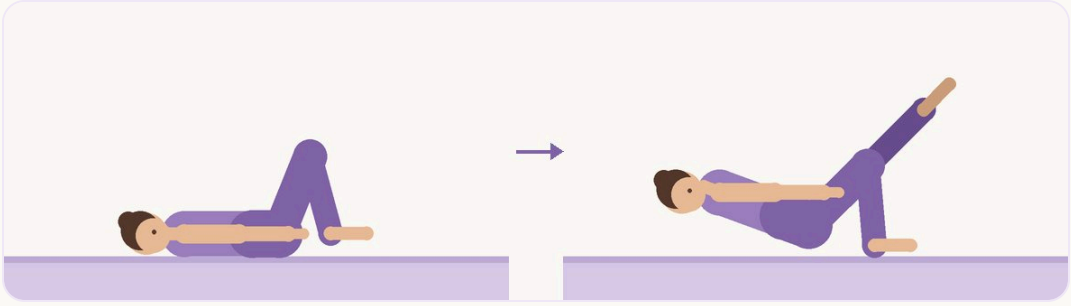
Cue
“Hold your plank and pull the elbow back.”

Adaptation
Shoulder: use a lighter band. Pregnancy: use an incline surface.

Banded Shoulder Bridge Kick

with band

Advanced | Band | V3-044



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back in a bridge with the band around the thighs.
2. Lift the hips and find a straight line from shoulders to knees.
3. Extend one leg and kick it up toward the ceiling.
4. Lower the leg with control and switch sides.

Focus
Challenges hip extension and pelvic stability while the legs move independently from a lifted bridge.

Target muscles
Gluteals, hamstrings, hip flexors, deep core

Dosage
4 kicks each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to extend, exhale to flex and kick.

Common faults
Dropping the hips, overarching the back, gripping the neck.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Hold the bridge without kicking. Harder: Use a heavier band.

Cue
“Keep your hips lifted and kick from the hip.”

Adaptation
Pregnancy: avoid long supine holds. Lumbar: lower the hips a bit.

VOLUME 3 · ADVANCED

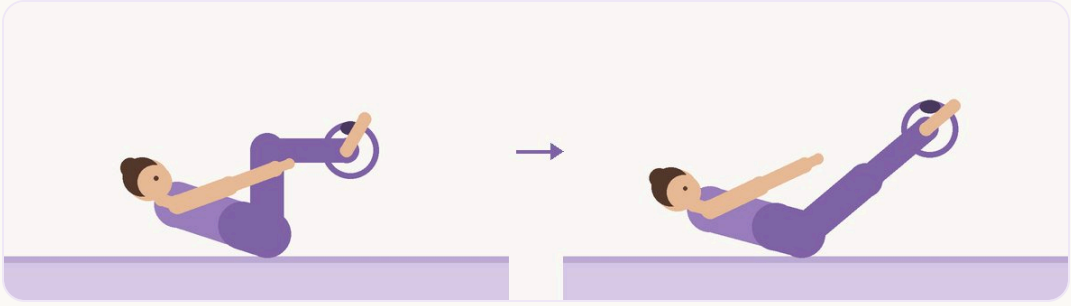
Magic Circle

10 exercises

Circle Hundred

circle between ankles

Advanced | Magic Circle | V3-045



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back with the circle between the ankles.
2. Curl the head and chest up and extend the legs.
3. Pump the arms in small beats.
4. Breathe in for five, out for five, ten times.

Focus
Builds breathing capacity and abdominal endurance while the circle recruits the inner thighs.

Target muscles
Deep abdominals, adductors, hip flexors, shoulder stabilizers

Dosage
100 pulses · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale for five pulses, exhale for five pulses.

Common faults
Lifting the chin to the chest, arching the low back, losing the circle squeeze.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep knees bent in tabletop. Harder: Lower the legs toward the floor.

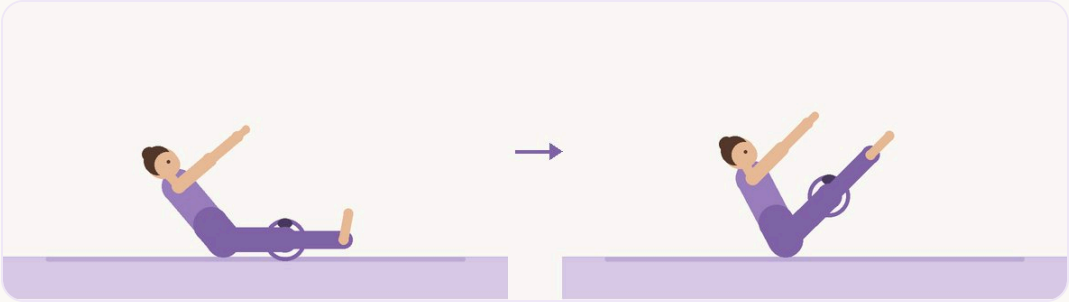
Cue
“Pump your arms and keep the circle gently pressed.”

Adaptation
Pregnancy: avoid. Lumbar: keep legs higher.

Circle Teaser

circle press

Advanced | Magic Circle | V3-046



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie back with the circle between the ankles.
2. Lift the legs to 45 degrees with arms overhead.
3. Roll up into a V, reaching the arms to the shins.
4. Roll down with control.

Focus
Challenges balance and abdominal strength while the circle keeps the legs aligned and the inner thighs working.

Target muscles
Abdominals, adductors, hip flexors, quads

Dosage
5–6 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to rise, inhale to hold, exhale to lower.

Common faults
Rolling onto the tailbone, bending the arms, losing leg alignment.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Bend the knees. Harder: Hold at the top for three breaths.

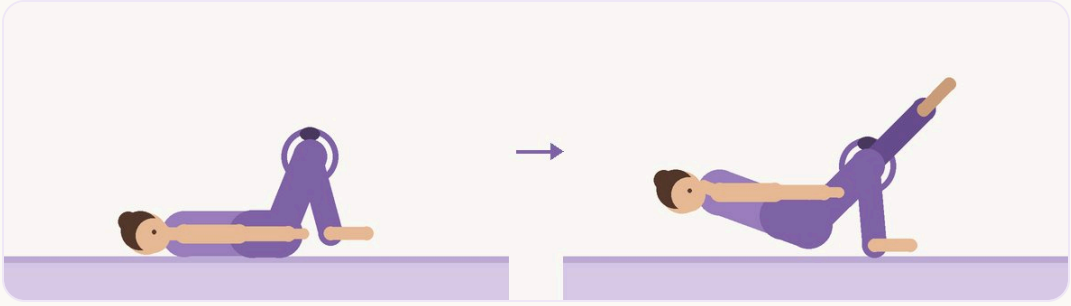
Cue
“Rise into the V and squeeze the circle.”

Adaptation
Pregnancy: avoid. Lumbar: bend the knees.

Circle Single Leg Bridge

with circle squeeze

Advanced | Magic Circle | V3-047



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back with the circle between the knees.
2. Lift one foot and extend that leg.
3. Lift the hips into a bridge and squeeze the circle.
4. Lower and repeat on the other leg.

Focus
Develops gluteal strength and pelvic stability while the circle adds an adductor challenge.

Target muscles
Gluteals, hamstrings, adductors, deep abdominals

Dosage
8 each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare, exhale to lift the hips.

Common faults
Rotating the pelvis, overarching, letting the knees wobble.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Both feet on the floor. Harder: Add a small leg extension.

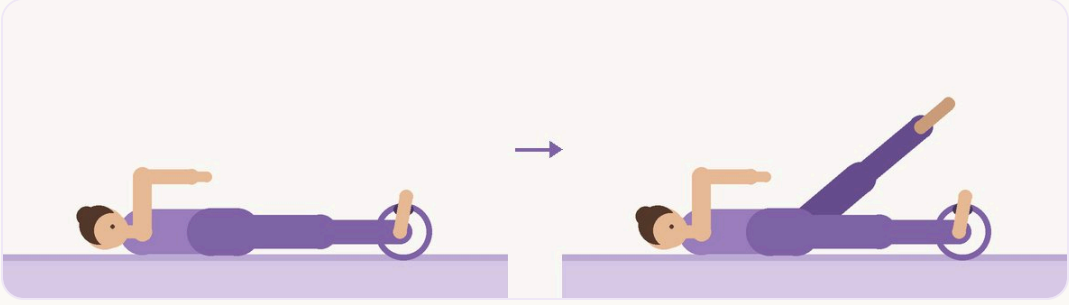
Cue
“Press through your heel and keep the hips level.”

Adaptation
Pregnancy: avoid long supine holds. Lumbar: reduce the lift height.

Circle Side-Lying Inner Thigh Press

circle between ankles

Advanced | Magic Circle | V3-048



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your side with the circle between the ankles.
2. Stack the hips and keep the waist lifted.
3. Press the circle gently together and release.
4. Repeat, then switch sides.

Focus
Targets the adductors and outer hip with a controlled resisted range in side-lying.

Target muscles
Adductors, gluteus medius, deep core

Dosage
10 each side · about 2 min

Breathing
Exhale to press the circle, inhale to release.

Common faults
Rolling the pelvis back, losing the waist lift, pressing with the foot only.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Reduce the range. Harder: Add a pulse.

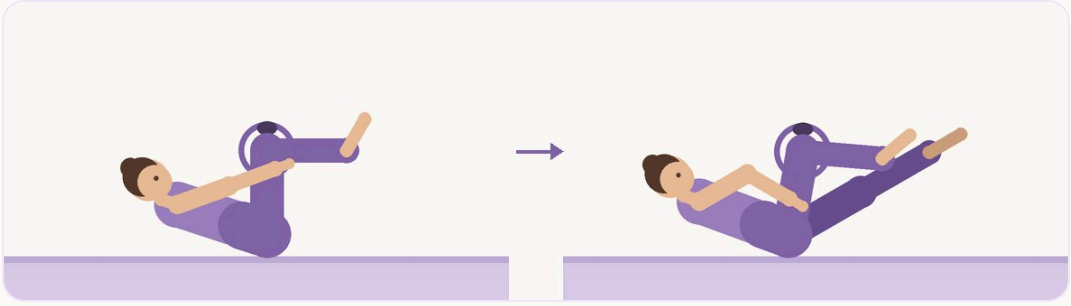
Cue
“Press the circle and lengthen your legs.”

Adaptation
Pregnancy: use a pillow under the belly. Hip: keep the range small.

Circle Criss-Cross

with circle

Advanced | Magic Circle | V3-049



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back with the circle between the ankles.
2. Lift the head and chest, hands behind the head.
3. Rotate the torso, reaching the elbow toward the opposite knee.
4. Alternate sides.

Focus
Develops rotation and oblique strength with the circle tucked between the ankles for added adductor work.

Target muscles
Obliques, rectus abdominis, hip flexors

Dosage
8 each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale as you rotate, inhale as you switch.

Common faults
Pulling on the neck, rocking the hips, losing the curl.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep knees bent. Harder: Extend the legs lower.

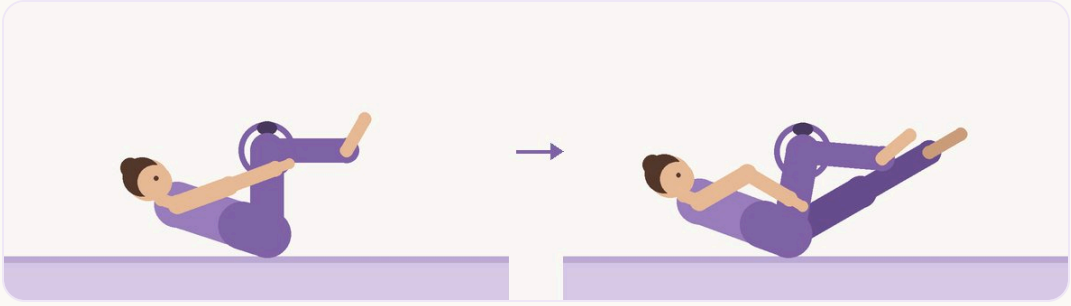
Cue
“Rotate through the ribs and reach long.”

Adaptation
Pregnancy: avoid. Neck: keep the head supported.

Circle Double Leg Stretch

circle hold

Advanced | Magic Circle | V3-050



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back with the circle between the knees.
2. Curl up and hug the knees in.
3. Extend arms and legs away from each other.
4. Circle the arms and pull the knees back in.

Focus
Trains abdominal control as the limbs extend and return, with the circle adding adductor engagement.

Target muscles
Abdominals, hip flexors, adductors, shoulders

Dosage
8–10 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to reach out, exhale to circle the arms in.

Common faults
Dropping the lower back, lifting the head too high, gripping the circle.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep the head down. Harder: Lower the legs further.

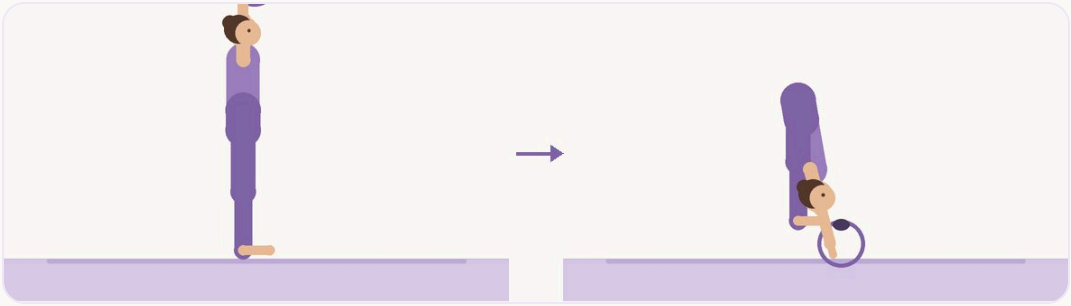
Cue
“Reach long and pull everything back to center.”

Adaptation
Pregnancy: avoid. Lumbar: keep the legs higher.

Circle Standing Roll Down

with overhead circle

Advanced | Magic Circle | V3-051



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand tall with the circle held overhead.
2. Tuck the chin and roll the spine down.
3. Pause at the bottom and press into the circle.
4. Stack the spine back up.

Focus
Teaches segmental flexion while the circle keeps the shoulders active and the upper back long.

Target muscles
Abdominals, spinal flexors, hamstrings, shoulders

Dosage
6 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Exhale as you roll down, inhale at the bottom, exhale as you stack up.

Common faults
Dropping the circle, locking the knees, collapsing the chest.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep knees soft. Harder: Add a squeeze at the bottom.

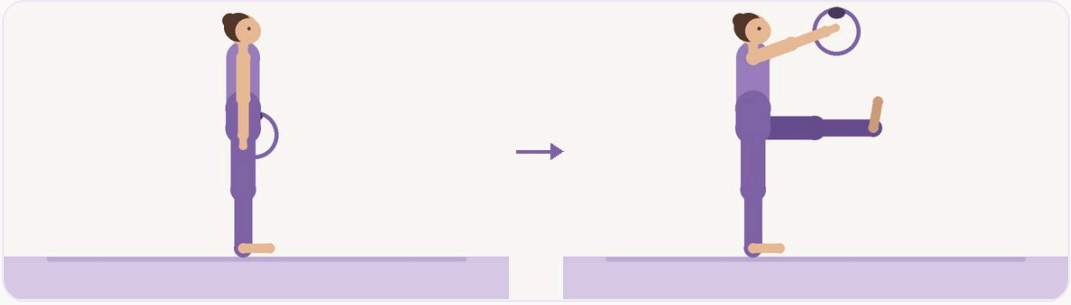
Cue
“Roll down slowly and keep your arms active.”

Adaptation
Pregnancy: widen the stance. Lumbar: bend the knees more.

Circle Single Leg Balance Chest Press

standing

Advanced | Magic Circle | V3-052



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand on one leg holding the circle at chest height.
2. Lift the other foot slightly off the floor.
3. Press the palms together against the circle.
4. Release and repeat, then switch legs.

Focus
Pairs standing balance with chest and shoulder work, challenging the stabilizers on one leg.

Target muscles
Pectorals, hip stabilizers, deep core, ankle stabilizers

Dosage
8 each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to press the circle, inhale to release.

Common faults
Leaning the torso, locking the knee, shrugging the shoulders.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Lightly touch a wall. Harder: Add a heel raise.

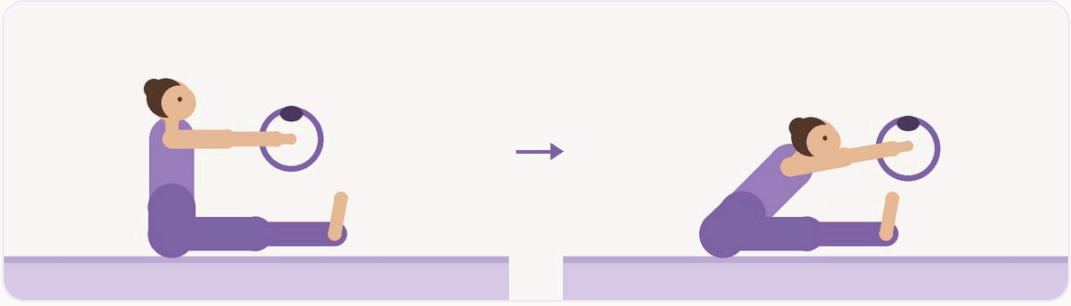
Cue
“Press the circle and keep your balance.”

Adaptation
Older adults: hold a wall. Knee: keep the standing knee soft.

Circle Spine Stretch Forward

with circle

Advanced | Magic Circle | V3-053



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall with legs wide and the circle held in front.
2. Inhale to lengthen the spine.
3. Exhale as you curl forward, reaching the circle over the legs.
4. Roll back up one vertebra at a time.

Focus
Lengthens the back and hamstrings while promoting a deep abdominal scoop with the circle held in front.

Target muscles
Spinal extensors, hamstrings, deep abdominals

Dosage
6 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to sit tall, exhale to round forward.

Common faults
Collapsing the chest, bending the knees, shrugging the shoulders.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Sit on a folded towel. Harder: Add a deeper curl.

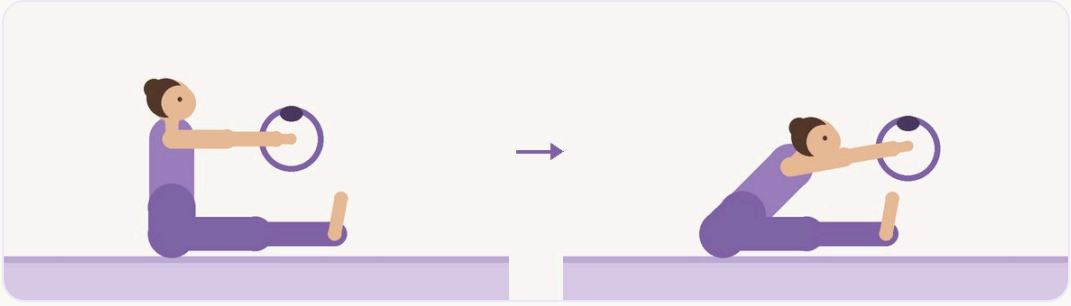
Cue
“Round forward over a big beach ball and reach long.”

Adaptation
Lumbar: sit on a pad. Pregnancy: widen the legs.

Circle Seated Arm Press

circle at chest

Advanced | Magic Circle | V3-054



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall on the mat with legs crossed.
2. Hold the circle with both hands at chest height.
3. Press the circle gently together.
4. Release slowly.

Focus
Strengthens the chest and inner arms while the posture muscles stay engaged.

Target muscles
Pectorals, triceps, serratus anterior, deep core

Dosage
10–12 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Exhale to press, inhale to release.

Common faults
Shrugging, rounding the back, losing the ribcage position.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Reduce the resistance. Harder: Press with the arms raised.

Cue
“Press from your chest and keep your shoulders down.”

Adaptation
Shoulder: keep the range small. Pregnancy: sit tall on a cushion.

VOLUME 3 · ADVANCED

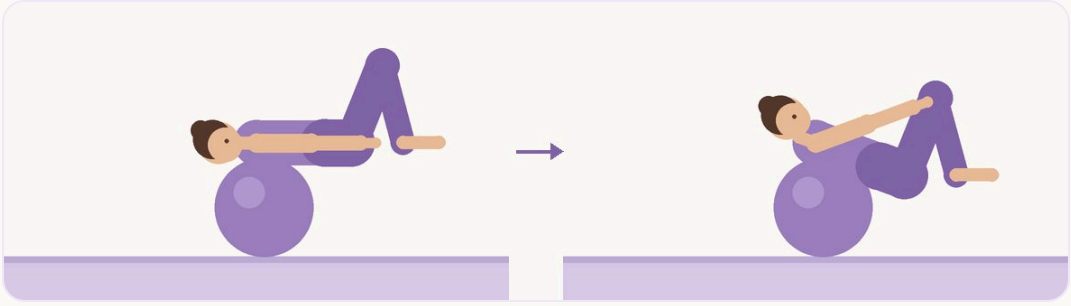
Stability Ball

12 exercises

Ball Roll Up

on the ball

Advanced | Stability Ball | V3-055



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie with the ball under the low back and feet grounded.
2. Reach arms overhead.
3. Curl up, sweeping the arms forward.
4. Roll back down with control.

Focus
Builds abdominal control and spinal articulation while the ball supports the low back through a deeper range.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, hip flexors, obliques

Dosage
6–8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare, exhale to curl up.

Common faults
Using momentum, tilting the ball, yanking the neck.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Cross the arms on the chest. Harder: Hold the arms overhead.

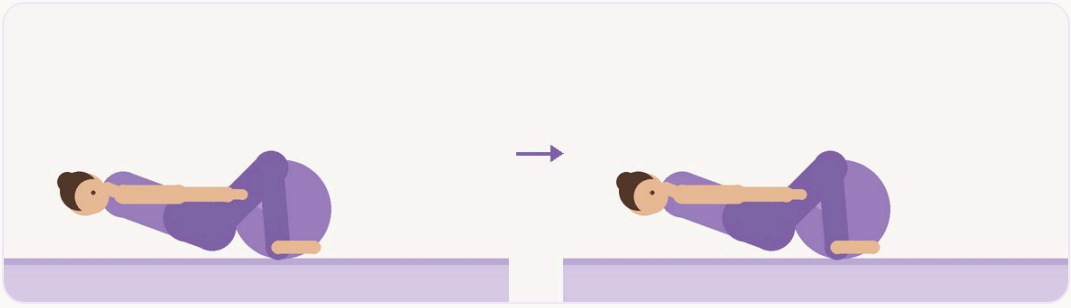
Cue
“Peel up one vertebra at a time and press your feet down.”

Adaptation
Pregnancy: avoid. Lumbar: reduce the range.

Ball Hundred

feet on the ball

Advanced | Stability Ball | V3-056



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie with the ball between the lower legs.
2. Curl up and extend the legs.
3. Pump the arms.
4. Inhale five, exhale five.

Focus
Develops breath and core endurance while the ball challenges pelvic stability.

Target muscles
Abdominals, hip flexors, shoulder stabilizers

Dosage
100 pulses · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale for five pulses, exhale for five pulses.

Common faults
Lifting the chin, arching the back, letting the ball slip.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep the head down. Harder: Lift the legs higher.

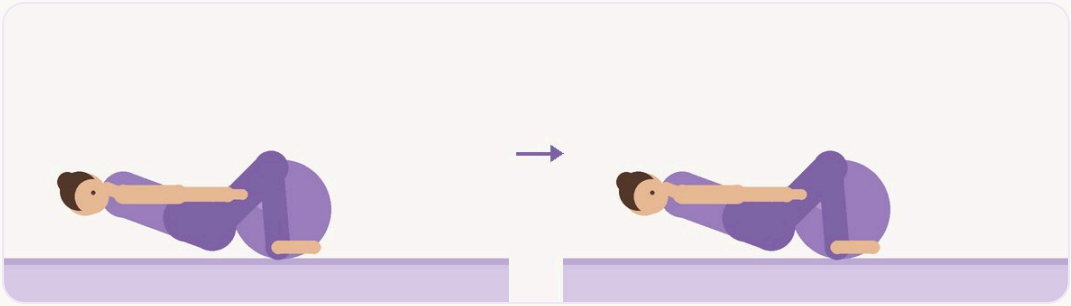
Cue
“Pump the arms and keep your core strong.”

Adaptation
Pregnancy: avoid. Neck: keep the head supported.

Ball Pike

feet on the ball

Advanced | Stability Ball | V3-057



HOW TO DO IT

1. Start in a plank with the shins on the ball.
2. Brace the core.
3. Lift the hips up toward the ceiling.
4. Roll back to plank.

Focus
Challenges shoulder stability and core strength by lifting the hips over the shoulders.

Target muscles
Abdominals, shoulders, hip flexors, triceps

Dosage
6–8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to pike, inhale to return.

Common faults
Bending the knees, dropping the head, collapsing the lower back.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep knees bent. Harder: Pike on one leg.

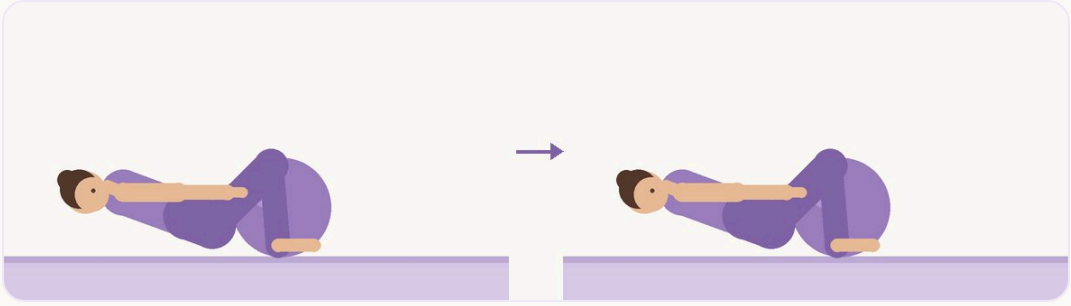
Cue
“Lift your hips and keep your legs long.”

Adaptation
Shoulder: avoid. Pregnancy: avoid.

Ball Hamstring Curl

bridge on the ball

Advanced | Stability Ball | V3-058



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back with heels on the ball.
2. Lift the hips into a bridge.
3. Curl the ball toward the glutes.
4. Roll it back out.

Focus
Strengthens the hamstrings and glutes while the ball demands deep abdominal control.

Target muscles
Hamstrings, gluteals, deep core

Dosage
8–10 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to curl in, inhale to extend.

Common faults
Letting the hips sag, rolling the ball sideways, arching the back.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep both feet on the ball. Harder: Curl one leg.

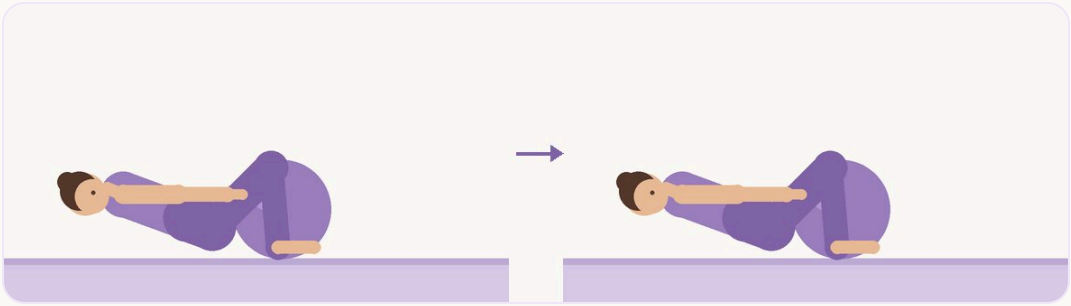
Cue
“Curl the ball in and keep your hips lifted.”

Adaptation
Pregnancy: avoid prolonged supine. Lumbar: reduce the lift.

Ball Jackknife

on the ball

Advanced | Stability Ball | V3-059



HOW TO DO IT

1. Start in a plank with the shins on the ball.
2. Pull the ball in toward the chest.
3. Lift the hips high.
4. Roll the ball back out.

Focus
Builds core strength by rolling the ball in under the hips and extending the legs overhead.

Target muscles
Abdominals, hip flexors, shoulders

Dosage
5–6 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to lift, inhale to lower.

Common faults
Dropping the hips, bending the knees, hunching the shoulders.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep knees bent. Harder: Straighten the legs fully.

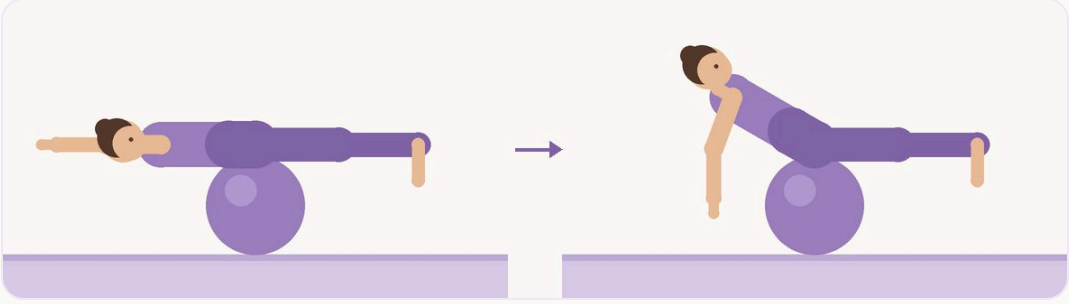
Cue
“Roll the ball in and lift your hips.”

Adaptation
Shoulder: avoid. Pregnancy: avoid.

Ball Back Extension

over the ball

Advanced | Stability Ball | V3-060



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie face down over the ball.
2. Place the feet against the wall.
3. Lift the chest, reaching long.
4. Lower with control.

Focus
Strengthens the spinal extensors and glutes while the ball supports the torso.

Target muscles
Spinal extensors, glutes, rhomboids

Dosage
8–10 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to lengthen, exhale to lift.

Common faults
Cranking the neck, overextending the low back, lifting the legs too high.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Place hands behind the head. Harder: Reach the arms overhead.

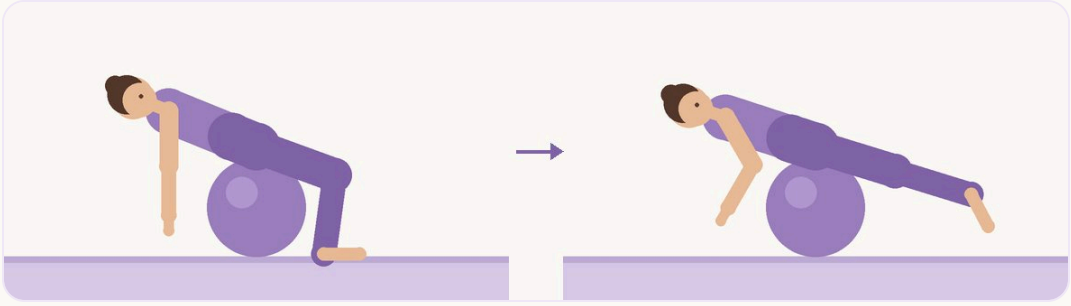
Cue
“Lengthen and lift your chest.”

Adaptation
Pregnancy: avoid prone. Lumbar: reduce the range.

Ball Stir the Pot

forearm plank

Advanced | Stability Ball | V3-061



HOW TO DO IT

1. Place the forearms on the ball in plank.
2. Squeeze the glutes.
3. Circle the forearms slowly.
4. Reverse direction.

Focus
Challenges core stability by circling the forearms on the ball while the body stays still.

Target muscles
Deep abdominals, shoulders, obliques

Dosage
6 circles each direction · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to circle out, exhale to circle in.

Common faults
Dropping the hips, rotating the pelvis, shrugging the shoulders.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Plank on the knees. Harder: Make the circles larger.

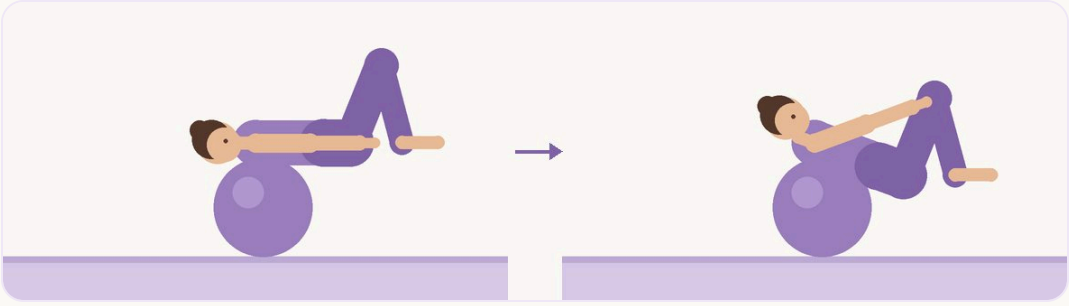
Cue
“Circle your arms and hold your plank.”

Adaptation
Shoulder: avoid. Pregnancy: use an incline.

Ball Teaser

on the ball

Advanced | Stability Ball | V3-062



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit on the ball and walk the feet forward.
2. Lean back slightly with arms forward.
3. Lift one leg.
4. Hold and switch.

Focus
Builds balance and abdominal strength while the ball adds an unstable surface.

Target muscles
Abdominals, hip flexors, quadriceps

Dosage
5–6 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to rise, inhale to hold.

Common faults
Losing the ball position, dropping the chest, bending the arms.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Bend the knees. Harder: Reach arms overhead.

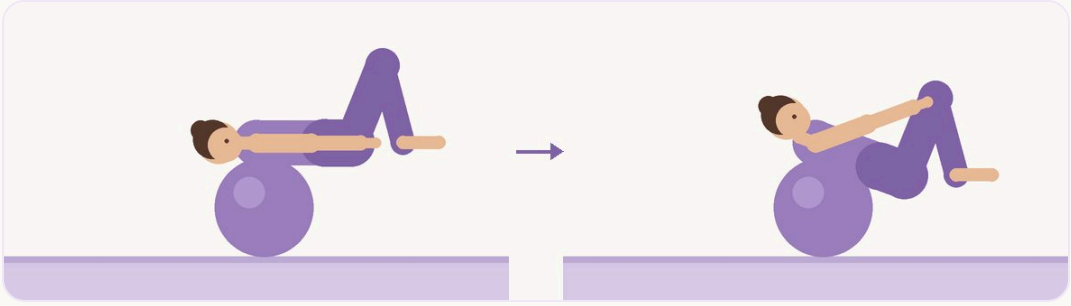
Cue
“Rise up and stay tall through your chest.”

Adaptation
Pregnancy: avoid. Lumbar: bend the knees.

Ball Side Bend

over the ball

Advanced | Stability Ball | V3-063



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie sideways over the ball with the feet staggered.
2. Reach the top arm overhead.
3. Bend sideways over the ball.
4. Lift back up.

Focus
Lengthens the side body and strengthens the obliques with ball support.

Target muscles
Obliques, quadratus lumborum, shoulders

Dosage
6 each side · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to lengthen, exhale to bend.

Common faults
Collapsing the waist, rolling forward, lifting the shoulders.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Use a wall for support. Harder: Reach the arm overhead.

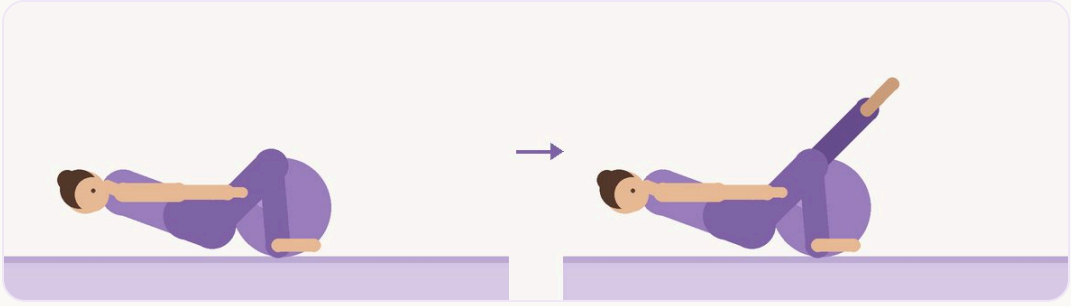
Cue
“Reach long and lift out of the waist.”

Adaptation
Pregnancy: widen the stance. Lumbar: reduce range.

Ball Single Leg Bridge

feet on the ball

Advanced | Stability Ball | V3-064



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie with one foot on the ball.
2. Extend the other leg.
3. Lift the hips.
4. Lower with control.

Focus
Challenges pelvic stability and glute strength with an unstable surface.

Target muscles
Glutes, hamstrings, deep core

Dosage
6–8 each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare, exhale to lift.

Common faults
Dropping the hip, rolling the ball, overarching.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Both feet on the ball. Harder: Lift one leg higher.

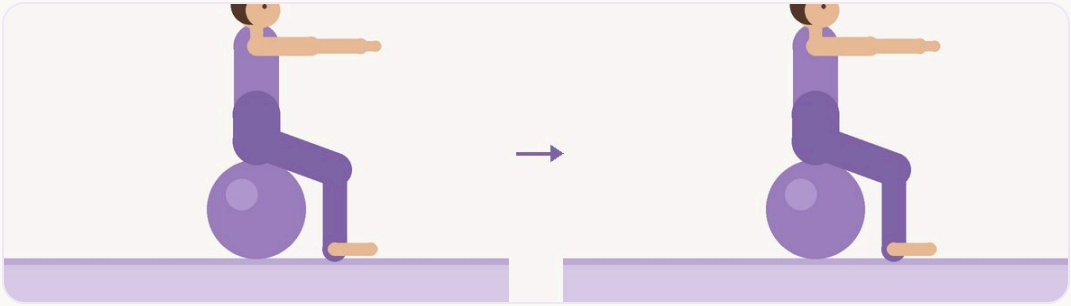
Cue
“Lift your hips and keep your pelvis level.”

Adaptation
Pregnancy: avoid. Lumbar: reduce the lift.

Ball Seated Balance Hover

feet lifted

Advanced | Stability Ball | V3-065



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall on the ball.
2. Lift one foot.
3. Lift the other foot.
4. Hold the balance.

Focus
Trains core strength and balance while the ball moves beneath the body.

Target muscles
Deep core, hip flexors, balance stabilizers

Dosage
3 holds of 20 sec · about 2 min

Breathing
Breathe steadily without holding the breath.

Common faults
Gripping the ball, leaning back, shifting the weight.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep one foot down. Harder: Lift the arms overhead.

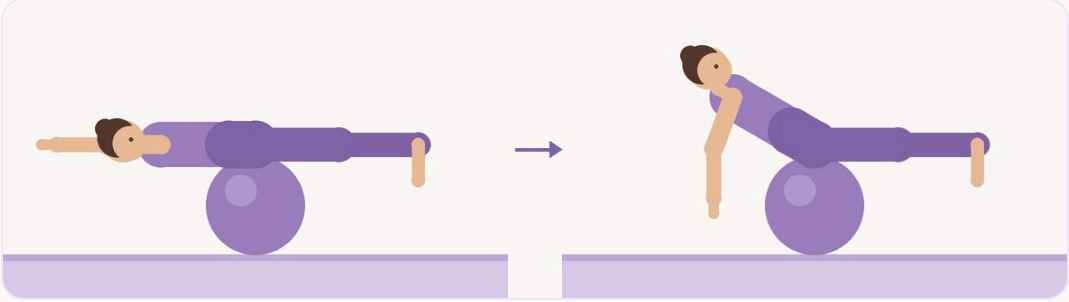
Cue
“Sit tall and hover your feet.”

Adaptation
Older adults: use a wall. Pregnancy: keep a hand near a support.

Ball Over Extension Stretch

over the ball

Advanced | Stability Ball | V3-066



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie back over the ball.
2. Let the arms drape overhead.
3. Breathe into the ribs.
4. Roll up slowly.

Focus
Opens the front body and releases the spine after flexion-heavy work.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, hip flexors, chest

Dosage
3 holds of 30 sec · about 2 min

Breathing
Breathe slowly and deeply.

Common faults
Overarching, holding the breath, pinching the low back.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Small range. Harder: Reach the arms overhead.

Cue
“Open your chest and breathe slowly.”

Adaptation
Pregnancy: avoid. Lumbar: reduce the range.

VOLUME 3 · ADVANCED

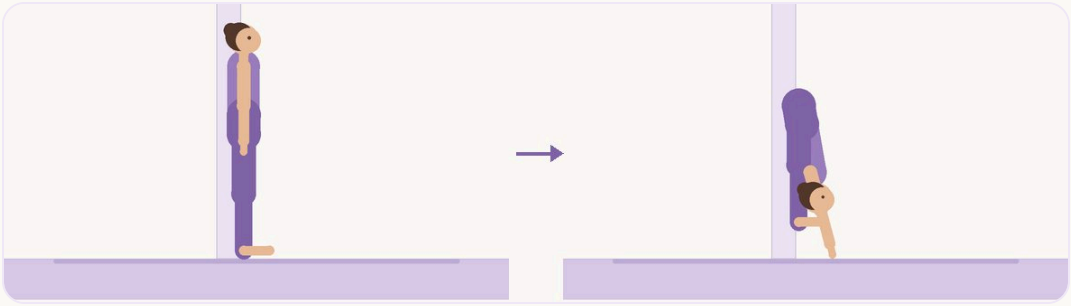
Wall

8 exercises

Wall Roll Down

back to the wall

Advanced | Wall | V3-067



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand with your back against the wall.
2. Tuck the chin and roll down.
3. Pause and breathe.
4. Roll back up, stacking the spine against the wall.

Focus
Teaches segmental spinal articulation with the wall guiding the sequence.

Target muscles
Abdominals, spinal flexors, hamstrings

Dosage
6–8 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Exhale to roll down, inhale at the bottom.

Common faults
Rolling too fast, locking the knees, letting the head drop.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep knees bent. Harder: Roll down with arms overhead.

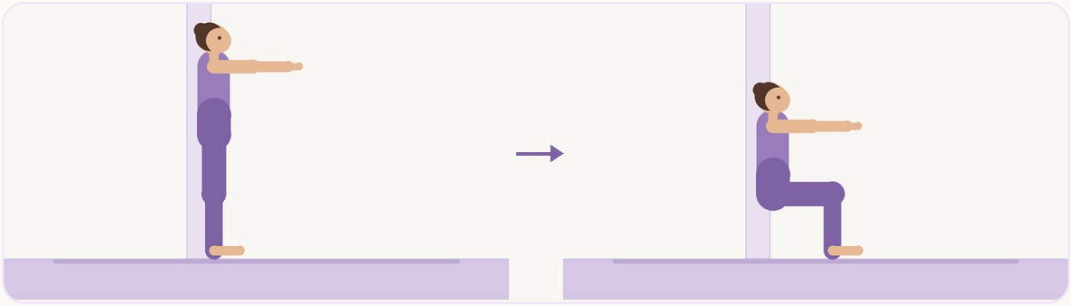
Cue
“Peel away from the wall one vertebra at a time.”

Adaptation
Pregnancy: widen the stance. Lumbar: bend the knees.

Wall Sit

single leg

Advanced | Wall | V3-068



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lean against the wall.
2. Slide down to a 90-degree angle.
3. Extend one leg.
4. Hold and switch.

Focus
Builds quadriceps and gluteal endurance while the wall supports the spine.

Target muscles
Quadriceps, gluteals, hamstrings, deep core

Dosage
3 holds of 20 sec · about 2 min

Breathing
Breathe steadily; exhale on effort.

Common faults
Knees past the toes, lifting the heels, pinching the low back.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Both feet down. Harder: Extend one leg.

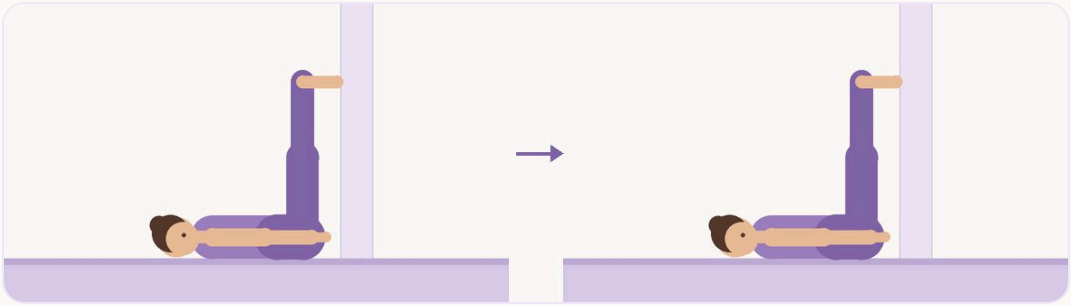
Cue
“Press into the wall and hold strong.”

Adaptation
Knee: reduce the depth. Pregnancy: use a stability pad.

Wall Bridge

feet on the wall

Advanced | Wall | V3-069



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie with feet on the wall.
2. Press through the heels.
3. Lift into a bridge.
4. Lower slowly.

Focus
Strengthens the glutes and hamstrings with the feet elevated.

Target muscles
Gluteals, hamstrings, deep core

Dosage
8–10 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare, exhale to lift.

Common faults
Pushing into the toes, overarching, lifting the neck.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Lower the feet. Harder: Lift one leg.

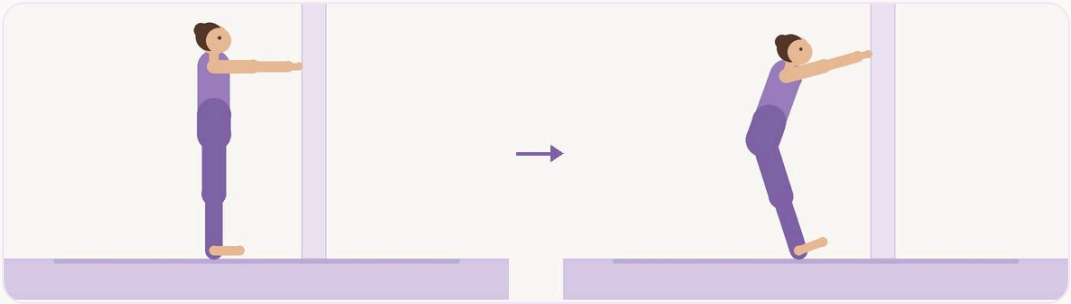
Cue
“Press through your heels and lift your hips.”

Adaptation
Pregnancy: avoid prolonged supine. Lumbar: reduce the lift.

Wall Push-Up

plank to wall

Advanced | Wall | V3-070



HOW TO DO IT

1. Place hands on the wall at shoulder height.
2. Step back into a plank.
3. Bend the elbows toward the wall.
4. Press back.

Focus
Builds upper body and core strength with the wall as support.

Target muscles
Pectorals, triceps, serratus anterior, core

Dosage
10–12 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to lower, exhale to press.

Common faults
Flaring the elbows, sagging the hips, shrugging the shoulders.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Stand closer to the wall. Harder: Move the feet further back.

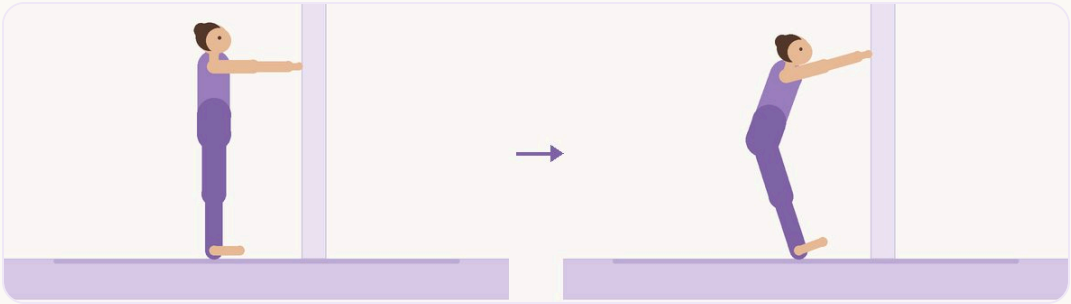
Cue
“Lower with control and press away.”

Adaptation
Shoulder: reduce the range. Pregnancy: safe with a wide stance.

Wall Side Plank

standing

Advanced | Wall | V3-071



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand sideways with forearm on the wall.
2. Step the feet away.
3. Lift the hips.
4. Hold and switch.

Focus
Develops oblique strength and shoulder stability with wall support.

Target muscles
Obliques, gluteus medius, shoulders

Dosage
3 holds of 20 sec each side · about 2 min

Breathing
Breathe steadily.

Common faults
Dropping the hip, rolling forward, shrugging.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Stand upright. Harder: Lift the top leg.

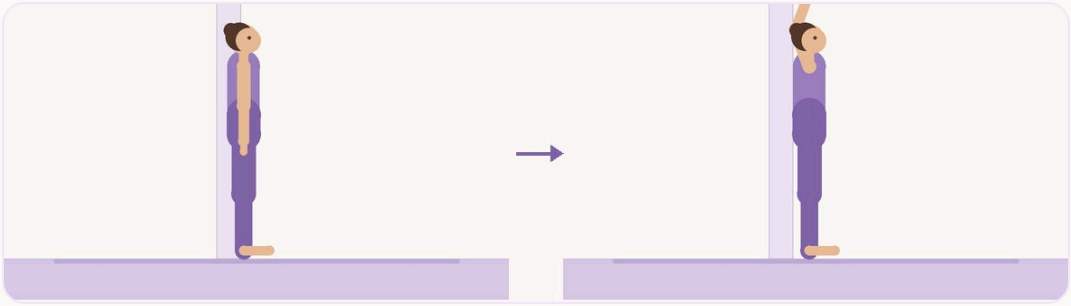
Cue
“Press into the wall and lift your waist.”

Adaptation
Shoulder: keep range small. Pregnancy: safe with support.

Wall Angel

back to the wall

Advanced | Wall | V3-072



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand with your back to the wall.
2. Place arms in a goalpost position.
3. Slide the arms up.
4. Lower back down.

Focus
Improves shoulder mobility and upper back posture.

Target muscles
Rhomboids, trapezius, rear deltoids

Dosage
10 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to raise, exhale to lower.

Common faults
Arching the lower back, lifting the shoulders, losing wall contact.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Reduce the range. Harder: Step away slightly.

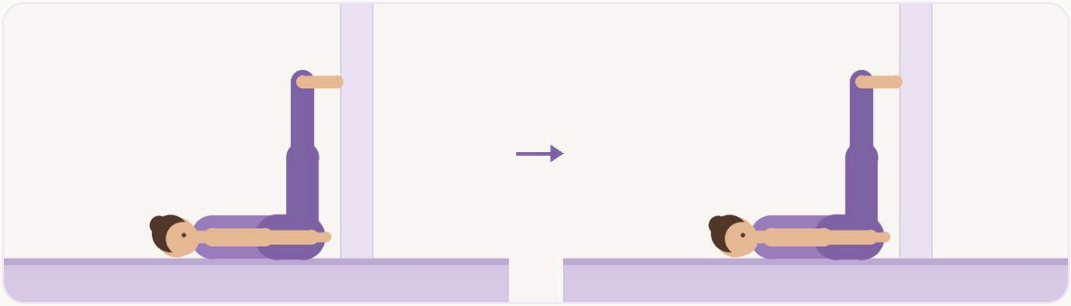
Cue
“Slide your arms and keep them on the wall.”

Adaptation
Shoulder: stay pain-free. Older adults: reduce range.

Wall Leg Slide Teaser

supine

Advanced | Wall | V3-073



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie with legs up the wall.
2. Slide one leg down.
3. Return it.
4. Switch sides.

Focus
Challenges core strength with a gentle leg slide along the wall.

Target muscles
Abdominals, hip flexors, quadriceps

Dosage
6 each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to slide, inhale to return.

Common faults
Rotating the pelvis, lifting the hips, shrugging.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep one foot down. Harder: Add a curl.

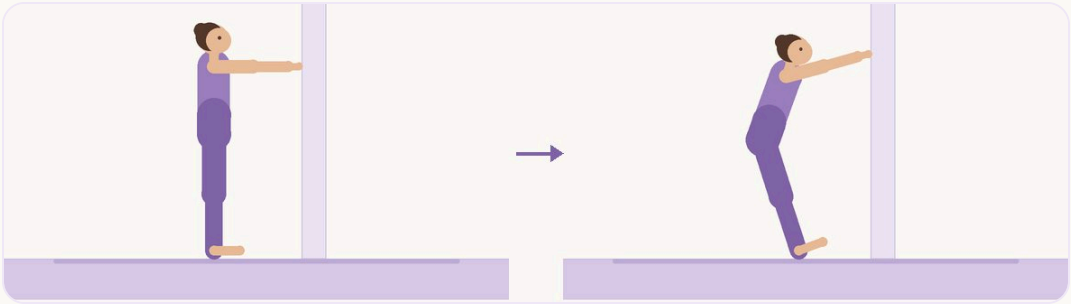
Cue
“Slide your leg and hold your pelvis.”

Adaptation
Pregnancy: avoid prolonged supine. Lumbar: reduce range.

Wall Hip Flexor Stretch

kneeling

Advanced | Wall | V3-074



HOW TO DO IT

1. Kneel with one foot against the wall.
2. Step the other foot forward.
3. Tuck the pelvis.
4. Hold and switch.

Focus
Opens the front of the hips after long sitting and standing work.

Target muscles
Hip flexors, quadriceps, psoas

Dosage
3 holds of 30 sec each side · about 2 min

Breathing
Breathe slowly into the stretch.

Common faults
Arching the low back, leaning forward, rotating the pelvis.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Use a cushion under the knee. Harder: Reach the arm overhead.

Cue
“Tuck your tailbone and breathe.”

Adaptation
Knee: pad under the knee. Pregnancy: safe with support.

VOLUME 3 · ADVANCED

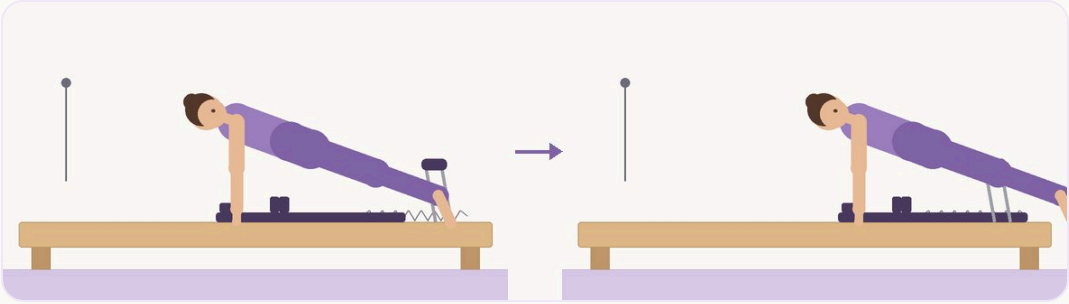
Reformer

40 exercises

Control Front

hands on the footbar

Advanced | Reformer | V3-075



HOW TO DO IT

1. Start in a plank with hands on the footbar and toes on the carriage shoulder rests.
2. Lengthen into a straight line from head to heels.
3. Press the carriage out by extending the hips and shoulders slightly forward.
4. Use your abdominals to draw the carriage back without moving the spine.

Focus
Builds shoulder stability and deep abdominal control while the carriage travels in a long plank. Teaches strong trunk support under moving load.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, transversus abdominis, serratus anterior, triceps, hip flexors

Springs
1 light spring

Dosage
6–8 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Exhale as the carriage moves out; inhale to return.

Common faults
Sagging lower back, shrugged shoulders, hips piking up, bending the elbows or letting the carriage rush.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Hold the plank without moving the carriage. Harder: Add a single-leg lift or slow the tempo to 4 counts.

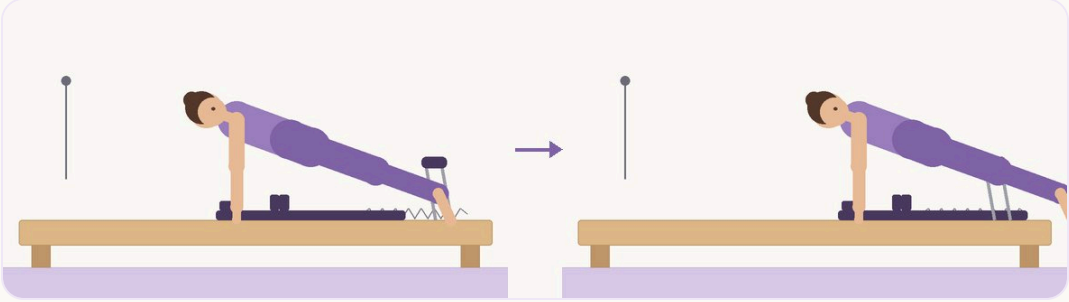
Cue
“Press the floor away and keep your ribs knitted to your hips.”

Adaptation
Lumbar: keep the range small and stop if the low back sags. Shoulder: skip if wrists or shoulders hurt. Not suitable in pregnancy.

Control Back

hands behind, facing the footbar

Advanced | Reformer | V3-076



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit facing the footbar with hands behind you on the carriage edge, legs reaching toward the footbar.
2. Lift the hips into a long reverse plank.
3. Press the carriage a few inches away using the triceps.
4. Control the carriage back without dropping the pelvis.

Focus
Challenges triceps and shoulder control in a reverse plank while the abdominals keep the pelvis lifted and the spine long.

Target muscles
Triceps, posterior deltoids, glutes, hamstrings, deep abdominals

Springs
1 light spring

Dosage
6–8 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare; exhale as the carriage moves.

Common faults
Dropping the hips, rounding the shoulders forward, locking elbows, and moving the carriage with momentum.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Bend the knees in a tabletop bridge. Harder: Lift one leg while the carriage moves.

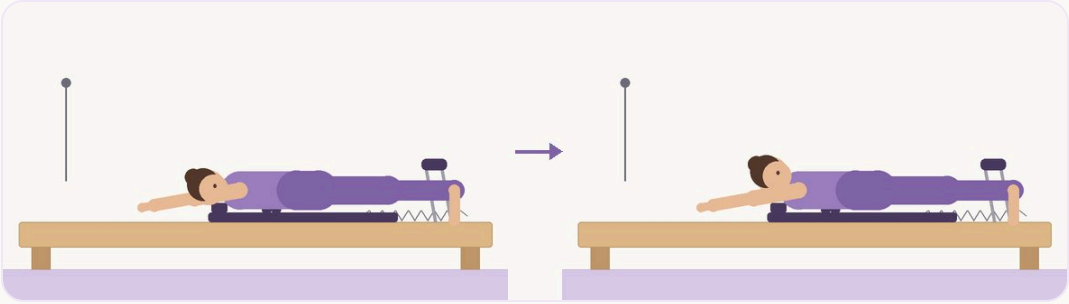
Cue
“Lift your chest and lengthen long through your heels.”

Adaptation
Shoulder: limit range or skip with anterior shoulder pain. Wrist: use padding. Avoid supine holds in later pregnancy.

Backbend

over the footbar

Advanced | Reformer | V3-077



HOW TO DO IT

1. Kneel on the carriage facing the shoulder rests with hands holding the bar.
2. Pulling your abdominals in, lengthen up through the spine.
3. Slowly arch back from the upper spine, keeping hips over knees.
4. Reverse by drawing the ribs down and lifting the chest.

Focus
Safely works extension through the upper back with abdominal support, teaching spinal articulation under load.

Target muscles
Spinal extensors, glutes, hip flexors, obliques, shoulder stabilizers

Springs
2 springs

Dosage
4–6 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to arch back; exhale to lift the chest and return.

Common faults
Overarching the low back, jutting ribs forward, forcing neck extension, or dropping weight onto the hands.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Reduce the arch and keep hands near the bar. Harder: Reach arms overhead at the top.

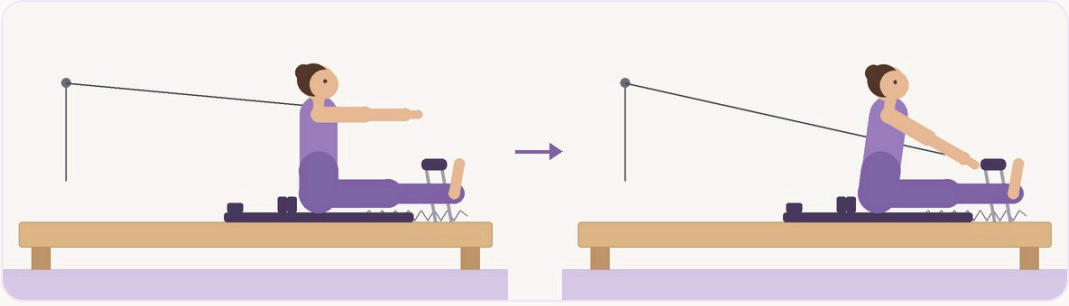
Cue
“Lift your chest and arch up and over, keeping your hips long.”

Adaptation
Lumbar: restrict range to the upper back. Shoulder: skip if overhead reaching hurts. Avoid in pregnancy; consult the client's provider.

Rowing – Into the Sternum

sitting tall with straps

Advanced | Reformer | V3-078



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall on the carriage with feet on the footbar and straps in hand.
2. Lengthen the spine and bring hands to the sternum with elbows wide.
3. Reach arms forward, then open them to the sides.
4. Return, rolling the shoulders back down.

Focus
Trains upper back strength and spinal extension with a strong, tall seated posture. Builds posture endurance.

Target muscles
Rhomboids, middle trapezius, posterior deltoids, spinal extensors

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
6–8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to open; exhale to pull and reach.

Common faults
Slumping the chest, shrugging, leaning backward, or letting the straps pull the shoulders forward.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep a smaller arm range. Harder: Add a back-arch at the end of the pull.

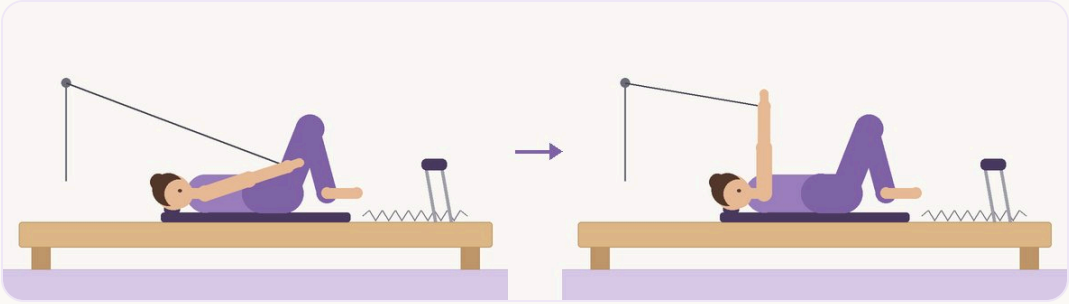
Cue
“Pull your elbows wide and lift your chest to the sky.”

Adaptation
Lumbar: keep the torso upright and avoid heavy extension. Shoulder: reduce range. Safe for most older clients when seated.

Rowing – Shaving

with long arms forward

Advanced | Reformer | V3-079



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall with legs long on the carriage and straps in hand at the chest.
2. Hinge forward from the hips with a flat back.
3. Sweep hands around the head into a full arm reach.
4. Re-stack the spine as you return upright.

Focus
Teaches a flat back hinge and pulling pattern, strengthening the posterior chain and reinforcing scapular control.

Target muscles
Lats, rhomboids, spinal extensors, deep abdominals

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
6–8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale as you hinge forward; exhale as you sweep and return.

Common faults
Collapsing the chest, lifting the shoulders, jutting the chin, or pulling with the neck.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Hinge only slightly. Harder: Hold the forward position for 2 counts.

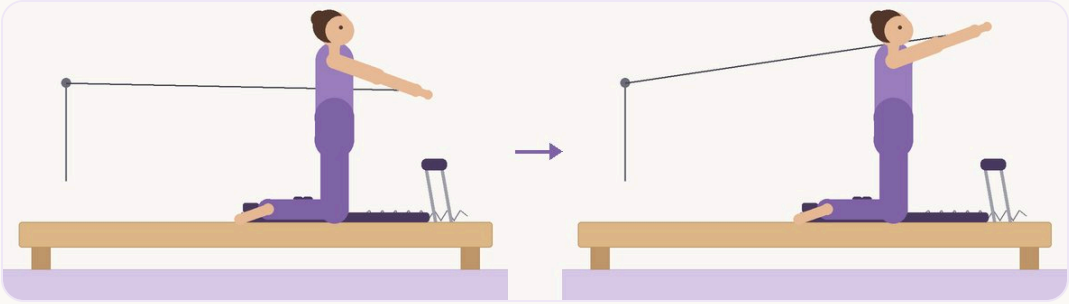
Cue
“Slide your hands past your ears and lift tall from the pelvis.”

Adaptation
Lumbar: keep the hinge small. Knee: place a cushion under the sit bones if needed. Hamstring tightness may limit the hinge.

Rowing – Hug a Tree

arms in a circle

Advanced | Reformer | V3-080



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall with hands holding straps open in a T-shape.
2. Curve the arms in a circle until the hands meet.
3. Open again, pulling the shoulder blades toward each other.
4. Keep your torso steady throughout.

Focus
Develops chest and shoulder control with a long spine, closing the arms like a wide hug while keeping the scapula stable.

Target muscles
Pectorals, anterior deltoids, serratus anterior, spinal extensors

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
6–8 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to open; exhale to hug.

Common faults
Shrugged shoulders, sinking into the low back, locking elbows, or letting the ribs flare.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Use a smaller arc. Harder: Add a small backward lean from the hips.

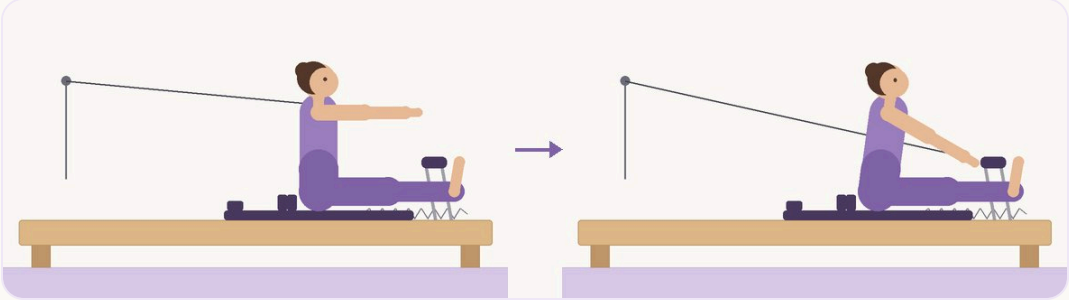
Cue
“Hug a big tree and keep your shoulders soft away from your ears.”

Adaptation
Shoulder: limit range if the shoulder pinches. Lumbar: keep the torso upright. Good for older adults when done seated.

Rowing – From the Hip

with a lean back

Advanced | Reformer | V3-081



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall with straps held at the hips.
2. Lean back as one long unit from the hips.
3. Reach arms forward and hold briefly.
4. Roll back up and return the hands to the hips.

Focus
Builds strength in the back and glutes while the trunk leans back under control, then returns using the abdominals.

Target muscles
Spinal extensors, rectus abdominis, glutes, triceps

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
5–6 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to lean back; exhale to curl up and return.

Common faults
Dropping the chest, hyperextending the neck, moving the pelvis, or losing the straight line of the spine.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Lean back a few inches. Harder: Add a hold at the bottom for 2 counts.

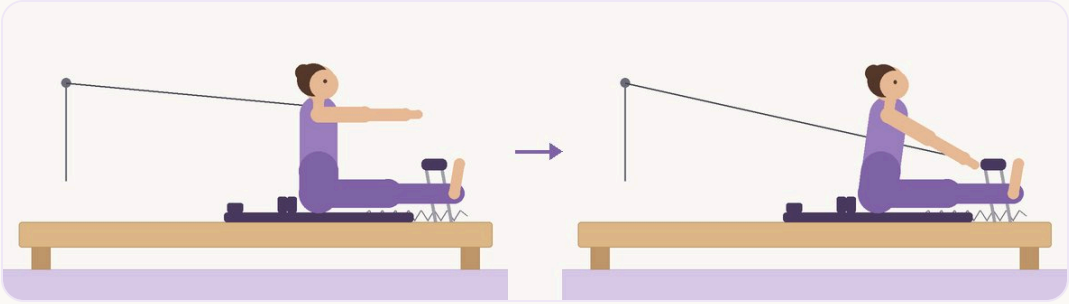
Cue
“Lean back as one long unit and rise up using your center.”

Adaptation
Lumbar: keep the lean small and avoid in acute back pain. Check abdominal separation in pregnancy.

Teaser

on the reformer

Advanced | Reformer | V3-082



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie back with feet in straps or hands on the headrest, legs lifted.
2. Curl the head and chest up into a V position.
3. Reach arms alongside the legs and hold briefly.
4. Roll back down one vertebra at a time.

Focus
Classic advanced balance and abdominal challenge: a V-sit with the feet in loops or on the bar, building core strength and coordination.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, hip flexors, obliques, quadriceps

Springs
1 light spring

Dosage
5–8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale as you roll up to the V; inhale as you lower.

Common faults
Using momentum, collapsing the spine, jerking the head forward, or letting the legs drop.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep knees bent. Harder: Add arm circles or hold the V for a full breath cycle.

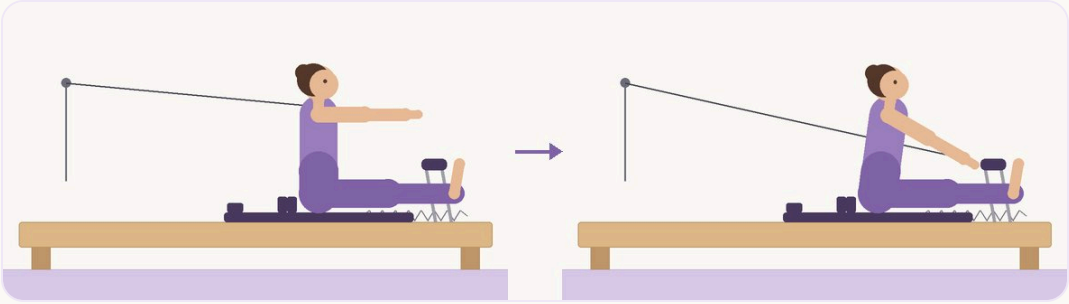
Cue
“Float into a V and keep your chest broad and proud.”

Adaptation
Lumbar: use a bent-knee version and avoid excessive flexion. Avoid in pregnancy beyond the first trimester.

Snake

on the reformer

Advanced | Reformer | V3-083



HOW TO DO IT

1. Start in a side plank with one hand on the footbar and feet on the carriage.
2. Lift the hips and reach the top arm overhead.
3. Pike the hips back toward the bar as the carriage moves.
4. Rotate and return to the long side plank.

Focus
A dynamic combination of flexion, extension and hip control, moving the body like a snake along the carriage.

Target muscles
Obliques, rectus abdominis, shoulder stabilizers, glutes

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
4–6 reps each side · about 4 min

Breathing
Exhale to move into the twist; inhale to return.

Common faults
Letting the shoulder collapse, forcing the twist, jamming the hips, or moving the carriage uncontrolled.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Reduce the range of the swing. Harder: Add a longer hold in the plank.

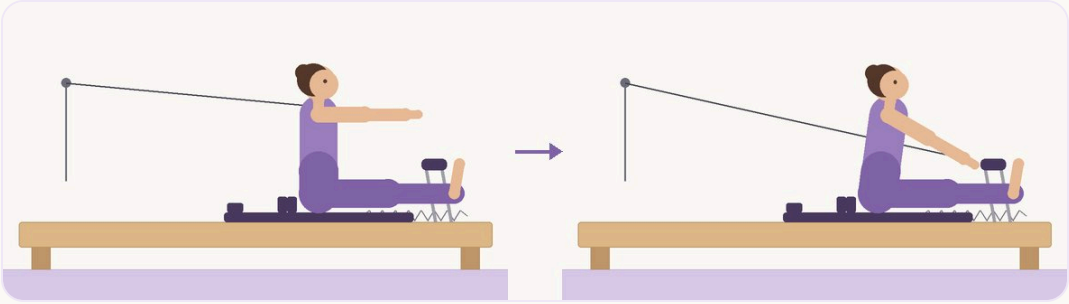
Cue
“Slither your hips back and reach long through your top arm.”

Adaptation
Shoulder: skip if weight bearing hurts. Wrist: use padding. Not for pregnancy or acute back pain.

Twist

with a long spine

Advanced | Reformer | V3-084



HOW TO DO IT

1. Begin in a plank with hands on the footbar and feet on the shoulder rests.
2. Rotate to a side plank, stacking the feet.
3. Reach the top arm up and look gently at the hand.
4. Return to the plank without letting the hips drop.

Focus
Challenging spinal rotation and side-plank strength, developing oblique power with shoulder stability.

Target muscles
Obliques, serratus anterior, shoulder stabilizers, glutes

Springs
1 light spring

Dosage
4–5 reps each side · about 4 min

Breathing
Exhale to twist; inhale to unwind.

Common faults
Collapsing into the shoulder, letting the hips sag, rushing the transition, or twisting from the neck.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep the bottom knee down. Harder: Add a leg lift or slow down.

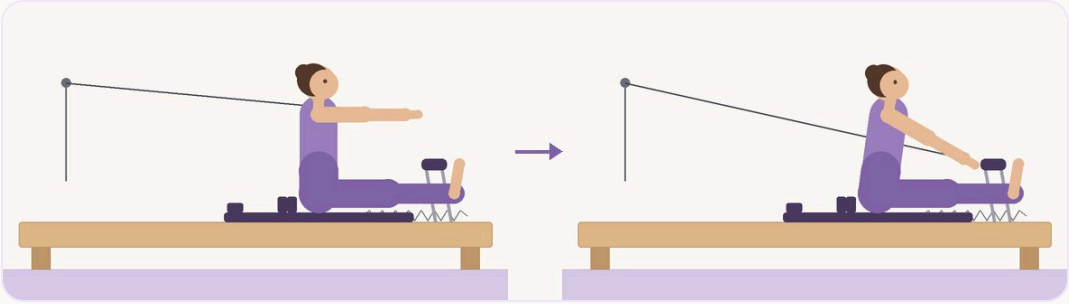
Cue
“Rotate as one long line and keep your lower ribs knit in.”

Adaptation
Shoulder: skip if the supporting shoulder feels unstable. Lumbar: keep the range small. Not for pregnancy.

Long Spine Massage

rolling back

Advanced | Reformer | V3-085



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back with feet in the straps and legs straight.
2. Press the carriage out to open the legs.
3. Roll up through the spine to a shoulder stand.
4. Roll down slowly as the springs control the return.

Focus
A rolling inversion that lengthens the spine and strengthens the abdominals and hamstrings; uses springs for smooth control.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, hamstrings, glutes, spinal extensors

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
5–6 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale as you roll up; inhale to roll down.

Common faults
Rolling onto the neck, rushing, overpushing with the arms, or bending the knees mid-roll.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Reduce the roll height. Harder: Add a pause at the top.

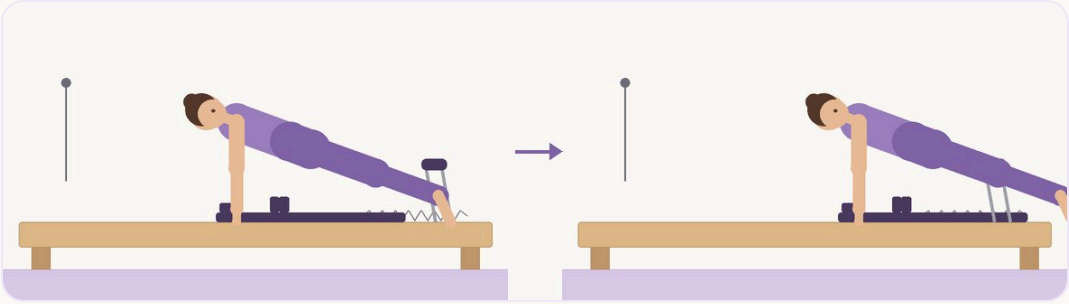
Cue
“Roll up one bone at a time and keep your neck soft.”

Adaptation
Neck: avoid if there is cervical pain or limited mobility. Avoid inversion in pregnancy and with high blood pressure.

Balance Control

on the footbar

Advanced | Reformer | V3-086



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand on the carriage with one foot and the other leg lifted.
2. Place one hand lightly on the support for balance.
3. Press the carriage a few inches away from the footbar.
4. Return slowly while maintaining the lift.

Focus
Trains single-leg balance and abdominal strength while the carriage glides under a balancing body.

Target muscles
Deep abdominals, hip flexors, glutes, quadriceps, ankle stabilizers

Springs
1 light spring

Dosage
3–5 reps each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to find length; exhale to press and balance.

Common faults
Locking the knees, hunching the shoulders, losing the pelvis position, or gripping with the toes.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Use hands for support on a rail. Harder: Add arm reaches overhead.

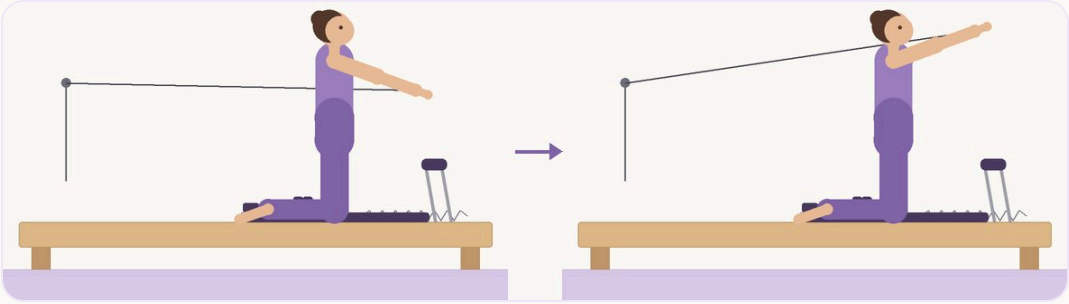
Cue
“Grow tall from the crown and glide with calm legs.”

Adaptation
Knee: use a smaller range and keep the stance leg slightly soft. Older adults: use a stable support.

Kneeling Cat Stretch

rounding the spine

Advanced | Reformer | V3-087



HOW TO DO IT

1. Kneel with hands on the footbar and knees on the carriage.
2. Curl the tailbone under and round the spine.
3. Press the carriage back as the shoulders stay over the hands.
4. Return and reach long through the spine.

Focus
Mobilizes the spine into flexion while the abdominals deepen, then reaches back for a long stretch through the lats.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, latissimus dorsi, glutes, spinal flexors

Springs
1 light spring

Dosage
6–8 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Exhale to round; inhale to lengthen.

Common faults
Collapsing the shoulders, tucking the pelvis too far, moving only the arms, or rushing.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep the hands on the bar. Harder: Add a longer hold at the end range.

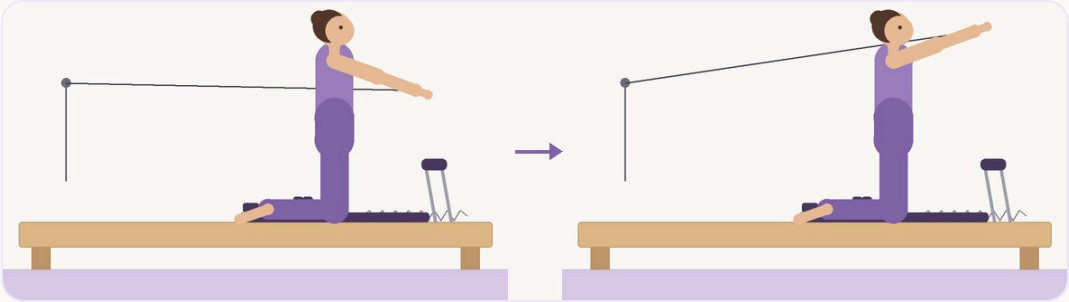
Cue
“Round your back like a cat and let the carriage glide.”

Adaptation
Wrist: use padding. Pregnancy: avoid heavy abdominal compression. Knee: use extra cushioning.

Kneeling Arm Circles

with straps

Advanced | Reformer | V3-088



HOW TO DO IT

1. Kneel upright on the carriage facing the straps.
2. Hold the straps with arms reaching forward.
3. Circle the arms up and around with control.
4. Reverse the circles while keeping your center steady.

Focus
Builds shoulder stability and trunk control, circling the arms while the torso stays tall and balanced on the knees.

Target muscles
Deltoids, serratus anterior, abdominals, glutes

Springs
1 light spring

Dosage
6 circles each direction · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale as you lift; exhale as you circle down.

Common faults
Shrugging the shoulders, arching the low back, tilting the ribs forward, or letting the knees slide.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Reduce the circle size. Harder: Add small pulses at the top.

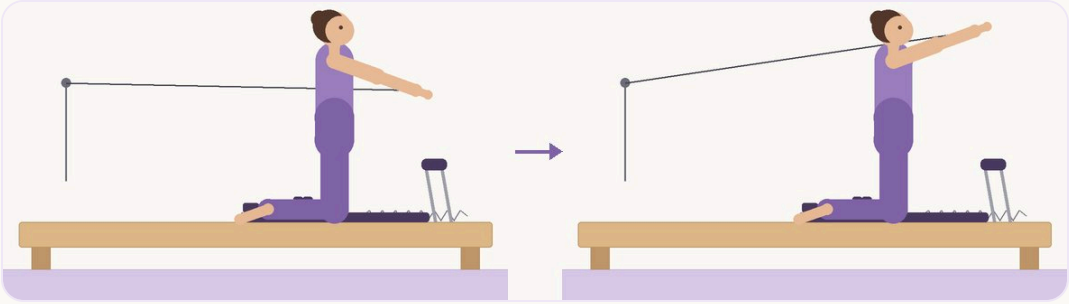
Cue
“Draw big circles while your trunk stays calm and tall.”

Adaptation
Shoulder: skip overhead range if painful. Lumbar: tuck the tailbone gently. Knee: use extra padding.

Kneeling Lat Pull-Down

with straps

Advanced | Reformer | V3-089



HOW TO DO IT

1. Kneel facing the straps with arms extended overhead.
2. Draw the straps down by the sides of the body.
3. Stop at the hips and pause briefly.
4. Return slowly with control.

Focus
A strong upper-body exercise that pulls the arms down while the core resists the swing of the body.

Target muscles
Latissimus dorsi, triceps, rear deltoids, obliques

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
8 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to reach up; exhale to press down.

Common faults
Leaning back, shrugging the shoulders, flaring the ribs, or yanking the straps.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Use a lighter spring. Harder: Add a small lean forward at the end of the pull.

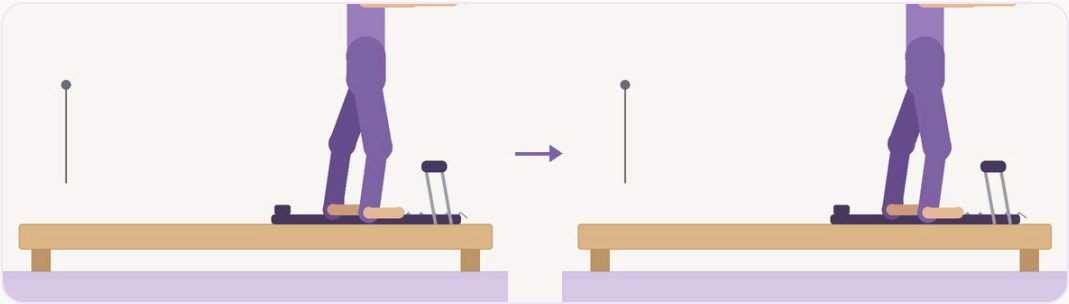
Cue
“Pull your elbows down to your ribs and keep your chest broad.”

Adaptation
Shoulder: limit the overhead range. Knee: extra padding. Good for most clients if shoulders are healthy.

Side Splits

standing on platform and carriage

Advanced | Reformer | V3-090



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand with one foot on the platform and one on the carriage.
2. Place hands on hips or a support.
3. Press the carriage slowly to the side.
4. Draw the legs back together using the inner thighs.

Focus
A balance and flexibility challenge: legs glide apart while the abdominals and inner thighs work together to control the carriage.

Target muscles
Adductors, hip abductors, abdominals, glutes

Springs
1 light spring

Dosage
5–8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare; exhale to open the legs.

Common faults
Gripping the hips, leaning forward, locking the knees, or pushing the carriage too fast.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Use a smaller range and hold a support. Harder: Add arm reaches overhead.

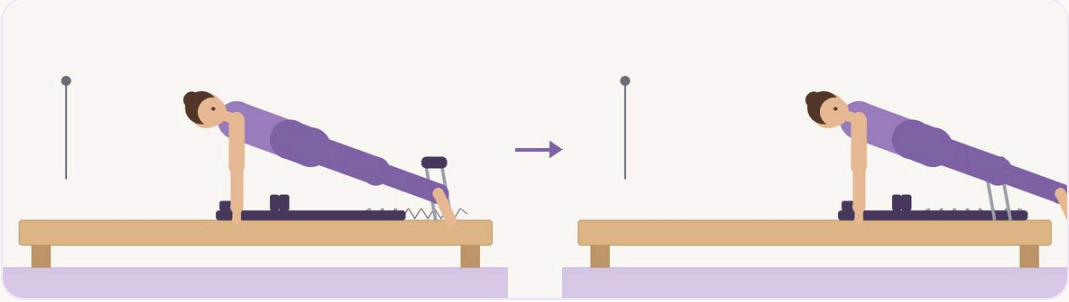
Cue
“Slide your legs apart and keep your center lifted.”

Adaptation
Hip: reduce the range. Knee: avoid locking. Pregnancy: only with stable balance and a support. Older adults: hold the frame.

Elephant

with straight legs

Advanced | Reformer | V3-091



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand on the carriage with hands on the footbar, hips high.
2. Round your spine into a pike.
3. Press the carriage back with straight legs.
4. Return it slowly while keeping the abdominals drawn in.

Focus
Strengthens the shoulders and hamstrings while stretching the calves, using a pike position to teach hip hinge.

Target muscles
Hamstrings, glutes, shoulders, abdominals, calves

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
8–10 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale as you press the carriage back; inhale to return.

Common faults
Rounding the lower back, locking the knees, shrugging the shoulders, or pulling with the arms.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Bend the knees slightly. Harder: Lift one leg at the end of the push.

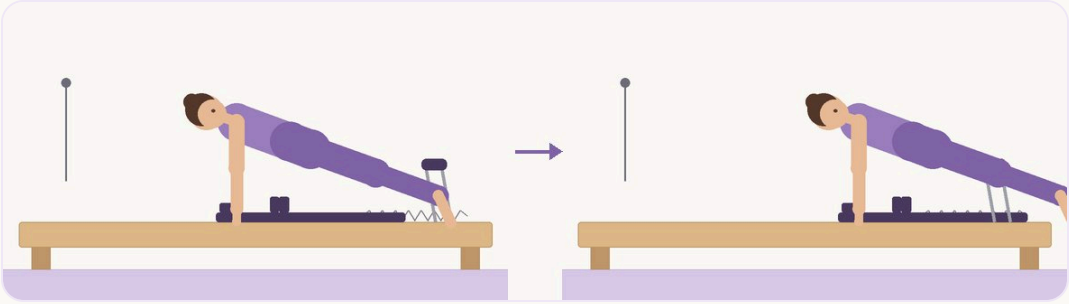
Cue
“Press the floor away and pull your belly up.”

Adaptation
Wrist: use padding. Lumbar: allow soft knees. Shoulder: avoid heavy loading if painful. Avoid deep pike in pregnancy.

Long Stretch

in a high plank

Advanced | Reformer | V3-092



HOW TO DO IT

1. Plank with hands on the footbar and feet against the shoulder rests.
2. Press the carriage out slightly.
3. Keep a straight line from head to heels.
4. Return using the abdominals.

Focus
Develops shoulder, core and leg strength in a long plank that moves the carriage out and in.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, shoulders, hamstrings, triceps, glutes

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
6–8 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale as you move out; exhale as you return.

Common faults
Sagging hips, lifting shoulders, bending the elbows, or hurrying the carriage.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Lower the knees to the carriage. Harder: Lift one foot slightly off.

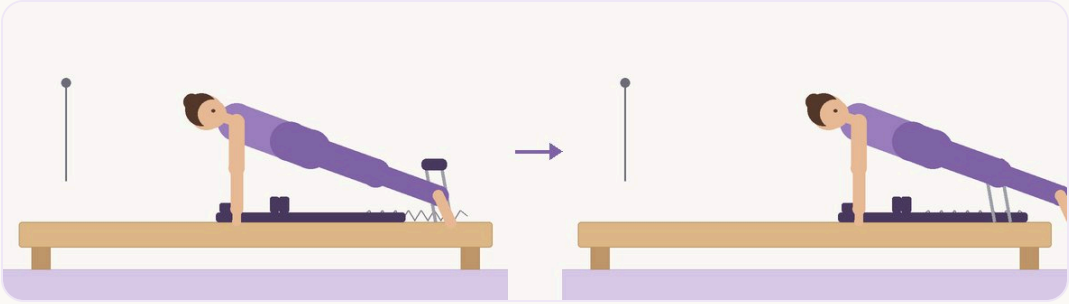
Cue
“Stay long from head to heels and press the bar away.”

Adaptation
Shoulder and wrist: avoid weight bearing if painful. Lumbar: stop if the low back sags. Avoid in pregnancy.

Up Stretch

a hip pike

Advanced | Reformer | V3-093



HOW TO DO IT

1. Start in a pike with hands on the footbar and feet on the carriage.
2. Round your spine and lift the hips.
3. Press the carriage out into a long plank.
4. Return to the pike with control.

Focus
Combines a deep hip stretch with strong abdominal lift as the body shifts from a pike to a plank.

Target muscles
Hamstrings, glutes, abdominals, shoulders

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
6–8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to round the spine; inhale to extend.

Common faults
Collapsing the chest, hanging on the shoulders, locking the knees, or sagging the hips.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Bend the knees in the pike. Harder: Lift one leg at the top.

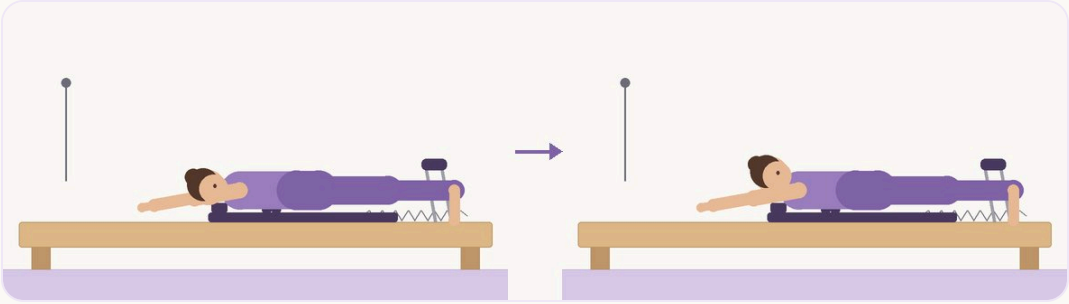
Cue
“Lift your hips up and press the floor away.”

Adaptation
Wrist and shoulder: use padding or skip. Pregnancy: avoid deep pikes. Lumbar: keep a soft knee.

Down Stretch

with a backbend

Advanced | Reformer | V3-094



HOW TO DO IT

1. Kneel on the carriage facing the footbar with hands on the bar.
2. Lift the chest and lengthen the spine.
3. Press the carriage back with an arch through the upper back.
4. Return while keeping the abdominals strong.

Focus
A spine extension exercise that arches the back and lengthens the front of the body with abdominal support.

Target muscles
Spinal extensors, glutes, hip flexors, shoulders

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
5–6 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to arch; exhale to return.

Common faults
Dumping into the low back, tilting the head back too far, locking the elbows, or rushing the carriage.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep a smaller arch. Harder: Add a longer hold.

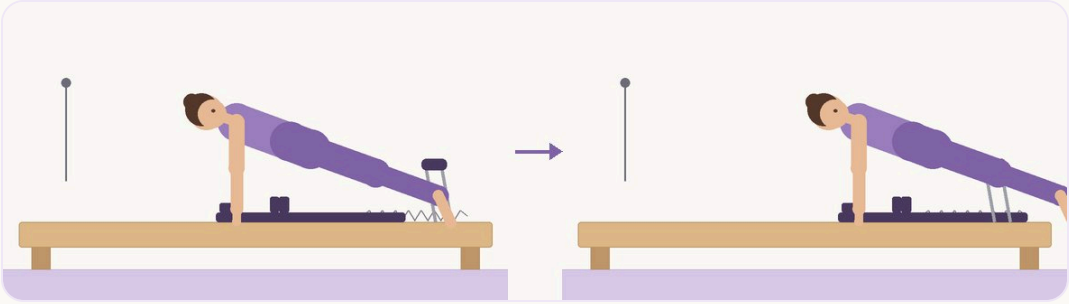
Cue
“Lift your chest and arch up without crunching the low back.”

Adaptation
Lumbar: keep the arch small. Shoulder: skip if painful. Pregnancy: avoid deep extension and check with the provider.

Semi-Circle

on the shoulder rests

Advanced | Reformer | V3-095



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie with feet on the footbar and arms by the sides.
2. Roll up through the spine into a bridge.
3. Press the carriage out and in with the legs.
4. Roll down slowly, one bone at a time.

Focus
A flowing spinal and hip-extension sequence that connects the back, glutes and hamstrings in a smooth arc.

Target muscles
Hamstrings, glutes, spinal extensors, abdominals

Springs
2 springs

Dosage
5–6 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to lift the hips; exhale to roll down.

Common faults
Lifting the ribs, pressing into the neck, rushing, or overextending the low back.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep the feet on the footbar. Harder: Slow the tempo to 4 counts each way.

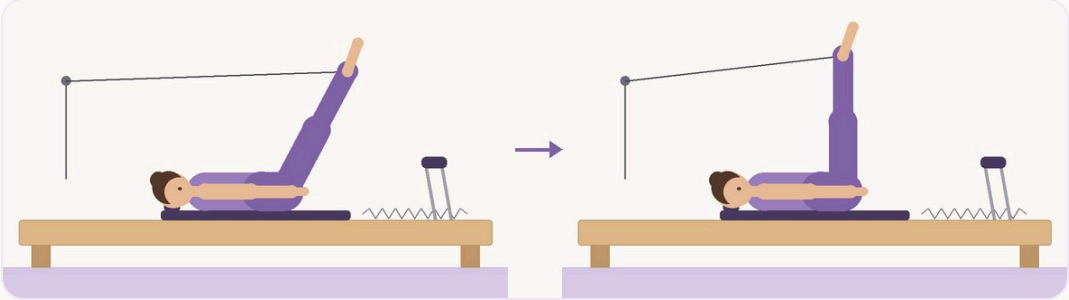
Cue
“Float your hips up and then roll through each bone.”

Adaptation
Neck: keep the head lightly in place. Lumbar: limit the lift. Avoid long supine holds in later pregnancy.

Short Spine Massage

rolling the legs

Advanced | Reformer | V3-096



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie with legs in straps, pointing to the ceiling.
2. Press the legs out and open.
3. Roll the hips over the shoulders.
4. Roll down and bend the knees to return.

Focus
A rolling exercise that stretches the spine and hamstrings, strengthening the abdominals as the legs press and bend.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, hamstrings, glutes, spinal flexors

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
5–6 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale as you roll up; inhale to extend.

Common faults
Rolling onto the neck, rushing, locking the knees, or relying on momentum.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep the knees bent. Harder: Add a longer hold at the top.

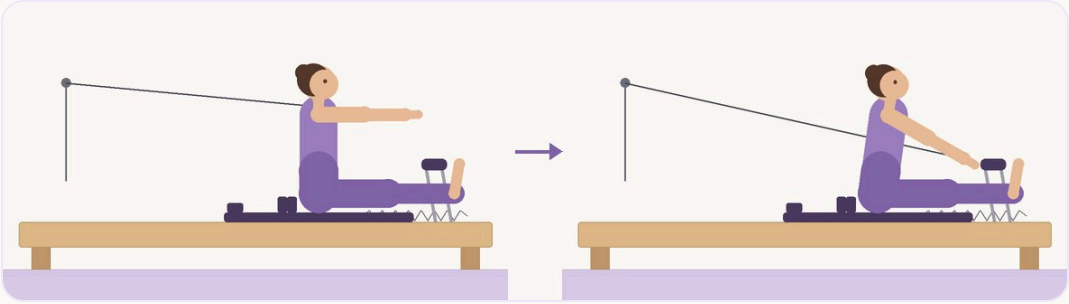
Cue
“Roll up with your spine and let your legs follow.”

Adaptation
Neck: avoid inversions with neck issues. Avoid in pregnancy beyond the first trimester or with high blood pressure.

Short Box – Round Back

seated on the box

Advanced | Reformer | V3-097



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit on the box with feet under the strap and hands behind the head.
2. Roll into a C-curve.
3. Return to upright, stacking the spine.
4. Maintain a neutral pelvis.

Focus
Trains abdominal control and spinal articulation as the torso rounds forward over the hips, keeping the legs anchored.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, obliques, hip flexors, spinal flexors

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
6–8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to curl; inhale to lengthen.

Common faults
Dropping the head, collapsing the chest, gripping with the hands, or pulling on the strap.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Hold a smaller range. Harder: Add a lift of the arms overhead.

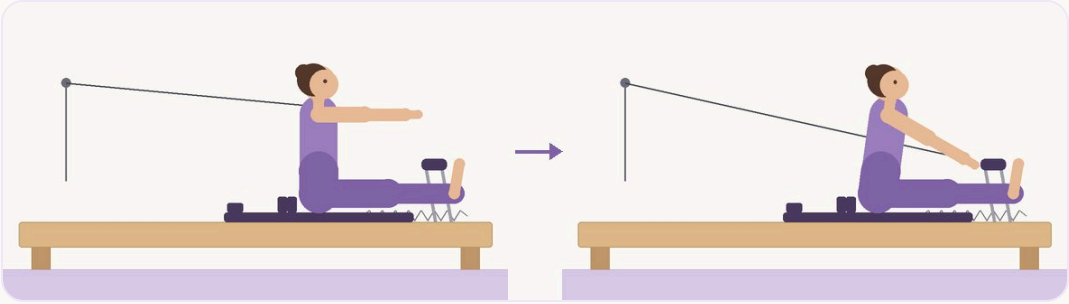
Cue
“Peel into a C-curve and breathe into your back.”

Adaptation
Lumbar: reduce range and keep a neutral spine. Knee: pad under the knee if tender. Avoid in pregnancy.

Short Box – Tree

with leg extension

Advanced | Reformer | V3-098



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall on the box with feet under the strap.
2. Place hands on the box or behind the head.
3. Lift one leg straight and hold.
4. Lower with control and switch sides.

Focus
Mobilizes the hamstrings and spine while seated tall, with one leg lifted into a straight line for balance.

Target muscles
Hamstrings, hip flexors, abdominals, spinal extensors

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
4–6 reps each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to lift the leg; exhale to lower.

Common faults
Rounding the back, locking the knee, slumping, or lifting the shoulders.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep the knee bent. Harder: Flex and point the foot.

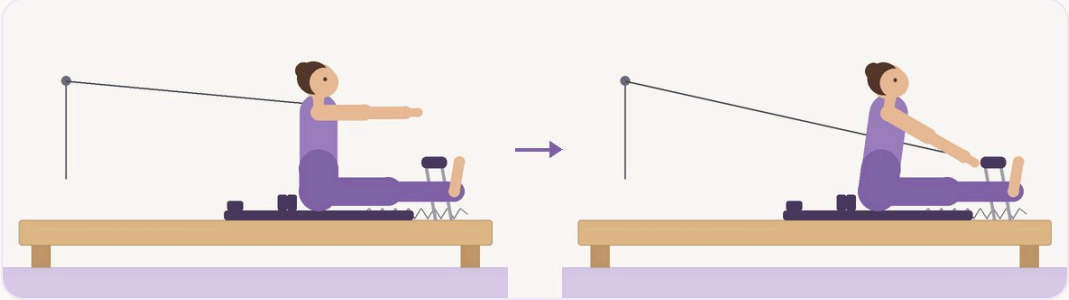
Cue
“Grow tall and reach the leg long like a tree.”

Adaptation
Hamstring: keep the knee soft. Lumbar: stay upright. Hip: limit the lift if there is pain.

Short Box – Twist

seated with rotation

Advanced | Reformer | V3-099



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall on the box with feet under the strap and hands behind the head.
2. Rotate the torso to one side.
3. Return to center and repeat on the other side.
4. Keep the pelvis still.

Focus
Builds oblique strength and rotational control with a tall spine on the box.

Target muscles
Obliques, spinal rotators, abdominals, hip stabilizers

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
5–6 reps each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to rotate; inhale to return.

Common faults
Sliding the hips, lifting the shoulders, twisting from the neck, or leaning back.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Reduce the rotation. Harder: Add a lean back and a small arm reach.

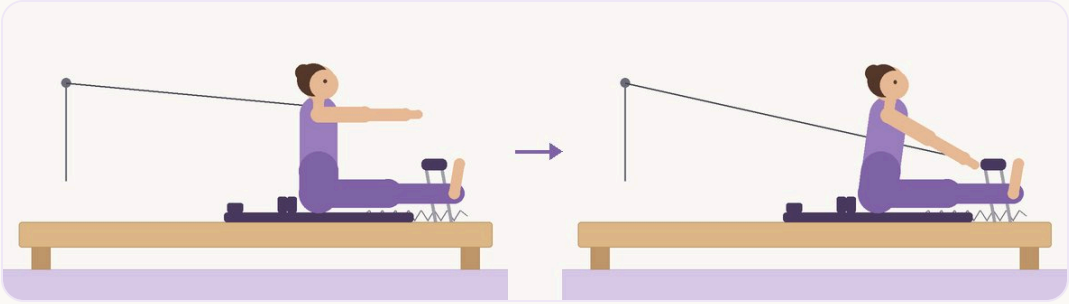
Cue
“Rotate from your ribs and keep your hips square.”

Adaptation
Lumbar: keep the twist gentle. Pregnancy: use an open twist, not a closed one. Older adults: stay light.

Tendon Stretch

with a lifted back

Advanced | Reformer | V3-100



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand on the carriage with hands on the footbar.
2. Lift the hips high.
3. Press the carriage back slightly.
4. Return and roll up through the spine.

Focus
An advanced hamstring and shoulder stretch performed with the hips lifted and the spine long.

Target muscles
Hamstrings, glutes, shoulders, abdominals, calves

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
6–8 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Exhale as you lift the hips; inhale to lengthen.

Common faults
Collapsing the chest, locking the knees, shrugging the shoulders, or losing balance.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Bend the knees. Harder: Lift one leg slightly off the carriage.

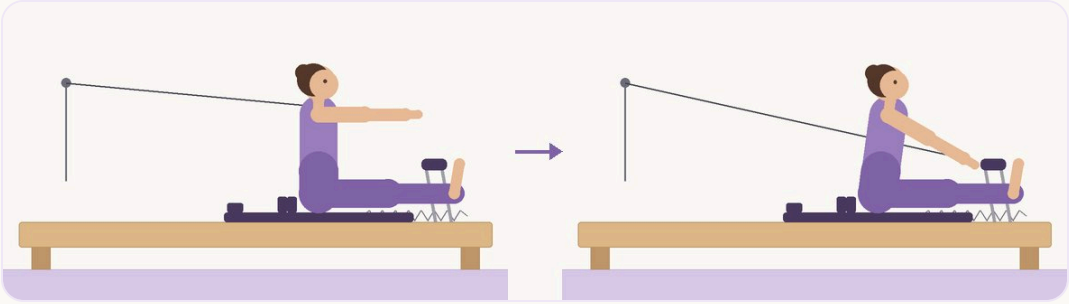
Cue
“Reach your hips high and keep your chest open.”

Adaptation
Wrist: use padding. Lumbar: soft knees. Shoulder: skip if pinching. Avoid deep forward folds in pregnancy.

Mermaid

side stretch

Advanced | Reformer | V3-101



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit sideways on the carriage with one hand on the bar.
2. Reach the top arm overhead.
3. Side-bend over the base arm.
4. Return to center and switch.

Focus
Lengthens the spine and side body while challenging the obliques in an open, side-bending shape.

Target muscles
Obliques, quadratus lumborum, lats, shoulders

Springs
1 light spring

Dosage
4–5 reps each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to reach long; exhale to bend.

Common faults
Collapsing the ribs, rolling forward, shrugging, or sitting back on the hip.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep a smaller side bend. Harder: Add a rotation at the end.

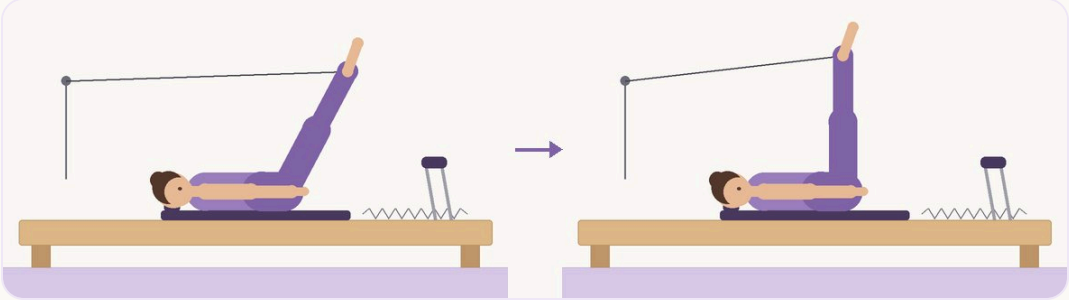
Cue
“Reach up and over like a rainbow.”

Adaptation
Lumbar: avoid deep side bends. Shoulder: skip overhead reach if painful. Pregnancy: use a wide, comfortable seat.

Corkscrew

in the straps

Advanced | Reformer | V3-102



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie with legs in straps, extended to the ceiling.
2. Lower the legs to one side in a circle.
3. Return the legs to center.
4. Reverse the circle.

Focus
A leg-circle exercise that challenges the abdominals to stabilize the pelvis while the legs draw a spiral.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, obliques, hip flexors, glutes

Springs
1 light spring

Dosage
4–6 reps each direction · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale as the legs lower; inhale as they rise.

Common faults
Letting the pelvis tip, lifting the shoulders, rushing, or swinging the legs.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Bend the knees. Harder: Increase the circle size.

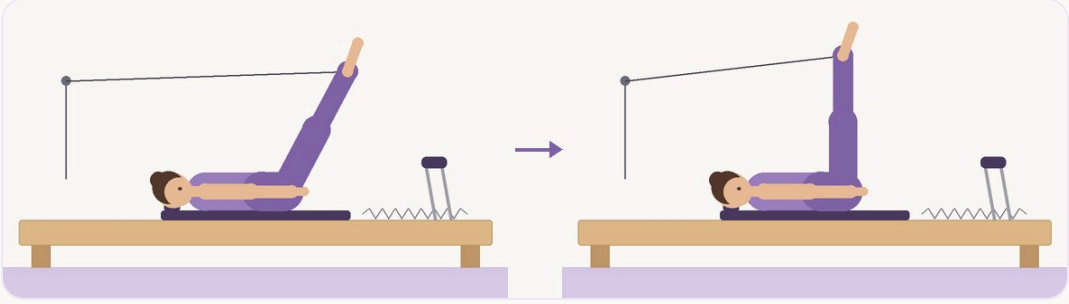
Cue
“Draw a spiral and keep your pelvis quiet.”

Adaptation
Lumbar: use a bent-knee version. Neck: keep the head down. Avoid in pregnancy beyond the first trimester.

Jackknife

with straps

Advanced | Reformer | V3-103



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie back with legs in straps pointing to the ceiling.
2. Lift the hips off the carriage.
3. Reach the legs straight over your head to vertical.
4. Roll down with control.

Focus
An inversion that lifts the hips high, building abdominal and back strength.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, hip flexors, glutes, spinal extensors

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
4–6 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to lift; inhale to lower.

Common faults
Using momentum, hyperextending the neck, bending the knees, or dropping the legs.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Roll up with bent knees. Harder: Hold the vertical position for 2 counts.

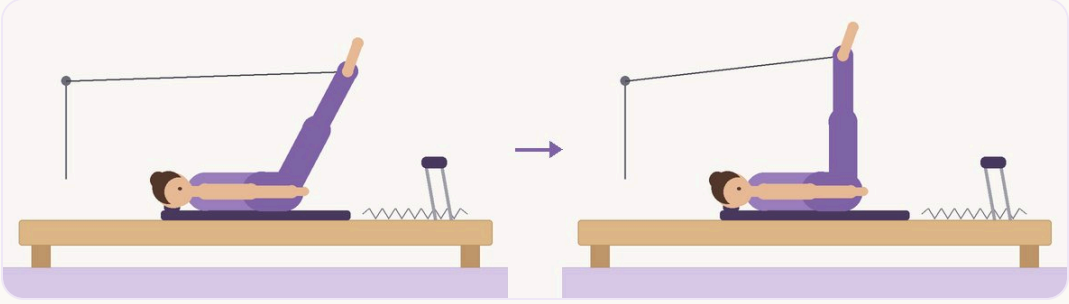
Cue
“Lift your hips and reach long through your toes.”

Adaptation
Neck: avoid with cervical issues. Avoid in pregnancy and with high blood pressure. Lumbar: reduce the range.

Overhead

with legs in the air

Advanced | Reformer | V3-104



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie with legs in straps.
2. Lift the hips and roll over the shoulders.
3. Pause and reach the legs overhead.
4. Roll down slowly.

Focus
A deep abdominal exercise where the legs move overhead and back, controlled by the springs.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, hip flexors, hamstrings, spinal flexors

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
5–6 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale as you roll up; inhale as you lower.

Common faults
Rolling onto the neck, bending the knees, jerking, or letting the carriage drive the movement.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Reduce the range. Harder: Slow the lower to 4 counts.

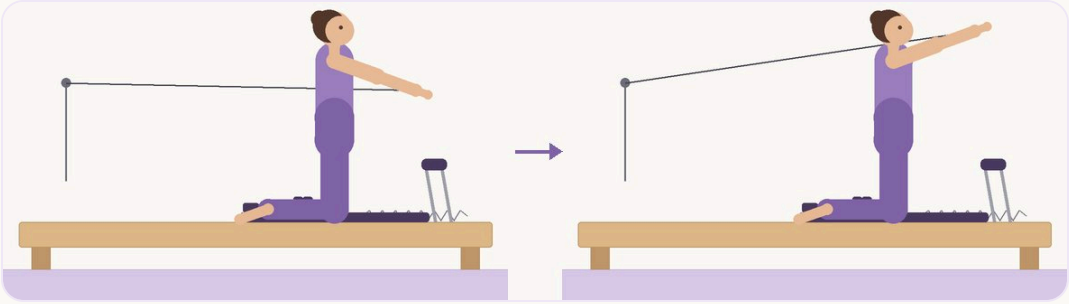
Cue
“Roll over slowly and keep your neck relaxed.”

Adaptation
Neck: avoid in cervical pain. Avoid in pregnancy and with high blood pressure. Lumbar: limit the range.

Knee Stretch – Off Knees

hover and round

Advanced | Reformer | V3-105



HOW TO DO IT

1. Kneel with hands on the footbar, knees hovering above the carriage.
2. Round your spine into a C-curve.
3. Press the carriage out with the legs.
4. Pull in with the abdominals.

Focus
A fast, dynamic abdominal exercise where the knees hover above the carriage, building heat and endurance.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, hip flexors, quadriceps, shoulders

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
10–12 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Exhale as you push the legs out; inhale as you pull in.

Common faults
Letting the hips rise, rounding the shoulders, losing the C-curve, or pushing from the hips.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep the knees on the carriage. Harder: Increase tempo or add a hover hold.

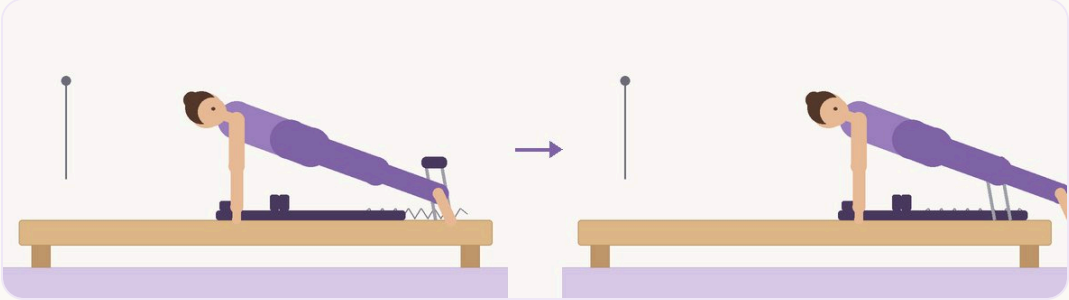
Cue
“Hover your knees and pull in from your belly.”

Adaptation
Wrist: use padding. Knee: keep a pad. Lumbar: reduce the speed. Avoid in pregnancy.

Bottoms Up

in the straps

Advanced | Reformer | V3-106



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie with feet in straps and knees bent.
2. Press the feet out and lift the hips.
3. Hold briefly at the top.
4. Lower with control.

Focus
A glute and hamstring exercise that extends the hips while the abdominals brace.

Target muscles
Glutes, hamstrings, abdominals, spinal extensors

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
8–10 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Exhale as you lift; inhale to lower.

Common faults
Overarching the low back, rolling the pelvis, locking the knees, or lifting the ribs.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Use a smaller range. Harder: Add a hold at the top.

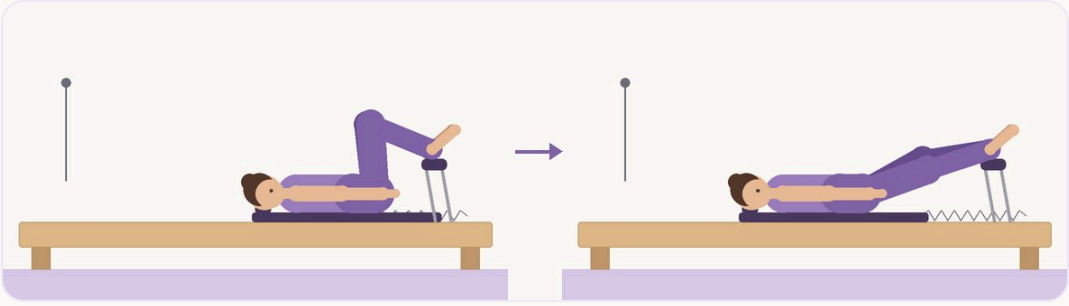
Cue
“Lift your hips and squeeze your glutes.”

Adaptation
Lumbar: keep the range small and neutral. Avoid supine holds in later pregnancy.

Footwork – Single-Leg Running

one leg at a time

Advanced | Reformer | V3-107



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back with one foot on the footbar.
2. Press the carriage out.
3. Alternate the heel lowering and lifting.
4. Keep the pelvis still.

Focus
A challenging footwork variation that trains calf control and single-leg stability.

Target muscles
Calves, quadriceps, hamstrings, glutes, ankle stabilizers

Springs
2–3 springs

Dosage
20 reps each leg · about 3 min

Breathing
Breathe steadily and evenly.

Common faults
Locking the knees, rolling the ankles, shifting the pelvis, or bouncing the carriage.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Use both legs. Harder: Increase speed with control.

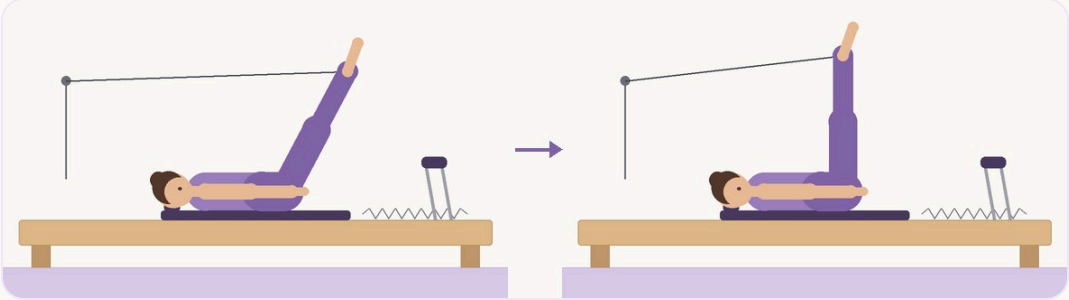
Cue
“Run lightly and keep your hips quiet.”

Adaptation
Knee: avoid locking the joint. Pregnancy: use a wedge for comfort. Ankle: reduce range.

Leg Circles in Straps

small and large

Advanced | Reformer | V3-108



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie with legs in straps, extended to the ceiling.
2. Open the legs out and down.
3. Circle around to meet at the top.
4. Reverse the direction.

Focus
Mobilizes the hip joint and strengthens the abdominals, circling the legs while the pelvis stays still.

Target muscles
Hip flexors, adductors, abdominals, glutes

Springs
1 light spring

Dosage
6 circles each direction · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale on the lift; exhale on the lower.

Common faults
Rocking the pelvis, bending the knees, overreaching, or tilting the ribs.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Reduce the circle size. Harder: Cross the circles at the top.

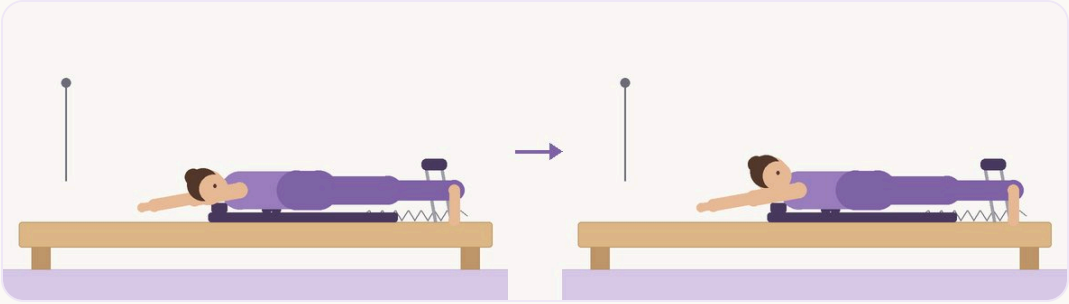
Cue
“Draw smooth circles and keep your pelvis still.”

Adaptation
Hip: keep the circle small. Lumbar: bend the knees if needed. Pregnancy: use a wedge.

Long Box – Swan

with the back arched

Advanced | Reformer | V3-109



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie face down on the box with hands on the bar.
2. Lengthen the spine.
3. Lift the chest and arms slightly.
4. Lower with control.

Focus
Trains back extension and shoulder strength lying face down, lifting the chest while the legs stay long.

Target muscles
Spinal extensors, glutes, rear deltoids, hamstrings

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
5–6 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to lift; exhale to lower.

Common faults
Overarching the low back, shrugging, gripping the neck, or letting the legs fall apart.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep a smaller lift. Harder: Hold the lift for 3 counts.

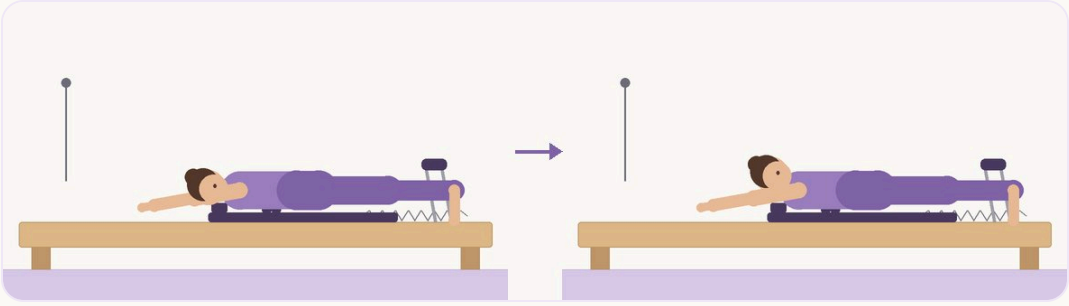
Cue
“Lift your chest and lengthen through your crown.”

Adaptation
Lumbar: avoid deep extension. Shoulder: lower the range. Avoid prone positions in pregnancy.

Long Box – Pulling Straps

arms back

Advanced | Reformer | V3-110



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie face down on the box holding the straps.
2. Lift the chest slightly.
3. Pull the arms back toward the hips.
4. Return the arms to the front.

Focus
Strengthens the back and shoulders while lying prone, with the arms pulling backward in a straight line.

Target muscles
Rhomboids, rear deltoids, spinal extensors, glutes

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
6–8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to lift; exhale to pull.

Common faults
Shrugging the shoulders, hyperextending the neck, lifting too high, or letting the legs lift.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Pull with a smaller range. Harder: Add a hold at the top.

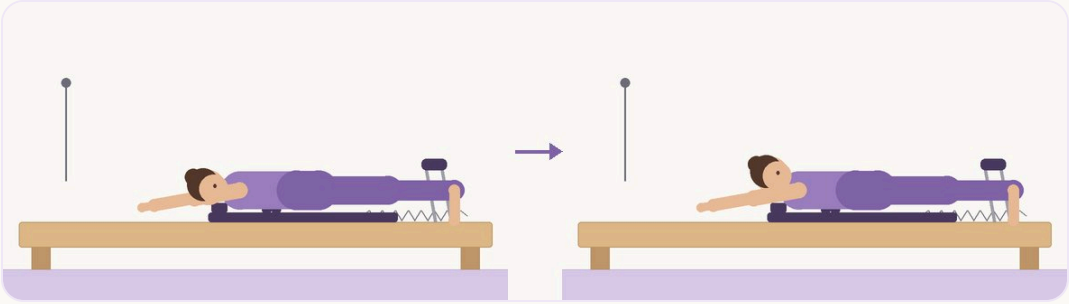
Cue
“Pull your hands to your hips and lift tall.”

Adaptation
Lumbar: keep the lift small. Shoulder: reduce range. Avoid in pregnancy.

Long Box – Backstroke

lying prone

Advanced | Reformer | V3-111



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie prone on the long box with straps in hands.
2. Lift the chest and arms.
3. Circle the arms back and around.
4. Lower with control.

Focus
A combination of shoulders and trunk work, drawing the arms in a back-stroke while the spine stays long.

Target muscles
Spinal extensors, deltoids, glutes, hamstrings

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
5–6 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale as the arms lift; exhale as they circle.

Common faults
Dropping the legs, arching the neck, shrugging, or using momentum.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep a smaller circle. Harder: Hold the lift at the top.

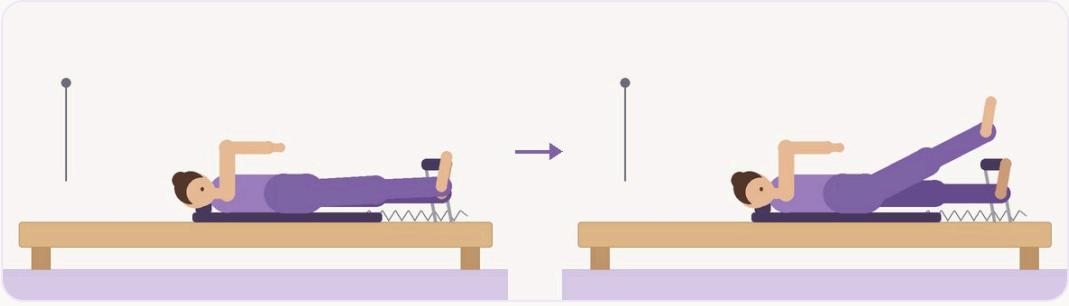
Cue
“Circle your arms long and keep your belly lifted.”

Adaptation
Lumbar: keep a small range. Shoulder: reduce the circle. Avoid prone positions in pregnancy.

Side Over

on the box

Advanced | Reformer | V3-112



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie sideways on the box with feet under the strap.
2. Hands behind the head.
3. Lower the torso to the side.
4. Lift back up using the obliques.

Focus
A lateral flexion exercise that strengthens the obliques and lengthens the side body while lying on the side.

Target muscles
Obliques, quadratus lumborum, hip abductors, shoulders

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
5–6 reps each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to reach; exhale to lift.

Common faults
Rolling the torso forward, lifting the shoulder, bending the knees, or dropping the hips.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep the bottom knee bent. Harder: Add a leg lift.

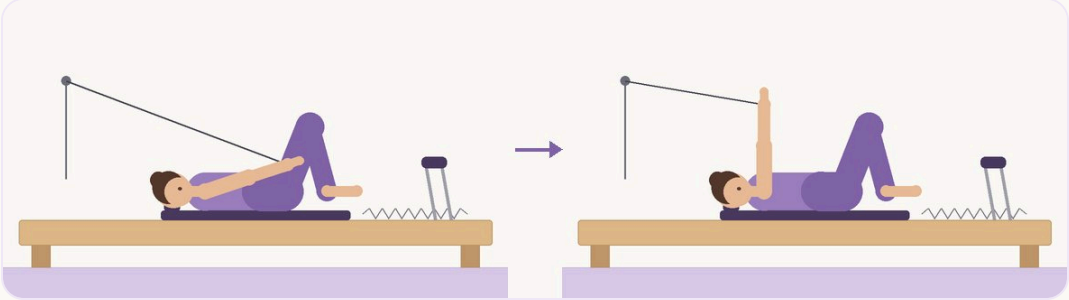
Cue
“Reach out long and lift from your waist.”

Adaptation
Shoulder: skip if the supporting shoulder hurts. Lumbar: keep the range small. Pregnancy: ok with a pillow.

Stomach Massage – Reaching

with the arms

Advanced | Reformer | V3-113



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit with heels on the footbar and hands behind the head.
2. Round your spine into a C.
3. Press the carriage out.
4. Return to the start.

Focus
A seated rounding exercise that adds an arm reach to deepen abdominal engagement and spinal flexion.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, hip flexors, spinal flexors, shoulders

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
6–8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale as you round; inhale as you extend.

Common faults
Collapsing the chest, shrugging, lifting the heels, or rushing the carriage.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep hands on the bar. Harder: Reach the arms overhead.

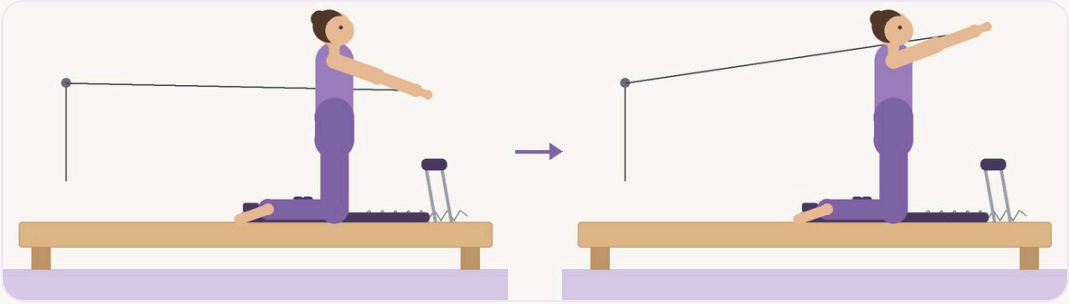
Cue
“Round back like a C and reach out long.”

Adaptation
Lumbar: reduce the range. Pregnancy: avoid deep flexion. Wrist: use padding.

Lunge – Front Split

stretching the hip flexors

Advanced | Reformer | V3-114



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand on the platform with one foot on the carriage and hands on the frame.
2. Press the carriage back into a lunge.
3. Hold briefly.
4. Draw the carriage back with the legs.

Focus
A deep lunge that stretches the hip flexors and strengthens the legs, with the carriage gliding in a split.

Target muscles
Hip flexors, quadriceps, glutes, hamstrings

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
5–6 reps each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare; exhale to glide into the lunge.

Common faults
Collapsing the front knee, tilting the pelvis, locking the legs, or rushing.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep a small range with a handhold. Harder: Reach the arms overhead.

Cue
“Glide long and keep your front knee over your ankle.”

Adaptation
Knee: keep the front knee stable. Hip: reduce the range. Balance: hold the frame. Pregnancy: use a wide stance with support.

VOLUME 3 · ADVANCED

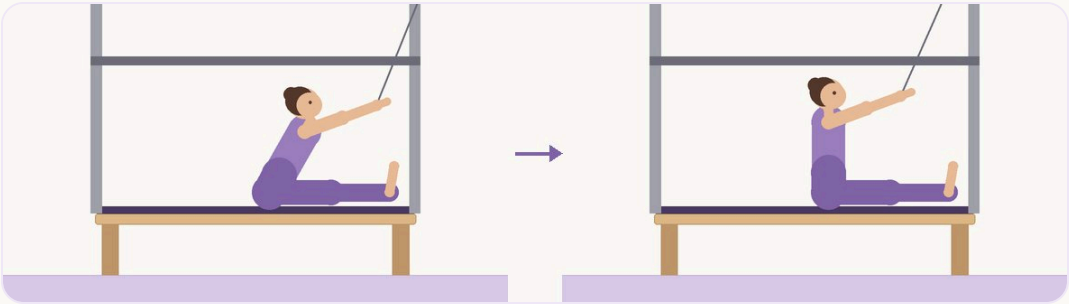
Cadillac

18 exercises

Roll-Down

with push-through bar

Advanced | Cadillac | V3-115



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit upright holding the push-through bar.
2. Roll back slowly, vertebra by vertebra.
3. Press the bar forward to engage the arms.
4. Roll up to sitting.

Focus
Builds spinal articulation and abdominal control, with the bar supporting the arms.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, hip flexors, erector spinae

Springs
1–2 springs (medium setting)

Dosage
6–8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare; exhale to roll down; inhale to roll up.

Common faults
Collapsing the chest, rolling too fast, tucking the pelvis.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep the knees bent. Harder: Roll down farther.

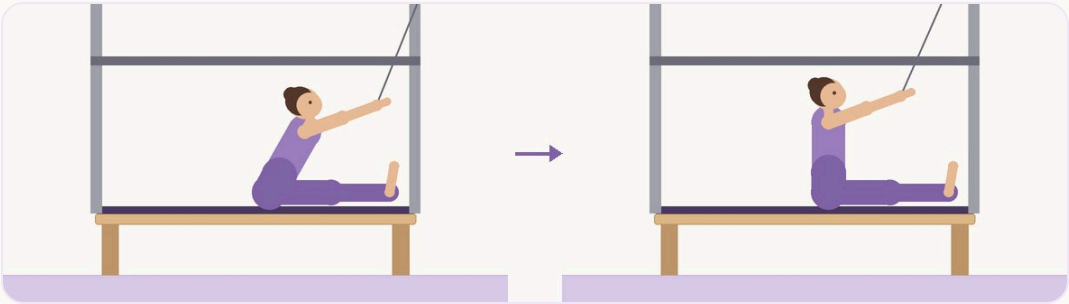
Cue
“Roll down one vertebra at a time.”

Adaptation
Avoid with disc or lower back pain, or in pregnancy. Keep the range small.

Push-Through Teaser

lifting the legs

Advanced | Cadillac | V3-116



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie supine holding the push-through bar overhead.
2. Roll up through the spine with the legs lifted.
3. Press the bar forward and balance.
4. Roll down with control.

Focus
Develops deep abdominal strength and control by combining a teaser with a bar press.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, hip flexors, triceps, shoulders

Springs
1–2 springs (medium-heavy setting)

Dosage
5–6 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to roll up and press; inhale to hold.

Common faults
Using momentum, pulling the neck, collapsing the chest.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep knees bent. Harder: Lower the legs closer to the mat.

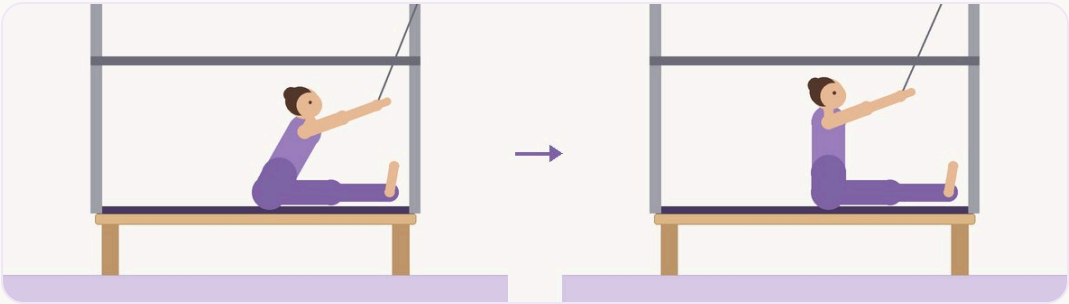
Cue
“Press the bar and balance on your sit bones.”

Adaptation
Avoid with neck or back pain, or in pregnancy. Use a bent-knee version.

Prone Push-Through

with the bar

Advanced | Cadillac | V3-117



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie prone, hands on the push-through bar.
2. Lengthen the legs.
3. Lift the chest and press the bar forward.
4. Lower slowly.

Focus
Strengthens the back and arms while lengthening the spine in extension.

Target muscles
Latissimus dorsi, triceps, erector spinae, rear deltoids

Springs
1–2 springs (light-medium setting)

Dosage
6–8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to lift and press; inhale to return.

Common faults
Shrugging, hyperextending the neck, collapsing the lower back.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep a smaller lift. Harder: Hold the lift for two breaths.

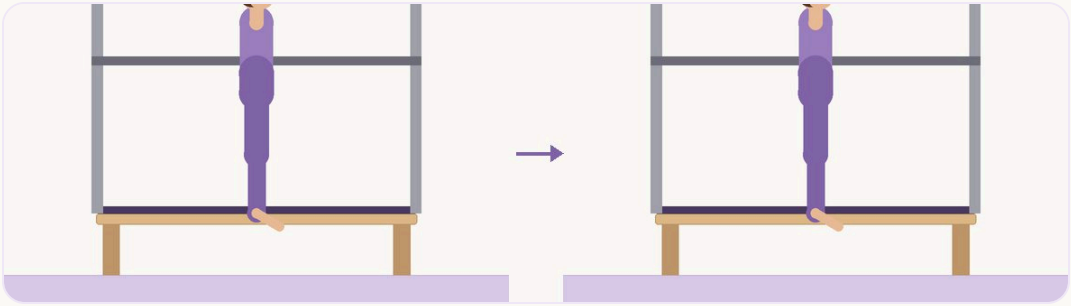
Cue
“Press long and lift through your chest.”

Adaptation
Avoid prone positioning in pregnancy; use a small range with shoulder or lower back concerns.

Tower

on the tower

Advanced | Cadillac | V3-118



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie supine, feet on the tower bar.
2. Press the legs to lift the hips.
3. Control the descent through the spine.
4. Reset and repeat.

Focus
Builds core and leg strength and coordination in an inverted shoulder-supported pattern.

Target muscles
Abdominals, hamstrings, glutes, shoulders

Springs
2 springs (medium-heavy setting)

Dosage
5–6 reps · about 4 min

Breathing
Exhale to press; inhale to return.

Common faults
Dropping the hips, tilting the neck, rushing.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep the knees bent. Harder: Add a slow lowering phase.

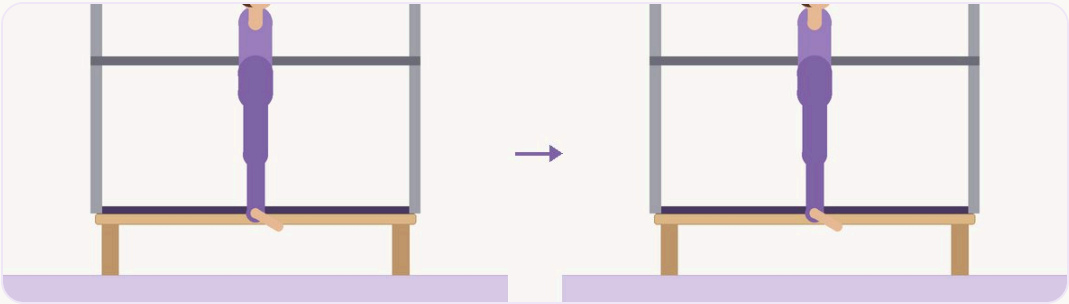
Cue
“Press down with your legs and lift your hips.”

Adaptation
Avoid inversion with neck, shoulder or blood pressure concerns, or in pregnancy. Supervise closely.

Monkey

on the tower

Advanced | Cadillac | V3-119



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie supine with the feet on the tower bar.
2. Press the legs to straighten.
3. Lift the hips up and over.
4. Lower slowly.

Focus
Stretches the hamstrings and spine while strengthening the legs with a fluid press.

Target muscles
Hamstrings, glutes, abdominals, erector spinae

Springs
1–2 springs (light-medium setting)

Dosage
6–8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to lengthen; exhale to press.

Common faults
Locking the knees, rounding the shoulders, losing control.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Reduce the leg range. Harder: Add a slower tempo.

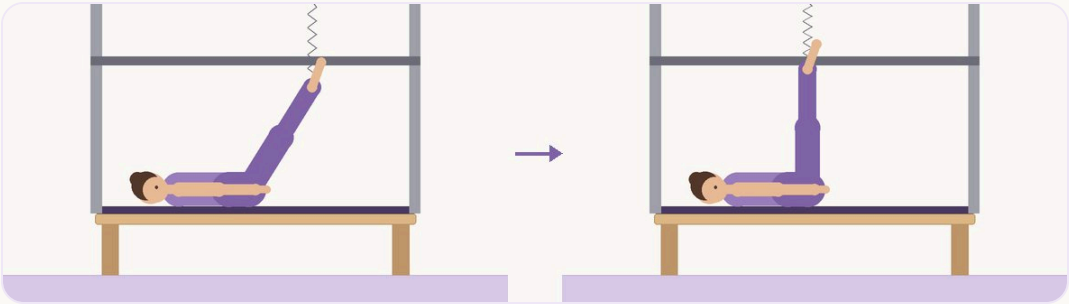
Cue
“Lengthen your legs and keep your back long.”

Adaptation
Skip with hamstring or lower back injury; avoid deep inversion in pregnancy.

Frog

leg springs

Advanced | Cadillac | V3-120



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie supine with the feet in straps.
2. Open the knees with the heels together.
3. Press the legs long on an exhale.
4. Return with control.

Focus
Works the inner thighs and hip rotators with a controlled press against the springs.

Target muscles
Adductors, glutes, hamstrings, abdominals

Springs
1–2 springs (light setting)

Dosage
8–10 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to open the knees; exhale to press the legs together.

Common faults
Gripping with the hip flexors, lifting the ribs, overarching.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Lower the range. Harder: Pause at full extension.

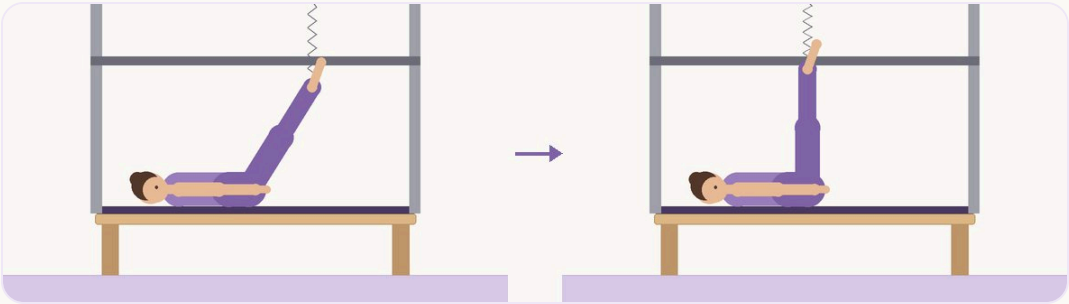
Cue
“Press your legs long and squeeze your heels.”

Adaptation
Avoid supine for long periods in later pregnancy; keep the spine neutral.

Circles

leg springs

Advanced | Cadillac | V3-121



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie supine with the legs in straps, lifted.
2. Brace the abdominals.
3. Circle both legs smoothly.
4. Reverse direction.

Focus
Improves hip mobility and stability while the pelvis stays still through smooth circles.

Target muscles
Hip flexors, adductors, abductors, abdominals

Springs
1–2 springs (light setting)

Dosage
6–8 reps each direction · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to circle open; exhale to close.

Common faults
Rocking the pelvis, flexing the foot, circling too fast.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Reduce the circle size. Harder: Lower the legs closer to the mat.

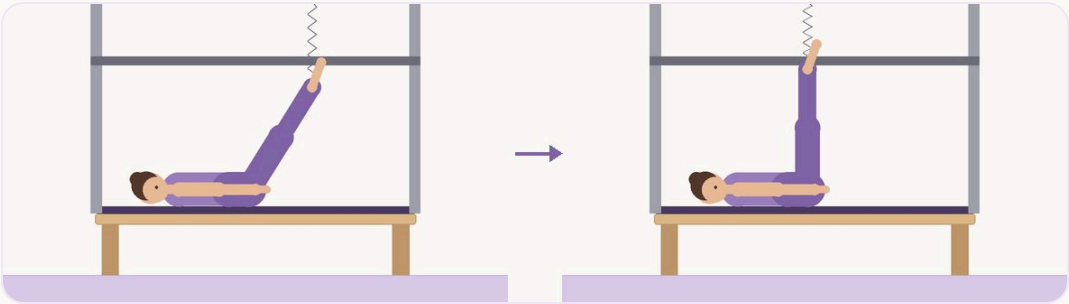
Cue
“Draw circles from the hip while your pelvis stays still.”

Adaptation
Avoid with hip pain; limit supine time in later pregnancy.

Walking

leg springs

Advanced | Cadillac | V3-122



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie supine with the legs in straps.
2. Lift both legs to the ceiling.
3. Lower one leg, then the other.
4. Maintain a stable pelvis.

Focus
Strengthens the hips and legs through a smooth alternating motion while the trunk stays stable.

Target muscles
Hip flexors, glutes, hamstrings, abdominals

Springs
1–2 springs (light setting)

Dosage
10 reps each leg · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to lift; exhale to press down.

Common faults
Rocking the pelvis, bouncing, losing length.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Reduce the range. Harder: Slow the tempo.

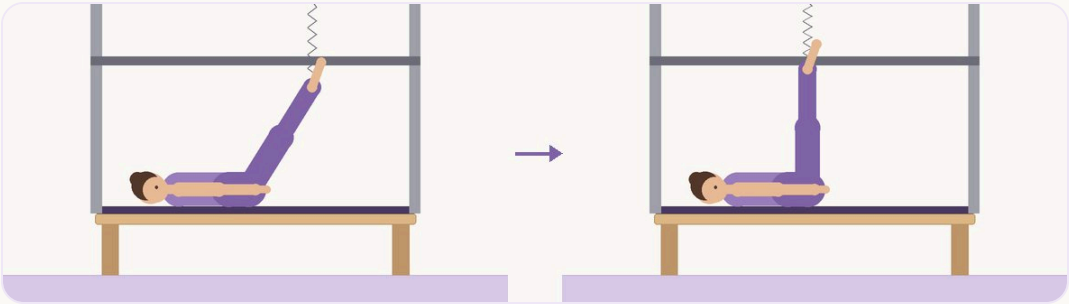
Cue
“Walk your legs slowly with a still pelvis.”

Adaptation
Avoid with lower back pain; limit supine time in later pregnancy.

Bicycle

leg springs

Advanced | Cadillac | V3-123



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie supine with the legs in straps.
2. Extend one leg long, bend the other.
3. Cycle the legs in a smooth pattern.
4. Reverse the direction.

Focus
Builds hip mobility and abdominal control with a smooth cycling pattern.

Target muscles
Hip flexors, hamstrings, quadriceps, abdominals

Springs
1–2 springs (light setting)

Dosage
6–8 reps each direction · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to cycle forward; exhale to reverse.

Common faults
Arching the lower back, rushing, losing neutral.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Reduce the range. Harder: Lengthen each pedal.

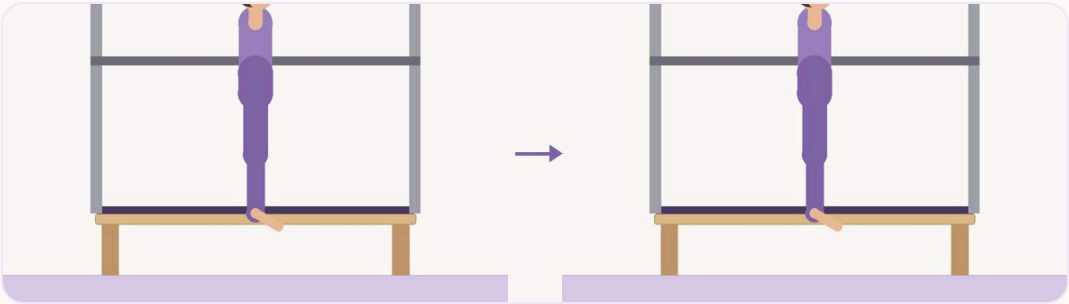
Cue
“Cycle smoothly and keep your pelvis steady.”

Adaptation
Avoid with hip or lower back pain; limit supine time in later pregnancy.

Airplane

hanging

Advanced | Cadillac | V3-124



HOW TO DO IT

1. Hang with the hands on the bar and legs hanging.
2. Lift the legs while keeping the torso long.
3. Hold briefly.
4. Lower slowly.

Focus
Builds core, hip and shoulder strength with a challenging hanging suspension.

Target muscles
Abdominals, hip flexors, deltoids, glutes

Springs
2 springs (medium-heavy setting)

Dosage
4–5 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to lift; inhale to lower.

Common faults
Dropping the hips, shrugging, rushing the lift.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep the knees bent. Harder: Hold the lift for two breaths.

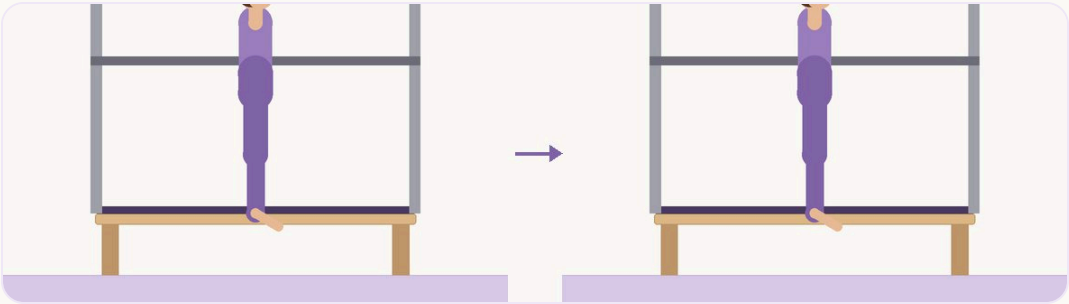
Cue
“Lift from your center and stay long.”

Adaptation
Avoid with shoulder or neck injury, or in pregnancy. Supervise closely; use spotting.

Spread Eagle

hanging

Advanced | Cadillac | V3-125



HOW TO DO IT

1. Hang from the bar with the legs lifted.
2. Open the legs wide in a controlled V.
3. Close the legs together.
4. Lower slowly.

Focus
Challenges the shoulders and trunk in an inverted hanging position, building control and strength.

Target muscles
Abdominals, hip adductors, deltoids, lats

Springs
2 springs (medium-heavy setting)

Dosage
4–5 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to lift; inhale to open; exhale to close.

Common faults
Shrugging, dropping the hips, losing control of the legs.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Reduce the range. Harder: Add a slower lowering.

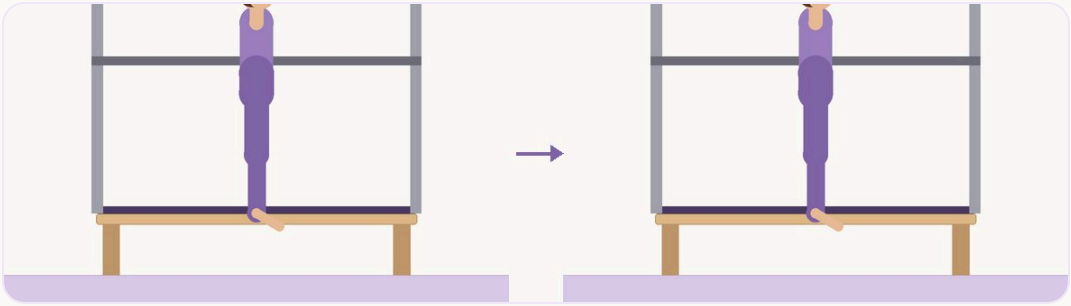
Cue
“Open wide and keep your core engaged.”

Adaptation
Avoid with shoulder, neck or blood pressure concerns, or in pregnancy. Provide a spotter.

Hanging Pull-Ups

from the bar

Advanced | Cadillac | V3-126



HOW TO DO IT

1. Grip the trapeze bar overhead.
2. Draw the shoulders down.
3. Pull the chest toward the bar.
4. Lower slowly.

Focus
Builds shoulder and arm strength with a controlled hang and pull from the trapeze bar.

Target muscles
Latissimus dorsi, biceps, lower trapezius, abdominals

Springs
1–2 springs (light setting)

Dosage
4–6 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to pull up; inhale to lower slowly.

Common faults
Shrugging, swinging, using momentum.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Use a spring assist. Harder: Lower more slowly.

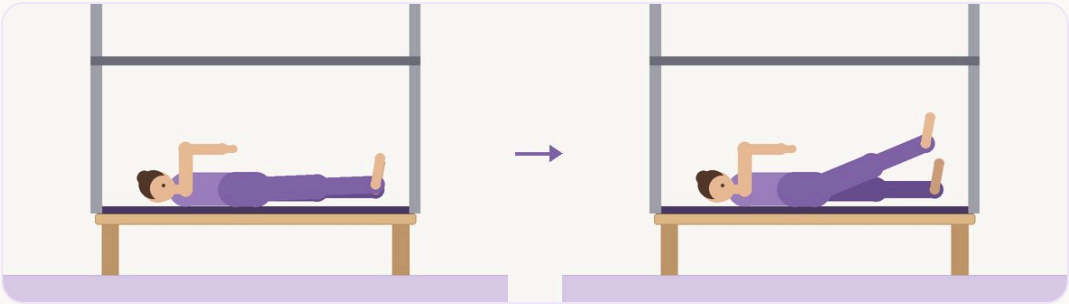
Cue
“Draw your shoulders down and pull up tall.”

Adaptation
Avoid with shoulder or wrist injury; skip in pregnancy. Use spotting and a small range.

Side Leg Springs

side-lying beats

Advanced | Cadillac | V3-127



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on one side with the top leg in a strap.
2. Stack the hips and keep the waist long.
3. Press the leg forward and back or beat.
4. Switch sides.

Focus
Strengthens the hips and stabilizers in side-lying with straps providing resistance.

Target muscles
Gluteus medius, adductors, obliques, hip flexors

Springs
1–2 springs (light setting)

Dosage
8–10 reps each leg · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to press; inhale to return.

Common faults
Rolling the pelvis, lifting the ribs, gripping the neck.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Reduce the range. Harder: Add a longer hold.

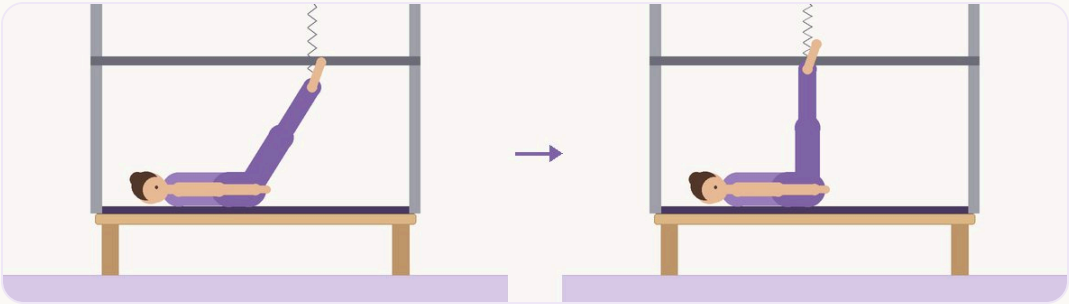
Cue
“Keep your waist long and your hips stacked.”

Adaptation
Use a small range with hip or knee pain; avoid pressure on the belly in pregnancy.

Teaser with Leg Springs

legs in straps

Advanced | Cadillac | V3-128



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie supine with the legs in straps.
2. Roll the spine up into a V.
3. Hold with arms long.
4. Roll down with control.

Focus
Develops deep abdominal strength and balance with straps adding resistance.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, hip flexors, quadriceps, obliques

Springs
1–2 springs (light setting)

Dosage
5–6 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to roll up; inhale to hold; exhale to roll down.

Common faults
Using momentum, pulling the neck, collapsing the chest.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep knees bent. Harder: Lower the legs further.

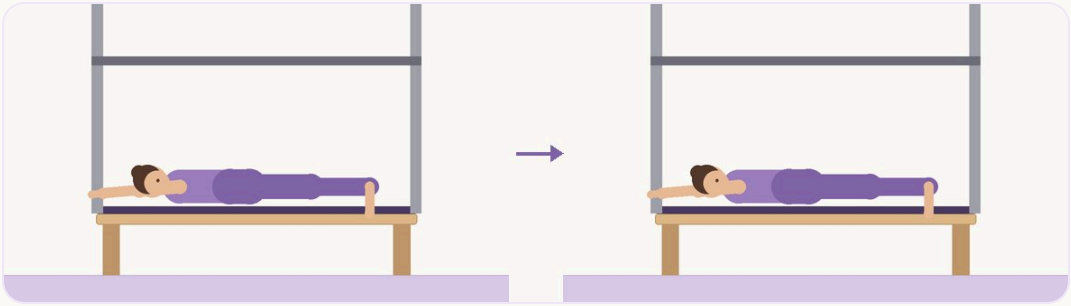
Cue
“Roll up and balance on your sit bones.”

Adaptation
Avoid with neck or lower back pain, or in pregnancy. Choose bent knees.

Flying Eagle

prone

Advanced | Cadillac | V3-129



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie prone holding the bars or straps.
2. Lengthen the spine.
3. Lift the chest and arms.
4. Lower slowly.

Focus
Strengthens the back extensors and improves posture in a long extension pattern.

Target muscles
Erector spinae, lats, glutes, rear deltoids

Springs
1–2 springs (light setting)

Dosage
5–6 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to lengthen; exhale to lift.

Common faults
Overextending the neck, lifting the legs too high, rushing.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep a smaller lift. Harder: Hold at the top.

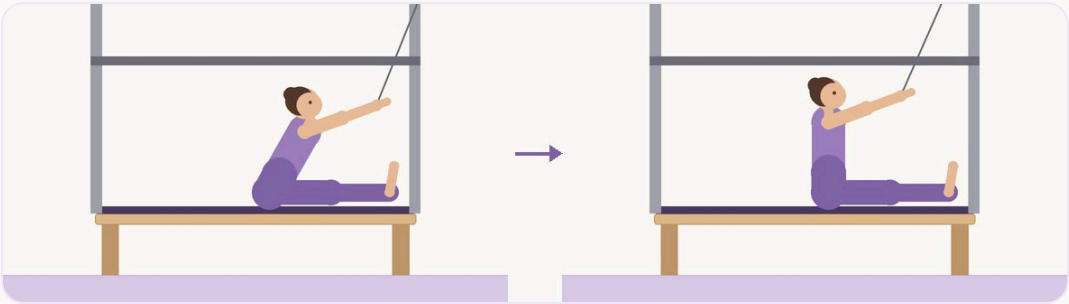
Cue
“Lift long and keep your neck long.”

Adaptation
Avoid prone positioning in pregnancy; avoid with disc or lower back pain.

Cat Stretch

push-through bar

Advanced | Cadillac | V3-130



HOW TO DO IT

1. Kneel facing the bar with hands on it.
2. Round the spine like a cat.
3. Extend and open the chest.
4. Alternate smoothly.

Focus
Mobilizes the spine and stretches the shoulders and back through a flowing cat movement.

Target muscles
Erector spinae, lats, abdominals, shoulders

Springs
1–2 springs (light setting)

Dosage
6–8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to extend; exhale to round.

Common faults
Collapsing the shoulders, rushing, locking the elbows.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Reduce the range. Harder: Add a slow hold.

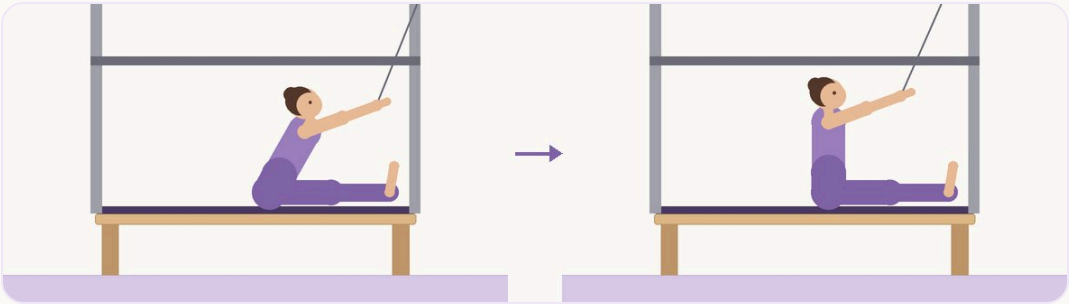
Cue
“Round and lengthen through your spine.”

Adaptation
Avoid with shoulder or wrist pain; reduce range in pregnancy.

Tension Control

roll-down bar

Advanced | Cadillac | V3-131



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit holding the roll-down bar.
2. Roll back slowly with the spine.
3. Hold briefly and breathe.
4. Roll up slowly.

Focus
Builds spinal flexion control and abdominal strength with a controlled roll against the bar.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, obliques, hip flexors, shoulders

Springs
1–2 springs (medium setting)

Dosage
6–8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to roll down; inhale to hold; exhale to roll up.

Common faults
Dropping back, pulling the neck, losing hip connection.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Reduce the range. Harder: Slow the roll.

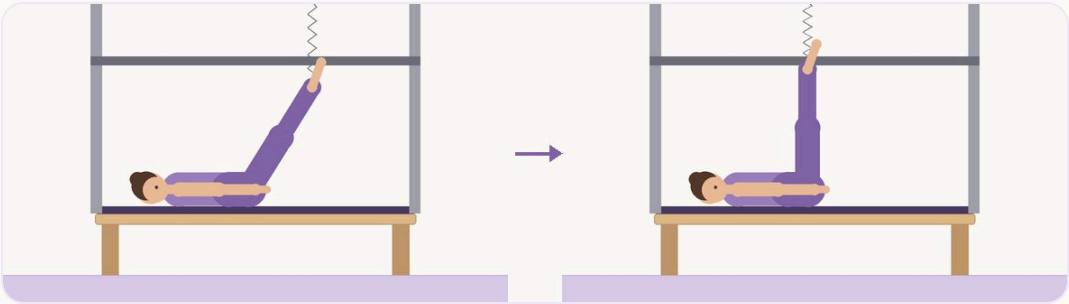
Cue
“Control the bar and roll one vertebra at a time.”

Adaptation
Avoid with lower back or disc concerns, or in pregnancy. Keep the range small.

Shoulder Bridge

leg springs

Advanced | Cadillac | V3-132



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie supine with the feet in straps.
2. Press the hips up into a bridge.
3. Hold briefly.
4. Lower slowly.

Focus
Strengthens the glutes, hamstrings and spine with a supported bridge and springs adding load.

Target muscles
Glutes, hamstrings, erector spinae, abdominals

Springs
1–2 springs (light-medium setting)

Dosage
6–8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to lift; inhale to hold; exhale to lower.

Common faults
Overarching the lower back, pushing the knees out, rushing.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep the legs bent. Harder: Extend one leg.

Cue
“Lift your hips and keep your ribs down.”

Adaptation
Avoid supine for long periods in later pregnancy; keep the spine neutral.

VOLUME 3 · ADVANCED

Wunda Chair

16 exercises

Tendon Stretch

pike over the pedal

Advanced | Wunda Chair | V3-133



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand facing the chair, hands on the pedal edge, feet hip-width.
2. Walk the feet back and lift the hips into a pike.
3. Press the pedal down, keeping the legs straight.
4. Control the pedal back up with the abdominals engaged.

Focus
Lengthens the spine and hamstrings while the arms and abs control a deep pike. Builds shoulder stability and abdominal control.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, hamstrings, triceps, anterior deltoids

Springs
1–2 springs (medium-heavy setting)

Dosage
6–8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to pike up and over; inhale to lower with control.

Common faults
Collapsing the shoulders, dropping the hips, letting the pedal slam up.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep knees slightly bent. Harder: Pause at the top for two breaths.

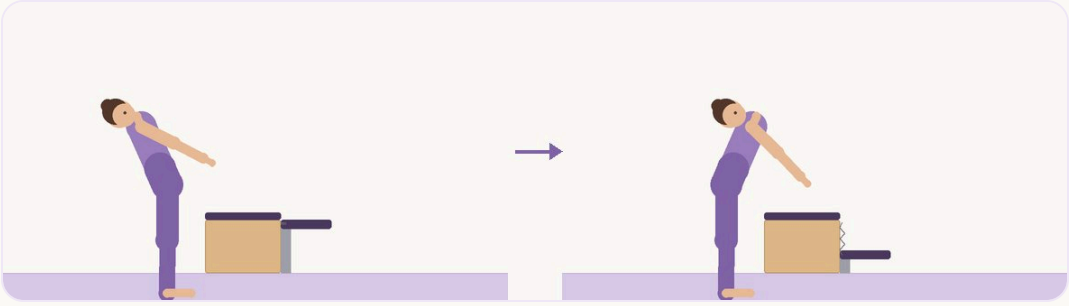
Cue
“Lift your hips and lengthen over the top of the pedal.”

Adaptation
Skip with wrist, shoulder or lower back injury; avoid in pregnancy. Check shoulder comfort before loading.

Mountain Climb

hands on the pedal

Advanced | Wunda Chair | V3-134



HOW TO DO IT

1. Place hands on the pedal, walk back into a long plank.
2. Lift one heel, then step it forward under the hips.
3. Press the pedal down and hold the plank steady.
4. Switch legs with a smooth rhythm.

Focus
Challenges shoulder stability and trunk control with moving legs. Reinforces a long, neutral spine under load.

Target muscles
Deltoids, triceps, abdominals, hip flexors

Springs
1–2 springs (medium-heavy setting)

Dosage
8–10 reps each leg · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare; exhale to climb each leg.

Common faults
Sagging hips, shrugged shoulders, kicking the pedal instead of pressing.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Reduce range and keep feet closer. Harder: Add a longer pause with the pedal down.

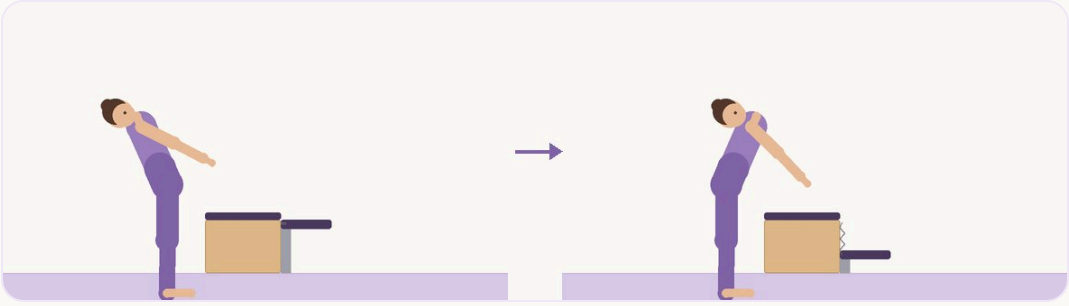
Cue
“Press the floor away and keep your hips level.”

Adaptation
Avoid with wrist or shoulder pain, or in pregnancy. Use a reduced range if the lower back tires.

Going Up Front

from the step

Advanced | Wunda Chair | V3-135



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand on the floor in front of the chair, hands on the pedal.
2. Press the pedal down and step a foot up onto the seat.
3. Lift the hips up and over, finding a balanced pike.
4. Step down with control and reset.

Focus
Strengthens the abdominals and hip flexors while challenging balance on the chair. Teaches control in a standing pike.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, hip flexors, quadriceps, shoulders

Springs
1–2 springs (medium-heavy setting)

Dosage
5–6 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale as you press up and forward; inhale to lower.

Common faults
Rushing the lift, rounding the shoulders, losing control of the pedal.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep the hands lower and the range small. Harder: Slow the lowering to four counts.

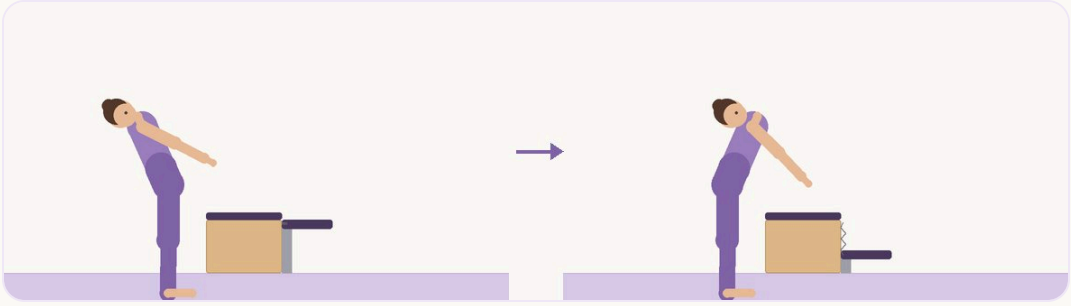
Cue
“Lift from the center of your body, not your feet.”

Adaptation
Skip with balance concerns or shoulder injury. Spot the client closely; avoid in pregnancy.

Swan

on the chair

Advanced | Wunda Chair | V3-136



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie prone over the seat, hands on the pedal edge.
2. Anchor the legs long and press the pedal down.
3. Lift the chest, lengthening the spine into extension.
4. Lower slowly, keeping the neck long.

Focus
Opens the chest and strengthens the back extensors while the pedal resists the arms. A graceful backbend with control.

Target muscles
Erector spinae, rhomboids, glutes, triceps

Springs
1–2 springs (light-medium setting)

Dosage
5–6 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to lengthen; exhale to lift and extend through the upper back.

Common faults
Overextending the lower back, hiking the shoulders, losing leg length.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep hips on the seat with a small lift. Harder: Add a slow pulse at the top.

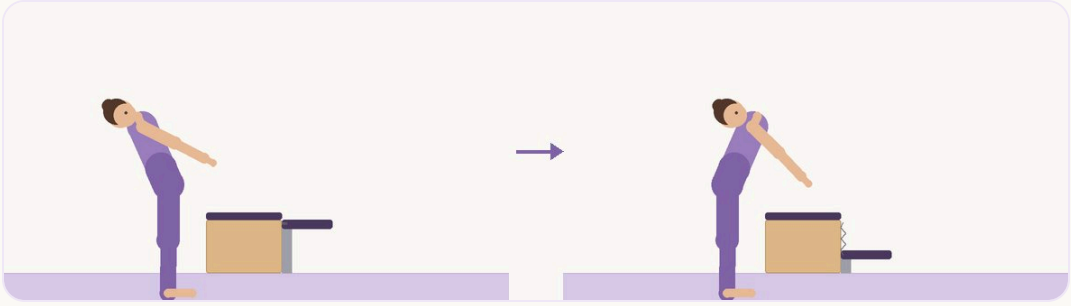
Cue
“Reach long through the crown and open your chest.”

Adaptation
Avoid prone positioning in pregnancy. Use a small range with lower back, shoulder or disc concerns.

Pike on Chair

press-up to inversion

Advanced | Wunda Chair | V3-137



HOW TO DO IT

1. Place hands on the pedal edge, feet on the seat or floor.
2. Lengthen the spine and press the pedal down.
3. Lift the hips high into a pike with straight legs.
4. Lower slowly to the start.

Focus
Builds hip, shoulder and abdominal strength in a controlled inversion on the chair.

Target muscles
Abdominals, deltoids, hamstrings, triceps

Springs
1–2 springs (medium-heavy setting)

Dosage
5–6 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to pike up; inhale to lower with control.

Common faults
Jumping into the pike, bending the elbows, dropping the head.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep the feet on the floor. Harder: Lift one leg at the top.

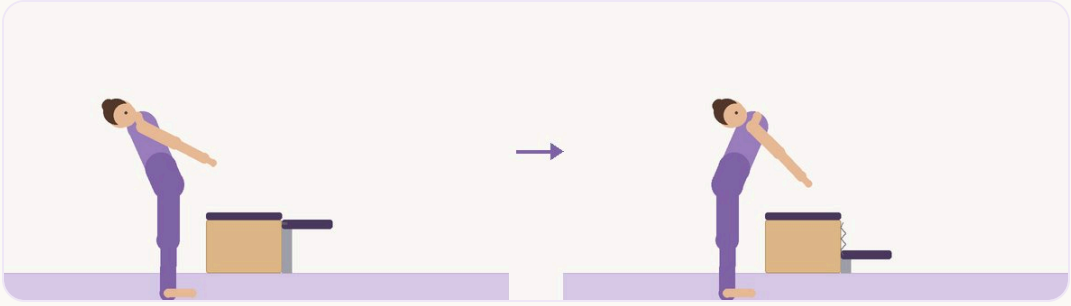
Cue
“Pull your abdominals up and press through your hands.”

Adaptation
Avoid with neck, shoulder or wrist problems, high blood pressure or pregnancy. Do not invert unsupervised.

Teaser

with hands on the pedal

Advanced | Wunda Chair | V3-138



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit on the chair, hands on the pedal, legs lifted.
2. Roll the spine into a long V position.
3. Press the pedal down lightly and balance.
4. Roll down with control.

Focus
Develops deep abdominal strength and balance in a V-sit. The chair pedal adds resistance for the arms.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, hip flexors, quadriceps, triceps

Springs
1–2 springs (light setting)

Dosage
5–6 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to roll up; inhale to hold; exhale to roll down.

Common faults
Using momentum, rounding the neck, collapsing the chest.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep the knees bent. Harder: Lower the legs closer to the floor.

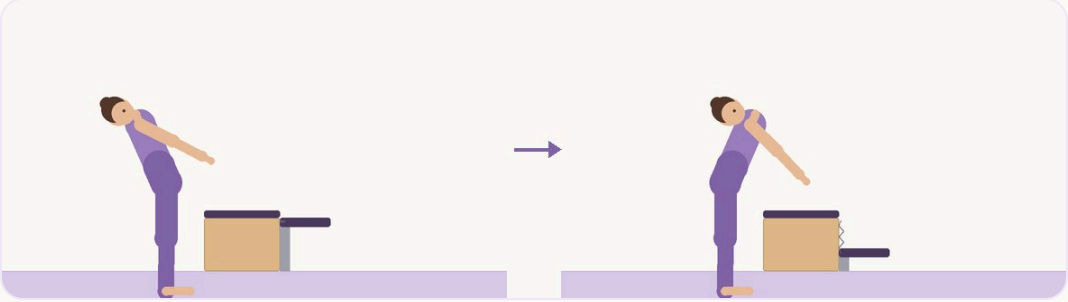
Cue
“Roll up slowly and balance on your sit bones.”

Adaptation
Avoid with neck or lower back pain; skip in pregnancy. Choose a bent-knee variation if the abdominals fatigue.

Pull-Up

hanging from the pedal

Advanced | Wunda Chair | V3-139



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand tall with hands on the pedal handles.
2. Draw the shoulders down and pull the chest forward.
3. Hold briefly at the top of the pull.
4. Lower with control back to the start.

Focus
Builds strength in the shoulders, lats and arms with a pull toward the pedal. A challenging upper-body exercise.

Target muscles
Latissimus dorsi, biceps, lower trapezius, abdominals

Springs
2–3 springs (heavier setting)

Dosage
5–6 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to pull up; inhale to lower slowly.

Common faults
Shrugging the shoulders, losing abdominal control, bouncing.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep the feet on the floor to assist. Harder: Hold the top for two breaths.

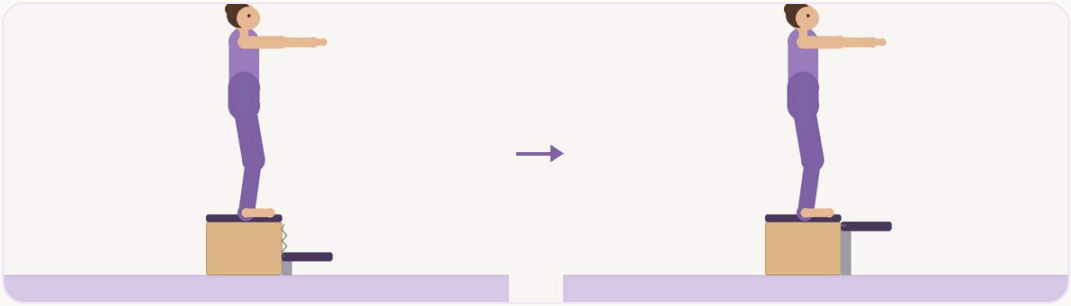
Cue
“Draw your shoulder blades down and pull tall.”

Adaptation
Avoid with shoulder or wrist injury; use a reduced range for neck concerns. Not for pregnancy.

Frog

on the chair

Advanced | Wunda Chair | V3-140



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit near the front with hands on the pedal edge.
2. Bring the heels together and open the knees.
3. Press the legs long without pushing the hips.
4. Return with control.

Focus
Works the inner thighs and hip rotators with a gentle spinal flexion. Teaches control through the full range.

Target muscles
Adductors, glutes, hamstrings, abdominals

Springs
1–2 springs (medium setting)

Dosage
8–10 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to open the knees; exhale to press the legs together.

Common faults
Gripping with the hips, lifting the ribs, losing the pelvic curl.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep the heels higher. Harder: Pause at full extension.

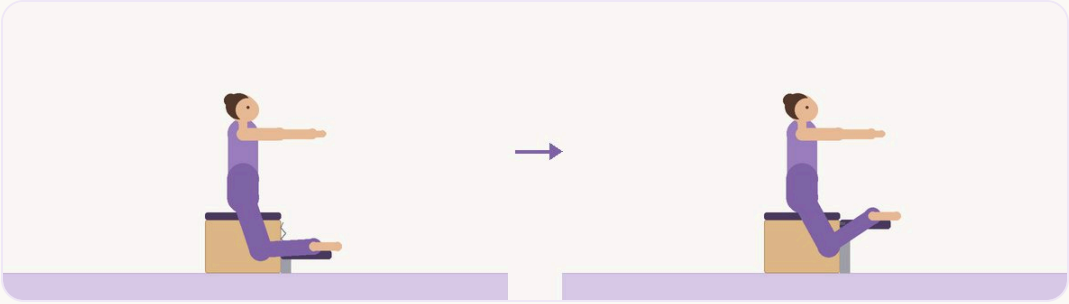
Cue
“Squeeze your heels together and lengthen your legs.”

Adaptation
Avoid flexion past comfort in pregnancy. Keep the spine neutral with lower back or hip concerns.

Side Sit-Up

over the chair

Advanced | Wunda Chair | V3-141



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie side-bending over the seat with the legs long.
2. Place hands lightly behind the head.
3. Curl up and over, keeping the chest open.
4. Lower slowly back to the start.

Focus
Builds oblique strength with a lateral curl. Improves lateral stability and spinal control.

Target muscles
Obliques, quadratus lumborum, hip abductors

Springs
1–2 springs (light setting)

Dosage
6–8 reps each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to lengthen; exhale to curl up and over.

Common faults
Rotating the torso, using the neck, collapsing the hip.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Reduce the range of the curl. Harder: Place the arms overhead.

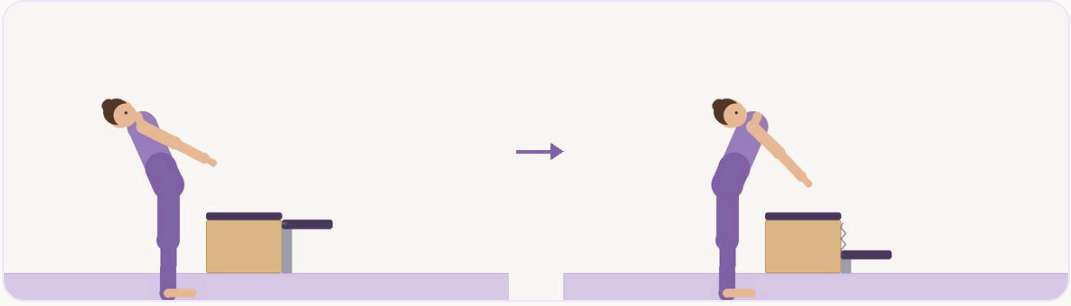
Cue
“Lift up and over, keeping your ribs aligned.”

Adaptation
Avoid with lower back or hip pain; skip in pregnancy. Support the hips if needed.

Washerwoman

on the pedal

Advanced | Wunda Chair | V3-142



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand in a plank with hands on the pedal.
2. Brace the abdominals and steady the hips.
3. Press the pedal in a small circular pattern.
4. Reverse direction and repeat.

Focus
Builds deep core control while the arms press the pedal in small, controlled circles.

Target muscles
Transversus abdominis, obliques, shoulders, triceps

Springs
1–2 springs (medium setting)

Dosage
6–8 reps each direction · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to press and circle; inhale to return.

Common faults
Rotating the pelvis, shrugging the shoulders, over-pressing.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Reduce the circle size. Harder: Lift the knees for extra core demand.

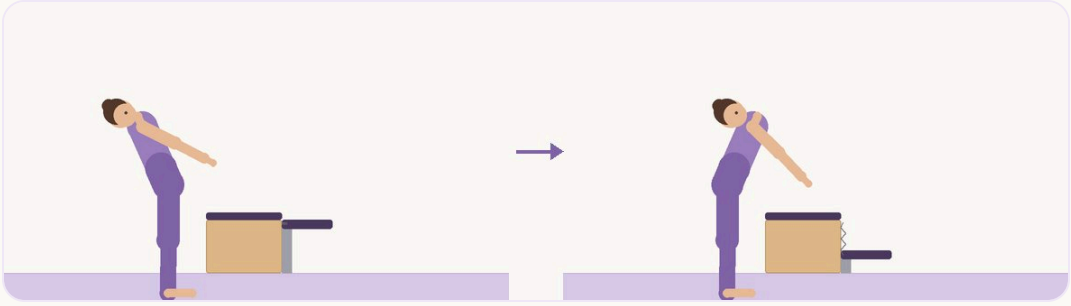
Cue
“Keep your hips quiet as your arms press.”

Adaptation
Avoid with shoulder or wrist pain, or in pregnancy. Keep the lumbar spine neutral.

Single Leg Push Down

standing on the chair

Advanced | Wunda Chair | V3-143



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand on one leg beside the chair.
2. Place the other foot on the pedal.
3. Press the pedal down with a long leg.
4. Return slowly while keeping the pelvis level.

Focus
Strengthens the leg and hip while challenging balance. Reinforces pelvic stability on one leg.

Target muscles
Quadriceps, gluteals, calves, abdominals

Springs
1–2 springs (medium-heavy setting)

Dosage
8–10 reps each leg · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to press down; inhale to lift the pedal.

Common faults
Hip hiking, locking the standing knee, gripping the toes.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Hold a support nearby. Harder: Add a slow tempo.

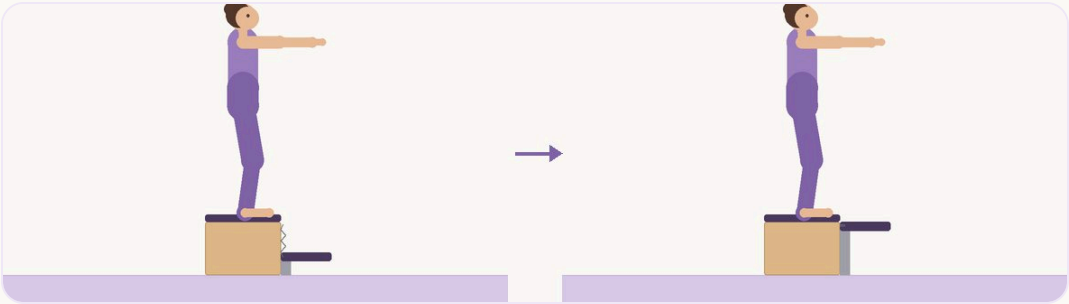
Cue
“Press down through your whole foot and stay tall.”

Adaptation
Skip with knee instability or balance concerns. Use support and a smaller range in pregnancy or older adults.

Standing Leg Pump

on the pedal

Advanced | Wunda Chair | V3-144



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand facing the chair with one foot on the pedal.
2. Find your balance over the standing leg.
3. Press the pedal down and extend the leg.
4. Return in a smooth, controlled motion.

Focus
Develops leg strength and balance, with the pedal resisting the working leg as the standing leg stabilizes.

Target muscles
Quadriceps, hamstrings, glutes, calves

Springs
1–2 springs (medium setting)

Dosage
10 reps each leg · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to pump the leg; inhale to return.

Common faults
Collapsing the standing ankle, tilting the pelvis, locking the knee.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Reduce the range and hold a wall. Harder: Lift the arms overhead.

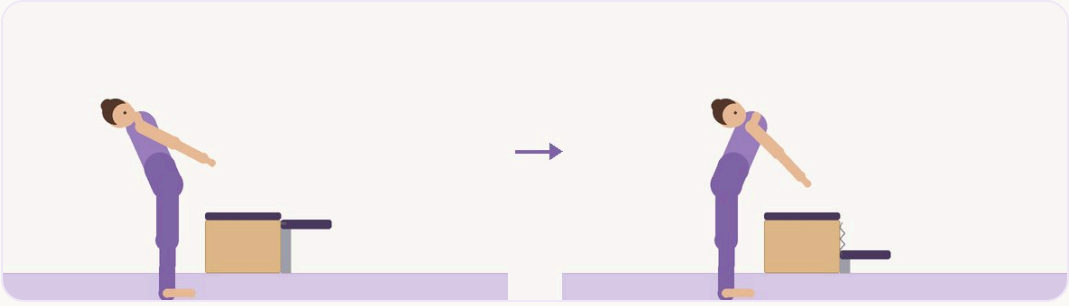
Cue
“Lengthen your leg and keep your pelvis level.”

Adaptation
Avoid with ankle or knee injury; use a support. Skip balance-challenging versions in late pregnancy.

Triceps Dips

facing away

Advanced | Wunda Chair | V3-145



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit on the edge with hands gripping the seat.
2. Slide the hips off the seat, legs long.
3. Lower by bending the elbows slowly.
4. Press up through the arms.

Focus
Strengthens the backs of the arms and shoulders with a deep dip from the chair edge.

Target muscles
Triceps, posterior deltoids, pectorals

Springs
1–2 springs (medium setting)

Dosage
8–10 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to bend the elbows; exhale to press up.

Common faults
Flaring the elbows, dropping the shoulders forward, bouncing.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Bend the knees. Harder: Straighten the legs.

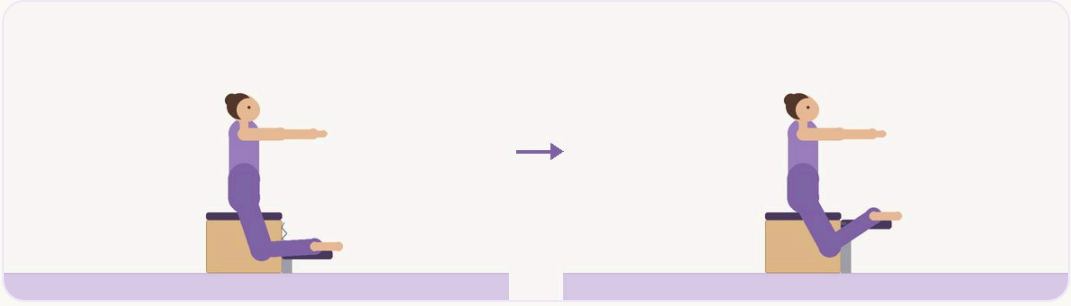
Cue
“Keep your elbows hugging back as you lower.”

Adaptation
Avoid with shoulder or wrist pain; limit the range in older adults or pregnancy.

Twist Up

with a rotation

Advanced | Wunda Chair | V3-146



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand with one hand on the pedal.
2. Reach the other arm long and rotate.
3. Press the pedal to deepen the twist.
4. Return smoothly to center.

Focus
Builds rotational control through the spine while the pedal challenges the arms and trunk.

Target muscles
Obliques, erector spinae, shoulders, hips

Springs
1–2 springs (medium setting)

Dosage
5–6 reps each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to twist; inhale to unwind.

Common faults
Twisting from the neck, shrugging, rushing the rotation.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Reduce the range of rotation. Harder: Add a hold at the end range.

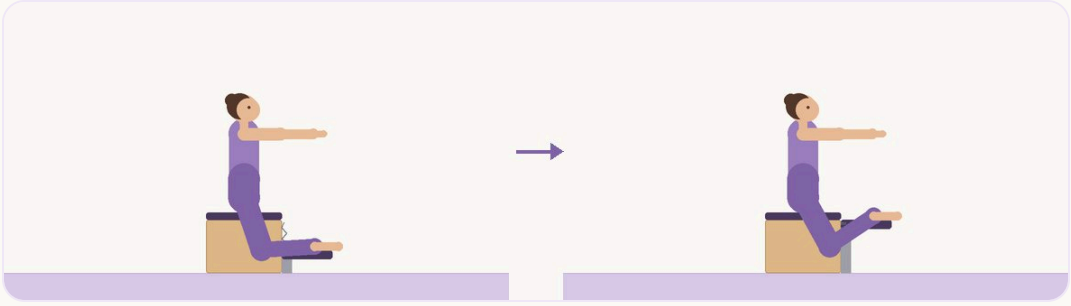
Cue
“Rotate from the ribs and keep your hips square.”

Adaptation
Avoid deep rotation with disc or lower back concerns; skip in pregnancy. Move within a pain-free range.

Arabesque

on the chair

Advanced | Wunda Chair | V3-147



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand beside the chair with one hand on the pedal.
2. Press the pedal down and lift the opposite leg behind.
3. Lengthen through the spine and hold briefly.
4. Lower the leg and switch sides.

Focus
Builds balance, hip extension and leg strength with the chair providing a stable base.

Target muscles
Glutes, hamstrings, erector spinae, deltoids

Springs
1–2 springs (medium setting)

Dosage
6–8 reps each leg · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to lift the leg; inhale to lower.

Common faults
Overarching the back, twisting the hips, shifting the weight back.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep the toe on the floor. Harder: Add arm reaches.

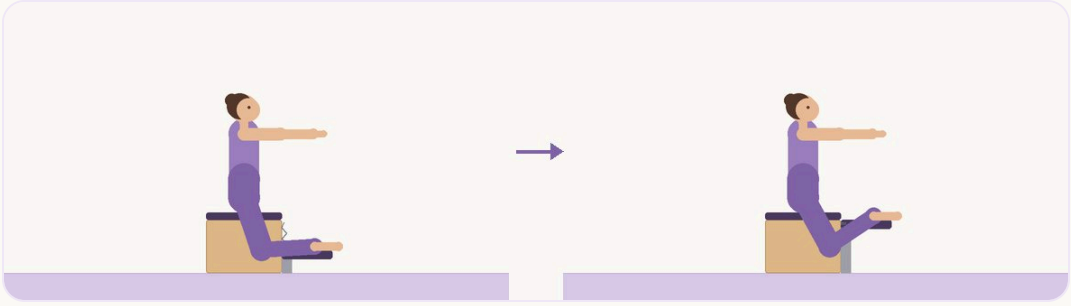
Cue
“Reach long through the leg and the crown of your head.”

Adaptation
Use support with balance concerns; avoid in late pregnancy. Reduce extension for lower back pain.

Backward Arm Press

kneeling

Advanced | Wunda Chair | V3-148



HOW TO DO IT

1. Kneel facing away from the pedal with hands on it.
2. Lengthen the spine and draw the shoulders down.
3. Press the pedal back behind you.
4. Return slowly under control.

Focus
Opens the chest and strengthens the upper back and arms as the pedal presses backward.

Target muscles
Triceps, rhomboids, rear deltoids, abdominals

Springs
1–2 springs (light-medium setting)

Dosage
8–10 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to press back; inhale to return.

Common faults
Shrugging, arching the lower back, collapsing the chest.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Lower the range. Harder: Hold the press for two breaths.

Cue
“Press back and keep your chest open.”

Adaptation
Avoid with shoulder pain; sit if kneeling bothers the knees. Keep a neutral spine in pregnancy.

VOLUME 3 · ADVANCED

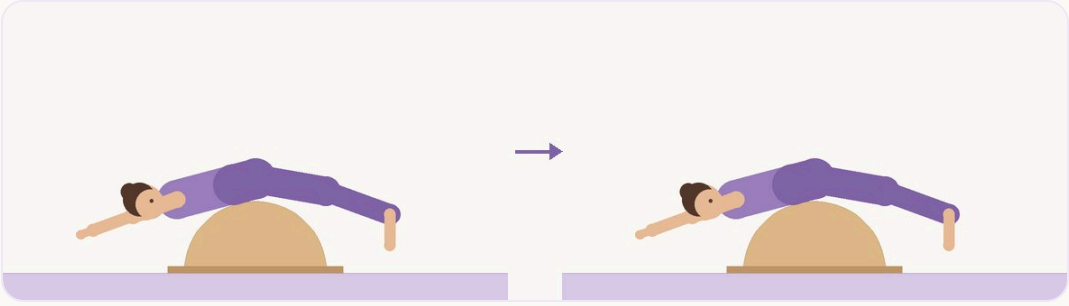
Barrel

12 exercises

Hug-a-Tree

over the barrel

Advanced | Barrel | V3-149



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit on the barrel with feet in the strap or anchored.
2. Extend back over the barrel with arms wide.
3. Lift and hug the arms toward the center.
4. Lower slowly.

Focus
Stretches the chest and lengthens the spine while the barrel supports the back. Introduces opening the thoracic spine.

Target muscles
Pectorals, erector spinae, abdominals, hip flexors

Springs
No springs (bodyweight)

Dosage
6–8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to open the arms; exhale to hug and curl.

Common faults
Overarching the lower back, tensing the neck, rushing the arms.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep the arms low. Harder: Add a longer hold at the top.

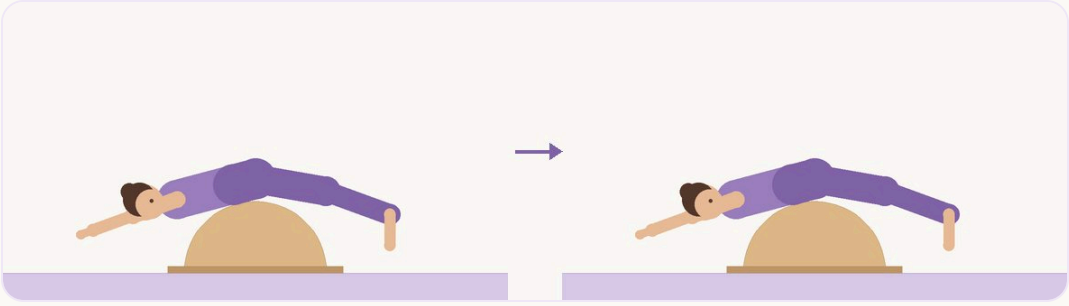
Cue
“Open your arms wide and lengthen through the spine.”

Adaptation
Support the head if the neck is sensitive; avoid in late pregnancy. Use a small range with lower back pain.

Swan

on the barrel

Advanced | Barrel | V3-150



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie prone over the barrel with hands on the floor.
2. Anchor the legs and lengthen the spine.
3. Lift the chest into extension.
4. Lower slowly.

Focus
Strengthens the back extensors and opens the chest while the barrel supports the torso.

Target muscles
Erector spinae, rhomboids, glutes, lats

Springs
No springs (bodyweight)

Dosage
5–6 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to lengthen; exhale to lift the chest.

Common faults
Hyperextending the neck, hiking the shoulders, tensing the glutes.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep the range small. Harder: Add an arm lift.

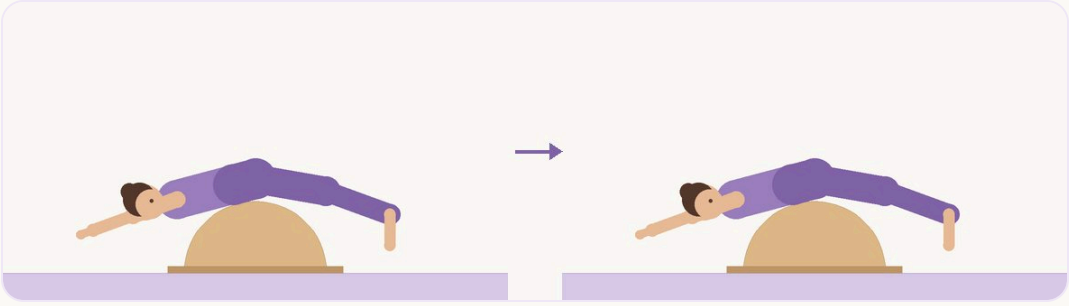
Cue
“Lift from your upper back and keep your neck long.”

Adaptation
Avoid prone positioning in pregnancy. Use a small range with disc or lower back concerns.

Swan Dive

rocking forward

Advanced | Barrel | V3-151



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie prone on the barrel with the arms reaching.
2. Lift the chest and legs into extension.
3. Rock forward and back with control.
4. Lower slowly to the start.

Focus
Builds back extension strength and control in a rocking motion over the barrel.

Target muscles
Erector spinae, glutes, hamstrings, shoulders

Springs
No springs (bodyweight)

Dosage
5–6 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to reach long; exhale to lift and rock.

Common faults
Rushing, losing neck alignment, jerking the movement.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep the hands on the floor. Harder: Reach the arms long in front.

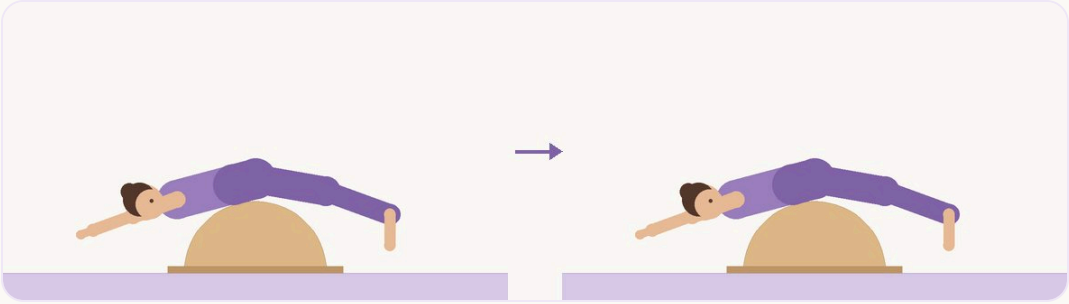
Cue
“Rock from the center and reach forward.”

Adaptation
Avoid with lower back pain, disc issues or pregnancy. Begin with a small range and supervision.

Back Extension

over the barrel

Advanced | Barrel | V3-152



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie prone over the barrel, legs anchored.
2. Hands rest behind the head.
3. Lift the chest into long extension.
4. Lower slowly.

Focus
Strengthens the posterior chain with a controlled lift over the barrel support.

Target muscles
Erector spinae, glutes, hamstrings, mid back

Springs
No springs (bodyweight)

Dosage
8–10 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare; exhale to extend; inhale to lower.

Common faults
Overextending the neck, gripping the glutes, lifting too fast.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Place the hands behind the head. Harder: Reach the arms overhead.

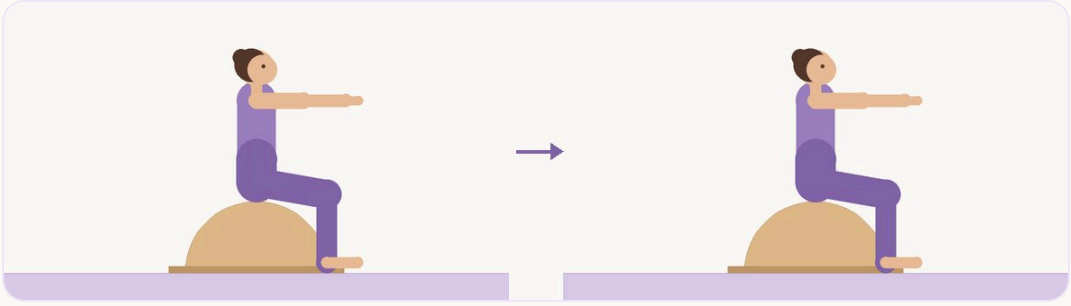
Cue
“Lengthen and lift through the crown.”

Adaptation
Avoid in pregnancy and with acute lower back pain. Keep the range small.

Horseback

seated on the barrel

Advanced | Barrel | V3-153



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit astride the barrel with the legs hugging.
2. Lengthen the spine and extend the arms.
3. Lean back slightly, then return.
4. Keep the hips steady.

Focus
Develops balance and core control as the legs hold the barrel while the torso moves.

Target muscles
Obliques, hip adductors, abdominals, shoulders

Springs
No springs (bodyweight)

Dosage
6–8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare; exhale to move.

Common faults
Gripping the neck, leaning back, losing leg connection.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Hold the barrel edge. Harder: Extend the arms overhead.

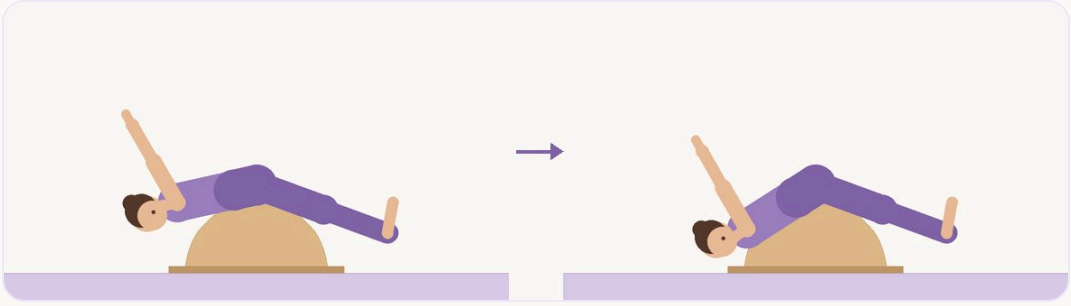
Cue
“Squeeze your legs and stay tall.”

Adaptation
Skip in pregnancy or balance issues; use support if hips are tight.

Side Stretch

over the barrel

Advanced | Barrel | V3-154



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie sideways over the barrel with the hip supported.
2. Reach the top arm overhead.
3. Stretch long over the barrel.
4. Return to center slowly.

Focus
Lengthens the lateral trunk and improves side-bending mobility while the barrel supports the hip.

Target muscles
Obliques, quadratus lumborum, intercostals, lats

Springs
No springs (bodyweight)

Dosage
3 breaths each side · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to lengthen; exhale to stretch over.

Common faults
Collapsing forward, lifting the hip, rushing.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Reduce the reach. Harder: Reach the top arm farther.

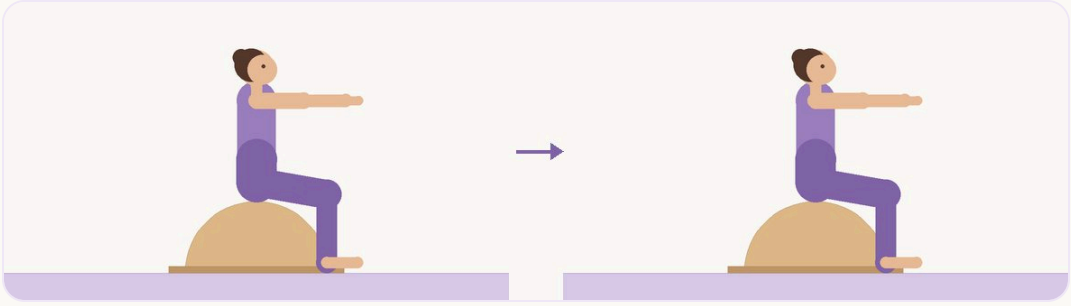
Cue
“Lengthen from your waist and reach over.”

Adaptation
Use a small range with shoulder pain; avoid deep side bends in late pregnancy.

Mermaid

on the barrel

Advanced | Barrel | V3-155



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit on the barrel side-sitting.
2. Reach one arm overhead.
3. Side-bend over the barrel.
4. Return slowly.

Focus
Stretches the side body while improving spinal mobility and shoulder control.

Target muscles
Obliques, lats, intercostals, shoulders

Springs
No springs (bodyweight)

Dosage
3 breaths each side · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to reach; exhale to deepen the stretch.

Common faults
Leaning forward, shrugging the shoulder, tilting the pelvis.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep the hand lower. Harder: Add an overhead reach.

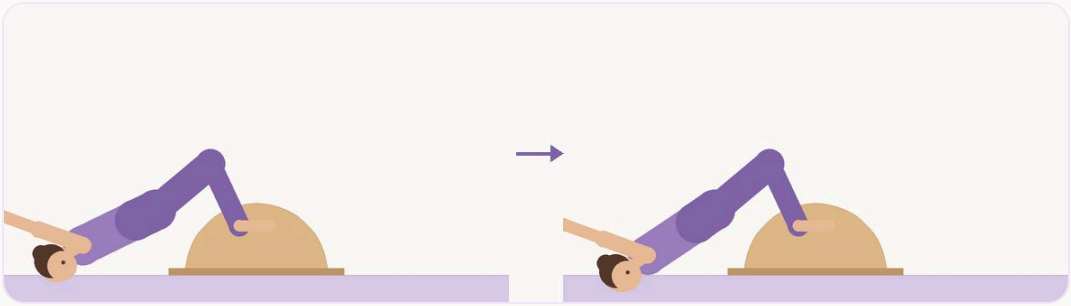
Cue
“Reach up and over without twisting.”

Adaptation
Avoid with shoulder or hip pain; support the hips in late pregnancy.

Teaser

on the barrel

Advanced | Barrel | V3-156



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit on the barrel with the legs lifted.
2. Roll back with a long spine.
3. Lift the arms to a V position.
4. Roll down slowly.

Focus
Builds abdominal control and balance while rolling up on the barrel.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, hip flexors, quadriceps, obliques

Springs
No springs (bodyweight)

Dosage
5–6 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to roll up; inhale to hold; exhale to roll down.

Common faults
Using momentum, pulling the neck, collapsing the chest.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep knees bent. Harder: Lower the legs closer to the floor.

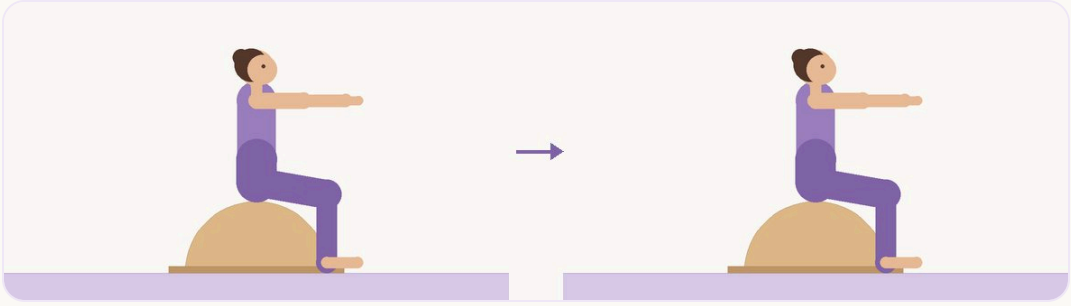
Cue
“Roll up and balance on your sit bones.”

Adaptation
Avoid with lower back or neck pain, or in pregnancy. Choose the bent-knee version.

Ab Roll-Back

seated on the barrel

Advanced | Barrel | V3-157



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit on the barrel with feet anchored.
2. Roll back slowly through the spine.
3. Pause at a controlled depth.
4. Roll up through the abdominals.

Focus
Strengthens the abdominals with a controlled roll-back that challenges flexion strength.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, obliques, hip flexors

Springs
No springs (bodyweight)

Dosage
6–8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to roll back; inhale to hold; exhale to return.

Common faults
Dropping back too fast, tensing the neck, lifting the ribs.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Reduce the range. Harder: Add arm pulses.

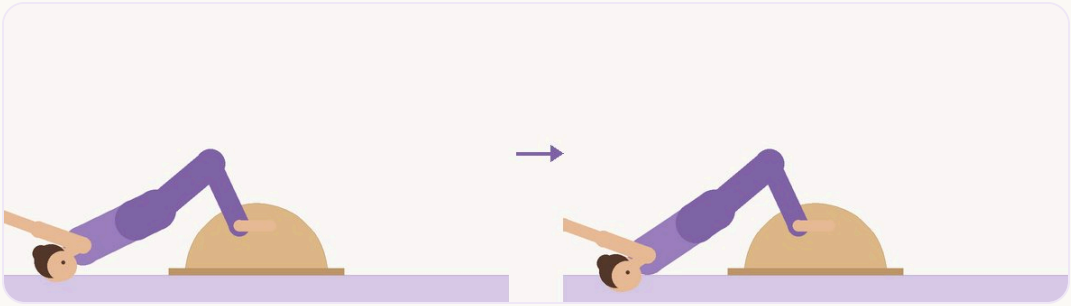
Cue
“Roll back one vertebra at a time.”

Adaptation
Avoid in pregnancy and with disc injury. Limit range with lower back pain.

Hundred

on the barrel

Advanced | Barrel | V3-158



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie supine over the barrel, legs lifted.
2. Curl the head and shoulders up.
3. Pump the arms vigorously.
4. Breathe in 5, out 5 for ten rounds.

Focus
Builds abdominal endurance and breath control on the barrel in an incline.

Target muscles
Transversus abdominis, rectus abdominis, hip flexors

Springs
No springs (bodyweight)

Dosage
100 beats · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale for 5 pumps; exhale for 5 pumps.

Common faults
Straining the neck, arching the lower back, holding the breath.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Bend the knees. Harder: Lower the legs.

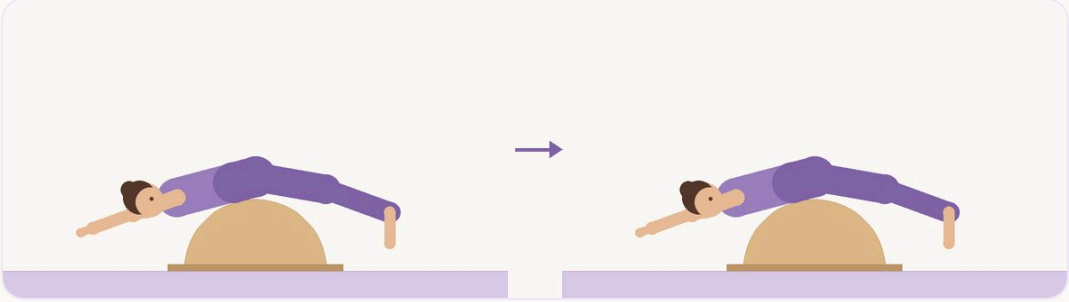
Cue
“Pump your arms and keep the breath steady.”

Adaptation
Avoid with neck or back pain, or in pregnancy. Keep the head supported.

Leg Pull Front

on the barrel

Advanced | Barrel | V3-159



HOW TO DO IT

1. Place hands on the floor and legs over the barrel.
2. Plank with a straight body line.
3. Lift one leg and lower with control.
4. Alternate sides.

Focus
Challenges the trunk and shoulders in a long plank while lifting each leg.

Target muscles
Abdominals, glutes, deltoids, triceps

Springs
No springs (bodyweight)

Dosage
6–8 reps each leg · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to lift the leg; exhale to lower.

Common faults
Dropping the hips, shifting the weight, shrugging.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep the knees down. Harder: Hold each lift longer.

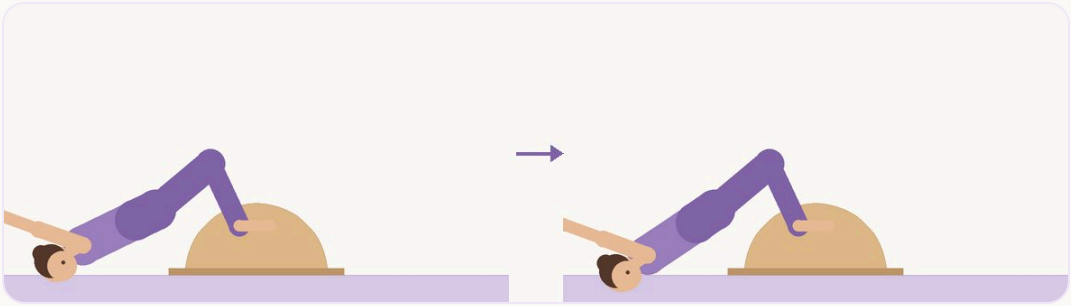
Cue
“Press the floor away and keep your body long.”

Adaptation
Avoid with wrist or shoulder pain and in pregnancy. Reduce the range for lower back concerns.

Hamstring Stretch

over the barrel

Advanced | Barrel | V3-160



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie over the barrel with one leg extended up.
2. Hold the leg with both hands or a strap.
3. Lengthen the leg gently.
4. Switch sides.

Focus
Lengthens the hamstrings and lower back while the barrel supports the body.

Target muscles
Hamstrings, gastrocnemius, erector spinae

Springs
No springs (bodyweight)

Dosage
30 sec hold each leg · about 2 min

Breathing
Breathe slowly through the stretch.

Common faults
Rounding the lower back, locking the knee, forcing the range.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Bend the knee slightly. Harder: Add a gentle flex.

Cue
“Lengthen your leg and breathe into the stretch.”

Adaptation
Avoid if hamstring injury or sciatica; stop with pain. Support the pelvis in late pregnancy.

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V3-113 Stomach Massage – Reaching (with the arms) · Reformer
V3-114 Lunge – Front Split (stretching the hip flexors) · Reformer
V3-115 Roll-Down (with push-through bar) · Cadillac
V3-116 Push-Through Teaser (lifting the legs) · Cadillac
V3-117 Prone Push-Through (with the bar) · Cadillac
V3-118 Tower (on the tower) · Cadillac
V3-119 Monkey (on the tower) · Cadillac
V3-120 Frog (leg springs) · Cadillac
V3-121 Circles (leg springs) · Cadillac
V3-122 Walking (leg springs) · Cadillac
V3-123 Bicycle (leg springs) · Cadillac
V3-124 Airplane (hanging) · Cadillac
V3-125 Spread Eagle (hanging) · Cadillac
V3-126 Hanging Pull-Ups (from the bar) · Cadillac
V3-127 Side Leg Springs (side-lying beats) · Cadillac
V3-128 Teaser with Leg Springs (legs in straps) · Cadillac
V3-129 Flying Eagle (prone) · Cadillac
V3-130 Cat Stretch (push-through bar) · Cadillac
V3-131 Tension Control (roll-down bar) · Cadillac
V3-132 Shoulder Bridge (leg springs) · Cadillac
V3-133 Tendon Stretch (pike over the pedal) · Wunda Chair

V3-134 Mountain Climb (hands on the pedal) · Wunda Chair
V3-135 Going Up Front (from the step) · Wunda Chair
V3-136 Swan (on the chair) · Wunda Chair
V3-137 Pike on Chair (press-up to inversion) · Wunda Chair
V3-138 Teaser (with hands on the pedal) · Wunda Chair
V3-139 Pull-Up (hanging from the pedal) · Wunda Chair
V3-140 Frog (on the chair) · Wunda Chair
V3-141 Side Sit-Up (over the chair) · Wunda Chair
V3-142 Washerwoman (on the pedal) · Wunda Chair
V3-143 Single Leg Push Down (standing on the chair) · Wunda Chair
V3-144 Standing Leg Pump (on the pedal) · Wunda Chair
V3-145 Triceps Dips (facing away) · Wunda Chair
V3-146 Twist Up (with a rotation) · Wunda Chair
V3-147 Arabesque (on the chair) · Wunda Chair
V3-148 Backward Arm Press (kneeling) · Wunda Chair
V3-149 Hug-a-Tree (over the barrel) · Barrel
V3-150 Swan (on the barrel) · Barrel
V3-151 Swan Dive (rocking forward) · Barrel
V3-152 Back Extension (over the barrel) · Barrel
V3-153 Horseback (seated on the barrel) · Barrel
V3-154 Side Stretch (over the barrel) · Barrel
V3-155 Mermaid (on the barrel) · Barrel
V3-156 Teaser (on the barrel) · Barrel
V3-157 Ab Roll-Back (seated on the barrel) · Barrel
V3-158 Hundred (on the barrel) · Barrel
V3-159 Leg Pull Front (on the barrel) · Barrel
V3-160 Hamstring Stretch (over the barrel) · Barrel